BENNETT, COLEMAN & CO. LTD. | Estd. 1838 | VOL. 43 NO. 265 BENGALURU | MONDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2026 | METRO | PAGES 16 | PRICE ₹5*

THE TIMES OF INDIA

INCLUDES 4 PAGES OF BANGALORE TIMES

HAPPY DEEPAVALI

INDIA'S LARGEST ENGLISH NEWSPAPER

Ayush Badoni replaces Rajat Patidar in India A squad for Rising Stars Asia Cup; Rinku Singh to be vice-captain

SHRI. D.K. SHIVAKUMAR
Hon'ble Chief Minister
Government of Karnataka

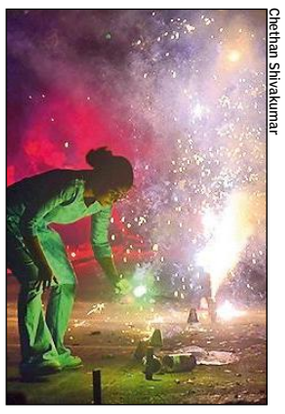
BENGALURU TECH SUMMIT 2026
BIEC | Nov 17-19, 2026

AI & BEYOND
120+ Sessions | 25,000+ Delegates | 60,000+ Business Visitors | 75+ Countries
1000+ Tech Startups | 1800+ Exhibitors | 700+ Speakers
+91 91488 62559

DR. G. PARAMESHWARA
Hon'ble Dy. Chief Minister
Government of Karnataka

Mekedatu needs TN cooperation, not nod, says CM

Chief minister D K Shivakumar on Sunday sought Tamil Nadu's cooperation for implementing the proposed Mekedatu project. His remarks came in response to TN chief minister C Joseph Vijay writing to the Centre, opposing the project. Shivakumar said Karnataka did not require Tamil Nadu's permission but only its cooperation to implement the project. **P 4**



Chethan Shivakumar

It's all sound and fireworks as Bengalureans basked in festive spirit and celebrated Deepavali on Sunday | **P 2**

Maha DCM's son meets Pawar Sr twice in two days

Maharashtra deputy CM Sunetra Pawar's elder son and Rajya Sabha member Parth Pawar Sunday met his granduncle and NCP (SP) chief Sharad Pawar for the second consecutive day at the latter's Mumbai residence amid renewed speculation that a disgruntled section of NCP was attempting to revive merger talks with the rival faction. **P 5**

FLIPPED IT by THE TIMES OF INDIA
A 60-SECOND DAILY WORD CHALLENGE.
Crack the word, build your streak, share your score. Top scorers get featured in TOI.

House Dem leader for Hegseth impeachment

House Democratic leader Hakeem Jeffries backed impeaching secretary of defence Pete Hegseth, saying he's a "hard yes" on a measure that may be introduced as soon as this week. "He engineered this reckless and costly war of choice in Iran." **P 10**

Another injured dies, Assam blast toll 4

A worker injured in the Nov 6 explosion at Oil India Limited's Intermediate Tank Farm in Assam died during treatment, taking the toll to four. The deceased was among seven workers who suffered burn injuries. **P 6**

Reds gone, but 'dimagi Naxals' still instigating people: Modi

'Identify, Defeat Such Elements To Safeguard India'

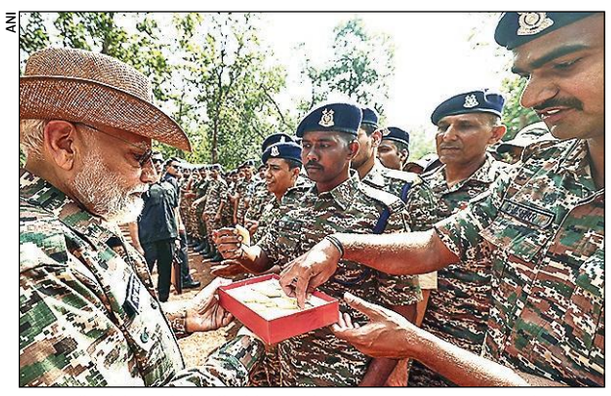
Rashmi.Drolia
@timesofindia.com

Raipur: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Sunday warned that the end of armed Maoist insurgency did not mean the threat had disappeared, alleging that what he called 'Dimagi Naxals' had infiltrated political parties and organisations and were inciting people against the Constitution and democracy.

Continuing his long-standing tradition of celebrating Diwali with security forces, this time at Karanpur camp in Chhattisgarh's Bastar — once the epicentre of Maoist insurgency and declared free of Naxalism on March 31 this year — he called for identifying and defeating such elements to safeguard the country.

Calling it a historic Diwali after nearly five decades of conflict, Modi said this was the first festival of lights when every district in the country was free from Maoist insurgency. "This is the first Diwali after the country has won its decades-long battle against Naxalism and Maoist terror. This is the first Diwali when every district is free from Naxalism," he said, attributing the achievement to the courage, sacrifices and dedication of security forces.

Modi asserted that for the first time in 47 years, the CRPF had completed a year without losing a single jawan in operational duty.



ANI

PM Modi celebrated Diwali with security forces at Karanpur camp in Bastar

Rajnath pays homage to war heroes in Sikkim

Defence minister Rajnath Singh visited Sherathang near Nathu La in Sikkim Sunday and paid homage to fallen soldiers at the war memorial. Addressing Army personnel stationed at India-China border, he said such memorials served as a lasting tribute to war heroes who made the supreme sacrifice for the nation & will continue to inspire generations of young Indians. **P 6**

▶'Political will', P 6

In Noel's crosshairs, Chandra and Mehli reconnect at Tata HQ

Reeba.Zachariah
@timesofindia.com

Mumbai: Fresh from Italy, where Tata Motors announced the acquisition of commercial vehicle maker Iveco, Tata Sons chairman N Chandrasekaran invited Mehli Mistry, the late Ratan Tata's confidant and a trustee of the Tata Education and Development Trust, to Bombay House on Thursday.

Coming just days after the two were seen together at the wedding celebrations of Mehli's daughter Laila, the meeting reinforced a belief within Tata circles that relations between the two are improving after more than a year marked by a broader power shift within the Tata Group following the death of Ratan Tata.

People familiar with the matter said Chandrasekaran and Mehli, who was voted out of the two principal trusts that hold majority in Tata Sons by Noel Tata and others, discussed issues that had affected their ties.

REBUILDING TRUST

Chandrasekaran at the wedding celebrations of Mehli's daughter Laila

- **For much of past decade,** Mehli and the Tata Sons chief were **regarded as allies**
- Their **conversation last week** was focused on rebuilding trust, **restoring working equation**

▶Restoring equation, P 9

SEC sets the stage for local body polls in Jan

Bengaluru: With the state govt planning to hold elections to zilla panchayats and taluk panchayats across Karnataka in Jan 2027, the State Election Commission has directed all deputy commissioners to initiate the process of appointing returning officers and assistant returning officers, **reports Santoshkumar B.**

Recently, RDPR minister Eshwar B Khandre indicated the SEC might publish the election schedule by mid-Dec.

According to sources, the SEC has completed an audit of ballot boxes available across the state and found that boxes valued at over Rs 80 crore were in good condition for reuse. However, the state govt recently released Rs 125 crore to the commission to procure additional ballot boxes and other materials required to conduct the elections using ballot papers.

▶Arrange training, P 4

Israeli prez gives Bibi challenger Eisenkot first chance to form govt

Israeli President Isaac Herzog has officially given opposition leader Gadi Eisenkot the first chance to form the next govt. After the formal announcement on Sunday, Eisenkot, who ran as prime minister Benjamin Netanyahu's main rival, now has to launch complicated negotiations with potential coalition partners.

He has 6 weeks to form a govt that accounts for the majority of 120 seats. Failure would mean the task likely reverts to Netanyahu, who for now governs in a caretaker capacity.

The Oct 27 elections gave neither Netanyahu's bloc (53) nor Eisenkot (48) a clear majority. Among the kingmakers — and most politically fraught potential allies — are the Arab-led parties who made historic gains in the election and have been a target of Netanyahu.

Eisenkot said he was open to Netanyahu and one of his far-right allies joining but under him as the new leader. "If members of Likud and the Religious Zionist Party truly believe this is a time for unity, as they told the president, I cannot conceive of any reason why they would not support a govt under my leadership and the principles I have presented," Eisenkot said. AGENCIES

President Isaac Herzog (R) with Yashar ('Straight') Party leader Gadi Eisenkot at the President's Residence in Jerusalem on Sunday

▶Coalition challenges, P 10

First since 2017: Muhurat trading ends in the red

For the second time in 10 years, Sensex and Nifty closed lower during the special hour-long Diwali Muhurat trading session marking the start of Samvat 2083, their first negative close in the session since 2017. Sensex opened higher at 81,299 points and touched a high of 81,442 points. Finally, it settled at 80,999 points, down 29 points on the day.

Nifty also followed a similar trajectory and closed 44 points lower at 24,986 points. Profit-booking followed a 7-session rally of over 10% that took the indices to multi-month high levels. However, BSE's midcap and smallcap indices gained 0.5% and 1.5%, respectively, amid buying in smaller stocks. TNN

▶ FULL COVERAGE: PAGE 9

Far-right wingnuts storm Diwali fest in Seattle after lights go out on MAGA

Chidanand Rajghatta | TNN

Washington: A celebration of light, colour, diversity, and religious pluralism in Seattle turned into a brief demonstration of America's darker side when two far-right activists gate-crashed the festivities carrying placards demanding the deportation of "dot heads" and warning of a "Hindu takeover of Christian America".

Jake Lang and Thomas Allen apparently didn't get the memo that Diwali is a celebration of the triumph of good over evil. They turned up at a local Diwali celebration with American flags determined to underscore the evil part. They were eventually escorted out of the Seattle Center Armory after a scuffle, but not before Lang, who seems to have a particular talent for turning provocation into publicity, claimed that he and Allen had been assaulted by "Antifa and Hindus", while blaming Hindus for the Republicans' electoral disaster in Texas.

"Hindus flipped Texas blue. F**k them," he complained, planting the idea in some heads that they should now be celebrating Krishna Jayanti in Texas.

Congresswoman Pramila Jayapal, whose Congressional district includes Seattle, condemned the disruption, saying she is beyond disgusted by this vile and racist display.

The demonstrators blamed Hindus for Republicans' poll loss in Texas

▶Broader campaign, P 10

CM: Ethanol probe covered blending units; findings today

Bengaluru: CM DK Shivakumar Sunday asserted that investigations into excessive ethanol blending — which found more than 30% against the prescribed 20% — at fuel stations in the state were comprehensive and covered processing units where the fuel and the chemical are blended.

Stating that the Centre cannot shirk its responsibility as public safety is paramount, the CM said food and civil supplies minister Rizwan Arshad will release a detailed report on Monday with documentary evidence on how and where the blend is done.

"It is not right to increase the blending ratio just to profit from ethanol available at a lower cost. The govt has taken the issue seriously," he said, adding information has been shared with the Union govt.

BJP state chief BY Vijayendra challenged the state govt to disclose the standards it followed while testing petrol samples for ethanol blending. TNN

OMCs run campaigns to deny E31 charge

Oil-marketing companies launched a social-media campaign Sunday to counter Congress govt's E31 findings. While IOC ran testimonies of dealers suggesting no complaints had come to them on E20 fuel, HPCL took customer feedback and put it on its social media handles. BPCL put up pictures of live testing results of E20 pump. **P 4**

▶ Oppn raises doubts, P 4

DKS & Hassan DC deny HDK's bribery allegations

Hassan: After Bidadi land row and sting op, Union minister **HD Kumaraswamy** Sunday alleged large-scale irregularities in the Hassan deputy commissioner's office in granting permission for stone-quarrying and land-conversion activities in the district.

Speaking to reporters after visiting Hasanamba temple here, the minister accused officials in the DC's office and a middleman of demanding lakhs of rupees in bribes. He released WhatsApp chat records allegedly exchanged between deputy commissioner **KS Latha Kumari**'s staff and a middleman.

Chief minister DK Shivakumar defended the DC and said JD(S) leaders were making allegations as she did not string along with them.

The DC dismissed the allegations as "completely false" and said she would file a complaint with the cyberpolice seeking investigation into attempts to damage an individual's reputation through false information.

The minister alleged bribes were demanded for granting permission to three stone-crushers in the district and land conversion for a residential layout in Sakleshpur. He further alleged Rs 75 lakh was paid to Hassan district minister KM Shivalingegowda through a KAS officer to prevent the transfer of the DC. TNN

▶ DC seeks probe, P 4

Grindstone murders: Two more bodies found in Mys

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru/Mysuru: Police probing the Rajajinagar grindstone murders allegedly committed by cab driver Indushekhar recovered two more bodies from Chamundi Hills in Mysuru on Sunday. The bodies are suspected to be those of Shivakumar and his wife Divya, taking the total number of bodies recovered in the case to five.

Shivakumar was the elder brother of Sunitha, wife of prime accused Indushekhar. The couple's bodies were found near a guesthouse along Chamundi Hills road, 2km from Tavarekatte. Cops suspect the bodies of the remaining two victims were dumped in Charmadi Ghat, near Mangaluru. A team is expected to reach the area by Monday to search for them.

Police brought Indushekhar to the spot on Sunday afternoon after he reportedly disclosed where he had disposed of the bodies. One body was found caught between trees, while the other was in a gorge. They were retrieved with help of police and forest officials and subsequently taken to Bengaluru after the mahazar.

▶Indushekhar's brother faced murder charges, died in jail, P 3

▶ DNA reports awaited, P 3

First foreign astronaut on China's Tiangong station will be from Pak

Chethan.Kumar
@timesofindia.com

Bengaluru: China has confirmed a Pakistani astronaut will become the first foreign national to board its Tiangong space station, joining the Shenzhou-24 crewed mission as a payload specialist.

The astronaut will be selected from two Pakistani candidates — Muhammad Zeeshan Ali and Khurram Daud — who have undergone months of training in China. The China Manned Space Agency (CMSA), which announced the decision on Nov 7, has not named the candidate or specified a launch date.

The mission will mark the first joint crewed flight involving Chinese and foreign astronauts in the history of China's human spaceflight programme. **TOI** has been tracking the developments for several weeks. Both Chinese and Pakistani agencies did not respond to multiple queries sent since late Sept. The agreement between China and Pakistan was signed in Feb 2025.

SPACE FOR DEVELOPMENT

SHORTLISTED: Muhammad Zeeshan Ali and Khurram Daud of Pakistan who have undergone months of training; candidate or launch date not decided

WHAT IT MEANS
For China: Opportunity to show Tiangong can serve as an international platform for crewed missions as ISS approaches retirement
For Pakistan: Mission represents its entry into **human spaceflight**
For India: Work with space powers without becoming confined to geopolitical choices

WHY IT MATTERS
ISS, the world's only mature, multilateral space station, is approaching the end of its life. **Tiangong could become an alternative for nations seeking access to human spaceflight,** scientific experiments and operational experience in orbit

▶China eyes int'l role, P 7

PES UNIVERSITY | INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES & RESEARCH

INTRODUCING
MD & MS
PG MEDICAL PROGRAMS @ PESUIMSR

MD DOCTOR OF MEDICINE — 15 SPECIALTIES
- Anaesthesiology
- Anatomy
- Biochemistry
- Community Medicine
- Dermatology, Venereology & Leprosy
- Emergency Medicine
- Forensic Medicine
- General Medicine
- Microbiology
- Paediatrics
- Pathology
- Pharmacology
- Physiology
- Psychiatry
- Radio-Diagnosis

MS MASTER OF SURGERY — 5 SPECIALTIES
- General Surgery
- Obstetrics & Gynaecology
- Ophthalmology
- Orthopaedics
- Otorhinolaryngology (ENT)

PG MEDICAL ADMISSIONS 2026 OPEN
A+ NAAC

HIGHLIGHTS
- 1000+ bed University Hospital
- 400 bed super-speciality Hospital
- State of the art infrastructure
- Approved by UGC, NMC

#1 UNIVERSITY IN KARNATAKA — NEW UNIVERSITIES UNDER 5 YEARS (KSURF 2019)
MORE INFO & APPLY AT pes.edu/med
EC Campus, Bengaluru | medicine@pes.edu | 7411 814 900

Troubled Rivers: Toxic Water Across 14 Stretches

Vindhya.Pabolu@timesofindia.com

A state grappling with drought can ill afford to let its rivers become repositories for untreated sewage. Yet, Karnataka's latest water-quality assessment presents a troubling picture: at some monitoring points, pollution is severe enough to leave little or no oxygen in the water, while bacterial counts run into lakhs.

The Karnataka State Pollution Control Board's Aug 2026 assessment covers 66 monitoring locations across 14 identified polluted stretches. The readings show that pollution is not confined to a few prominent waterways but extends across multiple river stretches. Data for rivers beyond the Dakshina Pinakini and Arkavathi — two of the most affected rivers with high biochemical oxygen demand (BOD) and high faecal-coliform counts — also raise concern.

High (BOD) indicates that microorganisms need more oxygen to break down organic pollution, leaving less dissolved oxygen available for aquatic life. High faecal-coliform counts indicate contamination by faecal matter and warn of the possible presence of disease-causing pathogens.

Experts point out that with water already scarce, long-term plans to protect its quality should be as critical as securing its supply while framing policies.

HIGHEST BOD READING IN THE REPORT
Dakshina Pinakini (near Mugalur bridge)
78 mg/L
Biochemical oxygen demand (BOD)
Dissolved oxygen: Below detection limits

AI

ARKAVATHI: SHARP VARIATION ALONG THE RIVER

Monitoring point	BOD (mg/L)	Dissolved oxygen (mg/L)	Total coliform (MPN/100 ml)	Faecal coliform (MPN/100 ml)
Tippagondanahalli reservoir	16	7.8	1,350	170
Manchanabele reservoir	8	4.0	2,20,000	21,000
Downstream of Kanakapura town	54	2.3	1,70,000	40,000

Highest total coliform: 2.2 lakh MPN/100 ml At Manchanabele reservoir

Highest faecal coliform: 40,000 MPN/100 ml Downstream of Kanakapura town

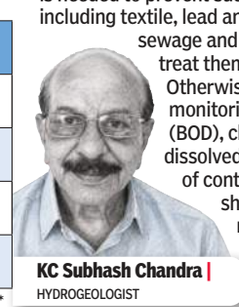
OTHER RIVERS WITH WORRYING READINGS

River and monitoring point	BOD (mg/L)	Dissolved oxygen (mg/L)	Total coliform (MPN/100 ml)	Faecal coliform (MPN/100 ml)	Class
Dakshina Pinakini, near Mugalur bridge	78	BDL	2,100	240	E
Shimsha, downstream of Yediyur highway bridge	6	5.9	1,600	280	D
Kagina, downstream of sewage disposal point	2.8	7.5	2,800	940	D
Lakshmanatirtha, downstream of Hunsur	4	5.5	3,300	450	D

BDL: Below detection limits. MPN: Most probable number.

Drains turned into sewage channels

Bengaluru's natural drains, or rajakaluves, have become conduits for sewage, with discharges from residential areas flowing into lakes. These flows are perennial, yet pollution levels went unexamined for years, while sewage treatment remained lacking. The problem extends beyond Bengaluru. Townships across Karnataka generate pollution through human activity. Industrial discharges into drains worsen the situation and risk groundwater contamination. Rules prohibit industrial pollution in natural drains and groundwater, but strict action is needed to prevent such discharges. Industries, including textile, lead and battery units, must keep sewage and effluents out of natural drains and treat them to tertiary, potable-level standards. Otherwise, pollution will continue. Regular monitoring of biochemical oxygen demand (BOD), chemical oxygen demand (COD) and dissolved oxygen (DO) can establish the extent of contamination. Recent fish deaths in lakes should serve as a warning. Sewage inflows reduce dissolved oxygen, while oxygen demand rises. Until discharges are stopped and treated, Bengaluru's lakes will remain vulnerable.

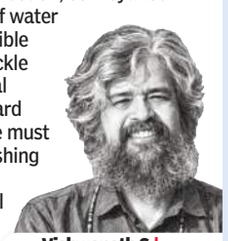


KC Subhash Chandra | HYDROGEOLOGIST

EXPERT SPEAK

Make polluters pay for clean rivers

Industrial pollution must also be stopped through effluent treatment plants, ensuring no industrial discharge enters rivers. Domestic sewage is greater in volume, but industrial effluents have a greater impact. Filing cases is the least that can be done. Peenya industrial area, which pollutes the Arkavathi, doesn't have a single functional common effluent treatment plant of scale. We need a long-term plan and, until then, must recognise that rivers will remain polluted. The question is where the money will come from. The principle must be that polluters pay. Every household & apartment discharging sewage must pay for its collection, conveyance and treatment. Unless we get the pricing of water and wastewater right, institutions responsible for managing them won't have funds to tackle pollution and we'll keep repeating the ritual every year: a report flags pollution, the board issues notices, and pollution continues. We must address the root of the problem by establishing a system to collect the money needed to treat wastewater. That's a difficult political question because nobody wants to raise water prices or charge for sewage collection and treatment.



Vishwanath S | WATER CONSERVATION EXPERT

Funding issues, drains hamper cleaning efforts

Action plans have been prepared for all identified polluted river stretches in Karnataka, but gaps in sewage infrastructure, funding constraints and delays in coordination continue to hamper Karnataka State Pollution Control Board's (KSPCB) clean up efforts.

Untreated sewage is the primary source of river pollution, a senior official said. Restoring water quality requires sewage treatment plants (STPs) along rivers, but inadequate underground drainage networks remain a hurdle. "Laying pipes needs a large budget, and the state can't release funds all at once," the official said, adding that projects have to be taken up in phases, with priority given to cities like Bengaluru, Mysuru and Mangaluru.

The official was hopeful of completing works in the next two years. Coordination among around 270 urban local bodies and panchayats presents another challenge. Most STPs have to be established by these bodies, requiring clearances, budgets and permissions. While almost all cities have STPs, some have been discontinued. In Bengaluru, most identified polluted stretches are along the Arkavathi, while many of Karnataka's polluted stretches are near Belagavi, which has numerous riverbanks, the official said.

The board has also stepped up enforcement. It has filed around 40–42 criminal cases under the Water Act against polluters, the official said. Several of the cases are pending before district magistrate courts. Earlier, action largely involved fines, but the board is now pursuing criminal cases as well.

The KSPCB also conducts awareness programmes, particularly during festivals, urging people not to dump waste into rivers. Following National Green Tribunal and High Court orders, urban local bodies have received pollution-control funding more actively in recent years, though allocations are being made progressively.

WATER QUALITY CLASSES

Class B: Suitable for organised outdoor bathing

Class C: Drinking-water source after conventional treatment and disinfection

Class D: Propagation of wildlife and fisheries

Class E: Irrigation, industrial cooling and controlled waste disposal

*These classifications describe designated best uses, not a blanket guarantee that water is safe for all purposes.

KEY NUMBERS FROM THE REPORT

66 monitoring locations across 14 polluted river stretches

14 river stretches assessed.

40–42 criminal cases filed under the Water Act against polluters, according to a senior KSPCB official

Source: Karnataka State Pollution Control Board, (KSPCB) Water Quality Classification of Polluted River Stretches in Karnataka, Aug 2026. Other official data sourced from the KSPCB.

Concept: **Chethan Kumar**
Design: **Sadashiva P**

KSEAB to prepare state-level I PU exam papers for 2027

Bengaluru: Question papers for the I PU annual examination — scheduled for 2027 — will be prepared at the state level. An order has been issued by the school education department entrusting this responsibility to Karnataka School Examination and Assessment Board (KSEAB).

However, the board will not conduct the exam itself; it will continue to be held under the leadership of the department of school education (PU). A uniform exam timetable, applicable to all PU colleges across the state, will be prepared for the conduct of these exams. On the day of the exam, question papers will be transmitted to colleges in digital format. Only the practical exam for the first-year PU course will be conducted according to a timetable prepared at the district level. Although the question papers are prepared at the state level, evaluation will take place at the college level. The results will be published only after they have been reviewed and approved by the respective district deputy directors.

"This measure will enable the department to monitor the quality of education as early as I PU stage. Furthermore, it will pave the way for improving the pass percentage in the II PU exam," said school education minister Madhu Bangarappa. TNN

B'LURU GLOWS IN DEEPAVALI CHEER

Pics: Chethan Shivakumar, Muthu P

The city basked in festive spirit and colour Sunday as Bengalureans celebrated Deepavali. Families decked up their homes with rangoli and diyas, while Commercial Street and Brigade Road dazzled with fairy lights. By evening, Bengaluru's skyline came alive as fireworks burst into vibrant shades of green, gold and red

Suburban rail: European signal system for 2 lines to cost ₹1k-cr

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

While the project initially planned to use communications-based train control similar to Namma Metro's Pink and Blue lines, K-Ride confirmed in Aug that a different system would be used

Bengaluru: The planned European train control system (ETCS) for Bengaluru Suburban Transport Project (BSTP) will cost more than Rs 1,000 crore just for corridors 2 and 4.

Rail Infrastructure Development Company (Karnataka) Ltd (K-Ride), the implementing agency for the project, floated a tender for the first-of-its-kind signalling system in Bengaluru Saturday. While the project initially planned to use communications-based train control (CBTC) similar to Namma Metro's Pink and Blue Lines, K-Ride confirmed in Aug that a different system would be used. It also received approval for the implementation of ETCS Level-2 across all BSTP corridors, replacing the earlier CBTC proposal.

According to Bengaluru Integrated Rail Infrastructure Development Enterprise Ltd (Bi-Ride), a subsidiary of K-Ride, the system will cost Rs 1,017 crore, excluding GST and customs duty on materials. The same ETCS is planned to be used for India's first high-speed rail project between Mumbai and Ahmedabad. The system is expected to boost safety by providing real-time data and monitoring of train movements.

According to a senior K-Ride official, it is designed to minimise land acquisition, save costs, eliminate traffic congestion, improve mobility, and address water stagnation issues while enabling safer and more efficient connectivity. Corridor 2, also named Mallige Line, will cover Byappanahalli Terminal to Chikkabanavara, a distance of 25km, and the installation of the signalling system is expected to be completed within 21 months of the selection of the bidder. Corridor 4, known as Kanaka Line, from Heelalige to Rajanukunte, is significantly longer, about 46km. From the date of selection of the bidder, the signalling system is expected to be ready within 30 months, officials said.

The Integral Coach Factory (ICF) in Chennai will manufacture and supply 51 trains, each comprising three coaches for the project. A total of four trainsets will be delivered by the 2027-28 financial year and by 2028-29. The trains will run with a maximum operational speed of 80kmph and will be fully made out of stainless steel. At a time, 350 passengers can travel across the three coaches.

BJP, Cong netas clash over credit for Metro

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: Ahead of the inauguration of Namma Metro's Pink Line this week, the ruling Congress and opposition BJP have once again crossed swords over who deserves credit for the city's crucial transport project.

File image of BJP MP Tejasvi Surya with Namma Metro officials

On Sunday, Bangalore South MP and BJP leader Tejasvi Surya claimed that the Union govt had taken Metro connectivity in the city from just 7km in 2014 to over 100km in 2026. He also alleged that Karnataka's Congress-led govt had perfected the art of delay, hypocrisy and misplaced priorities. "Across all approved phases of Bengaluru Metro — phase 1, 2, 2A & 2B, and 3 — the Union govt has committed Rs 41,557 crore towards construction. Karnataka govt's committed contribution stands at Rs 36,332 crore," Surya said.

According to the MoU, Bengaluru Metro follows a funding model which includes contributions from the Centre and state, along with soft loans from international bilateral and multilateral agencies. "These loans are secured directly by BMRCL and carry the sovereign guarantee of the central govt... The state govt cannot inspire confidence to secure such financing on its own because of its 'khali trunk.' It is the central govt's sovereign guarantee that makes these international loans possible," the MP added. He also accused the state of presiding over delays, extensions and cost escalations across infrastructure projects, while announcing car-centric projects.

Responding to Surya's allegations, former health minister and Gandhinagar MLA Dinesh Gundu Rao said the state bears 84% of the Metro project's cost. "Karnataka bears 84% of the cost of Namma Metro, while the Centre contributes a paltry 16%. You wouldn't know it from the way BJP talks about it," he stated on his X account. He added that while welcoming the Prime Minister for Pink Line's opening, credit should be given to Karnataka govt, its people, and the taxpayers for making it all possible.

Confirmed ticket, denied boarding: Court pulls up airline

Vindhya.Pabolu
@timesofindia.com

CONSUMER IS KING

Holding KLM guilty of deficiency in service, a consumer forum has ordered the airline to compensate the man who was denied boarding despite being assured that his ticket was valid

Bengaluru: Who wants to have their long-planned journey be thrown into uncertainty just hours before take-off, despite booking tickets months in advance? That is what a 68-year-old Bengaluru man faced when an airline refused to board him for his Calgary-bound flight, claiming his confirmed e-ticket was invalid. The fourth additional district consumer disputes redressal commission recently held the airline and its officials liable for deficiency in service.

The saga began when N Ramakrishna Ballal, an HAL II Stage resident, booked tickets for himself and his wife on Jan 29, 2023 for a Bengaluru-Canada trip, paying Rs 1.5 lakh per ticket. As his wife had an official trip, he decided to cancel her ticket and retain his own.

AI

On April 18, the airline's helpline assured him that the booking could be split and only his wife's ticket was cancelled. Following the advice, he received a refund of Rs 1.3 lakh after deductions. When his daughter later contacted the airline to update his meal preference, an agent blamed a technical glitch for the booking being inaccessible online but assured her that it remained active. Ballal subsequently received an e-ticket confirmation.

The assurance unravelled at the airport. Ballal arrived around 9.30pm on June 29 for his 1.10am flight, only to be told at check-in that his ticket was invalid because another passenger had already travelled against it. He was denied boarding.

With a family function awaiting him at his daughter's home, Ballal bought a fresh ticket for as much as Rs 1.8 lakh. He cancelled the original booking to avoid no-show charges, received a refund and booked a return ticket from Calgary. His total expenditure rose to Rs 2.3 lakh. A blood pressure patient, he endured an additional four hours of travel and missed the function.

Correspondence refused

Ballal filed a grievance on July 3 and sent seven emails, alleging contradictory responses. The airline first said on July 24 that his wife's refund request had cancelled all segments, later blamed him while admitting a colleague had given incorrect information, and eventually closed the grievance, refusing further correspondence.

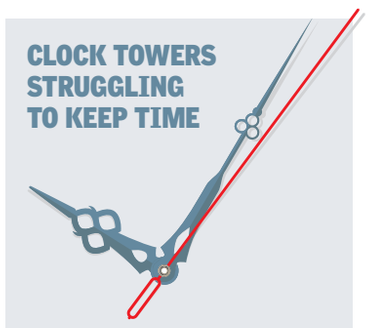
Ballal approached the consumer commission on March 18, 2025, alleging deficiency in service. The station manager of Air France-KLM at Kempegowda International Airport contested the case through counsel. KLM's corporate office in the Netherlands did not appear despite notice and was placed ex parte. In their defence, they argued that Ballal himself had cancelled both tickets. They said the system automatically deleted his booking once it was cancelled, which was explained in an email, and that both tickets had been refunded as voluntary cancellations.

The commission observed that at the time of the split, the airline had assured Ballal his ticket was confirmed, never told him it was cancelled, and refunded only his wife's ticket. It said that the contention that he cancelled both tickets was an attempt to escape liability, and that a service provider must rectify mistakes in its records and cannot make its customer suffer.

The commission, comprising president Ramachandra MS and members Nandini H Kumbhar and Savitha Airani, directed the airline to refund Rs 1.2 lakh with 6% annual interest from the date of filing till realisation. It further ordered the airline to pay Rs 20,000 for deficiency in service and mental agony and Rs 10,000 as litigation costs.

Not just restoration, clock towers need caretakers to keep ticking

Mysuru's Dufferin clock tower is ticking again after repairs, but Dharwad's silent heritage clocks are not working despite earlier restoration efforts. Karnataka needs trained maintenance staff for regular upkeep again of its heritage clocks



CLOCK TOWERS STRUGGLING TO KEEP TIME

1 **Silver Jubilee clock tower, Mysuru:** Built in 1927; 75 feet tall. Its 920-kg French-made bell has remained silent for decades

2 **Karnatak University Vidyasoudha, Dharwad:** Installed in 1960s and restored in 2021; only three of its four clock faces are functioning

3 **Karnatak College, Dharwad:** British-era mechanical clock restored in Sept 2020; subsequently stopped functioning

4 **Karnataka Central Cooperative Bank, Dharwad:** Built between 1954 and 1956; popularly known as Gadiyara Bank. Its clock is no longer functional

5 **Murugha Mutt, Dharwad:** Clock has remained defunct for years

6 **Dakshina Bharat Hindi Prachar Sabha, Dharwad:** Clock is non-functional

Shrinivasa M, Aravind HM, Vinobha KT & Gururaj Jamkhandi | TNN

Inside Mysuru's Dufferin clock tower, horologist Shaik Mahmood had to stand on his toes to repair the clock. Bent over a mechanism that has measured time for generations, the 63-year-old carefully worked on its ageing components, with barely enough space to move his hands. "I had to stand on my toes while working. There was no space to move," he said.

For Mahmood, restoring the historic clock, about to turn 140 years old on Dec 1, was as much about understanding the craftsmanship of its makers as it was about repairing worn-out parts. Some components are no longer manufactured and had to be specially fabricated for the 200 kg clock. Mahmood, who started in mid-July, finished the repair work in the first week of Sept and the clock tower was a major attraction during this Dasara.

The restoration has brought the clock back to life but keeping it running is a different challenge. The experience of heritage clock towers across Karnataka shows that the real test begins after the repair work is completed. Especially, as restoration can restart a clock, but only sustained maintenance can keep it running.

CLOCKMAKER WHO GOT OLD CLOCK TO LIFE

For Mahmood, repairing was not merely about replacing a faulty clock component. It involved understanding the engineering and craftsmanship that went into its making. He said the makers of the turret clock, also known as Chikka Gadiyra, had remarkable foresight. "The people who made this clock seem to have designed it with a vision of 500 years. The materials used, including cast iron and brass, are of very high quality," the horologist said.

Inaugurated by Maharaja Chamaraja Wadiyar on Dec 1, 1886, the turret clock tower commemorates the visit of the British Viceroy, Lord Dufferin, to the princely state of Mysuru.

Photo: **SR Madhusudhan**

ACTION MAN: Horologist Shaik Mahmood inside Dufferin clock tower

Its custodian, Mysuru City Corporation, tasked HMT to restore the clock. "I was approached by HMT officials to restore this clock," Mahmood explained.

Over the years, his reputation has brought him clocks and watches from different parts of India and even abroad. People approach him with old, complicated, and often delicate timepieces that require specialised repair and restoration. A native of Chikkaballapura, Mahmood studied up to PU and developed an interest in clocks and watches at an early age. "My father served in the Indian Air Force. Some of my uncles were involved in the watch and clock business, and I developed an interest in clocks and watches because of them," he said.

TIMES *Special*

After the restoration, the clock requires regular attention as it has to be wound once every four days. Mahmood has trained a local person to carry out this task. However, another iconic Mysuru clock tower, 75-foot-tall Silver Jubilee clock tower, is struggling as its 920kg French-made bell has remained silent for decades due to rusted iron supports and structural wear. Also known as Dodda Gadiyara, it has faced structural concerns, including cracks near the bell arch and upper canopy areas, largely tied to aging construction materials, rusting iron elements, and past vibrations. This tower, built by public contribution in 1927 near the palace, was a display of people's love and gratitude for Mysore ruler Nalwadi Krishnaraja Wadiyar. "I used to wake up in the morning listening to the chime from the clock when I resided in Agrahara," recalled nonagenarian Mysuru historian P V Nanjaraj Urs.

WHEN CLOCKS STOP AGAIN AFTER RESTORATION

Dharwad's six heritage clock towers, perched atop colleges, a university, a bank, a mutt, the railway station and Dakshina Bharat Hindi Prachar Sabha premises, are now mostly frozen in time.

Only the clock at Dharwad railway station is fully operational today. The remaining five have either stopped functioning or are only partially operational.

The repeated failures of Karnatak College clock, last restored in Sept 2020, and the west-facing dial at Karnatak University Vidyasoudha last restored in Aug 2021, point to a larger problem: restoration is ineffective without long-term maintenance. Although expert technicians revived these mechanisms, the absence of sustained upkeep has rendered some of the clocks inoperative once again.

Karnatak University vice-chancellor AM Khan said the varsity has a workshop where personnel have been trained in maintaining the clocks. "Three of the four clock faces are working, while the fourth is not operational. During restoration, missing gears, counterweights, chains, bushes and other parts had to be specially fabricated or repaired through welding because the original components are no longer manufactured. These challenges have made regular maintenance difficult," he said.

Experts at South Western Railway (SWR) say weather exposure also takes a toll. Heavy monsoon rains, humidity and temperature fluctuations in Dharwad cause rusting of chains and shafts, moisture damage to gears and bushes, and misalignment of moving parts. The university clock, mounted seven storeys above ground, is especially vulnerable.

Another major issue is the absence of a dedicated clock caretaker or horologist. After the voluntary restoration by SWR Workshop technicians, maintenance responsibility shifted to the institutions, but no specialised technician seems to have been appointed. Bird infestation, dust accumulation, and possible electrical failures in the automatic winding and chiming system also contribute to the clocks falling silent. Most importantly, restoration received one-time funding, but no regular budget was earmarked for continued maintenance, leaving these iconic heritage timekeepers neglected once again.

For now, the survival of these public timekeepers depends less on the age of their mechanisms than on whether someone is responsible for looking after them. Restoration may bring a clock back to life, but only regular maintenance can keep it ticking.

A FAMILY KEEPS TIME IN MANGALURU SINCE 1930s

Mangaluru's original clock tower was a gift of horologist M Vaman Nayak, proprietor of Vaman Nayak and Sons, to the city. He built a 45-foot-tall clock tower in 1968 by raising funds from businessmen and its clock featured a six-foot-circumference dial.

Mangaluru City Corporation demolished the structure in 1994, but the landmark eventually returned to the city. In 2018, Mangaluru Smart City Limited decided to construct a new clock tower at the same location. The new clock tower, 76 feet tall, has analogue clocks, measuring two metres in diameter, on all four sides. The RCC structure has laterite cladding and an 18-metre-high aluminum ladder. The clocks are equipped with proximity sensors and an electronic control system developed by Vaman Nayak's family business, Nayaks Times.

The iconic clock tower is maintained by M Satish Chandra Nayak, 73, and his son M Siddanth Nayak, 32, who runs the family's clockmaking business, Nayaks Times, in Mangaluru.

Photo: **Ravi Posavanike**

CLOCK MEN: M Satish Chandra Nayak and son M Siddanth Nayak preserve the legacy

Maintaining the old tower clock cost the civic body around Rs 3,000 a month in the 1990s. The new clock, however, comes without maintenance costs for the corporation, with Nayaks Times providing a free service, Siddanth said. "The first clock industry was set up by my father, M Vaman Nayak, at Jeppu in the 1930s, and Nayaks Clock Factory was and still is a household name. It was formally inaugurated by the then chief minister of Mysore state S Nijalingappa, on Jan 13, 1957. We are making an honest attempt to revive the old glory and delight of manufacturing and exhibiting world-class clocks," said Satish Chandra Nayak, a second-generation horologist.

Vaman Nayak, who learnt to repair watches in Bombay, returned to Mangaluru and established a manufacturing unit. In the early days, he made one clock a month, recalled his son Satish.

For Siddanth, the old clock tower is a reminder of a different era of clock maintenance. The weight-driven mechanism required weekly maintenance, including winding the clock and pulling its weights. Nayaks Times installed 25 tower clocks across Karnataka, including at Mangalore University, Basaveshwara Circle in Koppala, Cubbon Park in Bengaluru, Yelahanka and Ambedkar Stadium in Bengaluru. The company also made six Gandaberunda clocks placed inside Vidhana Soudha in Bengaluru.

HC: ED can't initiate PMLA proceedings through pvt plaints

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

'NOT A SUPER COP'

Bengaluru: The Karnataka high court has ruled that the enforcement directorate (ED) cannot initiate money laundering proceedings by filing a private complaint under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA). It held that the agency cannot assume the role of a "super cop" when no predicate offence has been registered by the investigating authority.

Justice M I Arun observed, in an order passed on Nov 6, that allowing the ED to file a private complaint when the concerned govt agency has chosen not to initiate criminal proceedings would effectively give it powers beyond those envisaged under the law. "If the ED is permitted to file a private complaint, it would be in a position to file such complaints against any person on its own and initiate an investigation against them. This is not contemplated under the provisions of the PMLA," the judge observed.

The court made these observations while quashing proceedings against K Y Nanje Gowda, MLA from Malur and chairperson of the Land Grant Committee in Malur, Kolar district, and others. In the job scam case, the ED had conducted searches during which it reportedly found several documents relating to recruitments in KOMUL, the milk-producing district cooperative union.

Based on these documents, a separate complaint concerning the alleged recruitment scam was registered. The ED's proceedings were challenged through separate petitions.

The court observed that allowing the ED to proceed in such circumstances would amount to presuming that the Lokayukta police or the concerned investigating agency had failed in its duty by not initiating criminal proceedings against the accused despite receiving information from the ED. This would place the ED on a higher pedestal, a position not envisaged by law.

The scheme of PMLA, the judge noted, contemplates that prosecution for the predicate offence must be initiated by the respective prosecuting agency or a third party, and not by the ED or authorities constituted under the PMLA.

High court quashes proceedings

Consequently, the court quashed the proceedings arising out of the private complaint against Nanje Gowda, K N Gopal Murthy and C Raju Krishna. It quashed the Enforcement Case Information Report (ECIR) against Y B Ashwathnarayan and C Raju Krishna. It also directed the ED to return the articles seized from Ashwathnarayan.

Grindstone murders: Cops await DNA confirmation

Madhusudhan SR

UNRAVELLING CLUES: A special team of Bengaluru police investigating the seven murders allegedly committed by Indushekhar recovered two more bodies near a guest house on Chamundi Hills Road on Sunday

▶Continued from page 1

Deputy commissioner of police (North) BS Nemagoud confirmed the recovery of the two bodies. Police will conduct postmortem examinations and DNA tests to establish the identities of the victims.

The latest recovery follows the discovery of three other bodies over the past two days.

On Friday, police recovered the body of seven-year-old Puneeth from Nandi Hills.

On Saturday, the bodies of Indushekhar's wife Sunitha and her mother Rupavathi were found in forest areas of Salem district in Tamil Nadu.

Police further said after completing necessary legal formalities, police will proceed with spot mahazars at various locations before recording Indushekhar's detailed statements.

CM to review BDA projects; property regularisation fee cut

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: Bangalore Development Authority (BDA) is set to place a range of citizen-centric initiatives and major infrastructure projects before chief minister DK Shivakumar at a review meeting Monday, with decisions expected on property regularisation, pending sale deed registrations and key urban development works.

Under Section 38(D) of Bangalore Development Authority Act, 1976, eligible occupants of houses constructed before July 10, 2008, on BDA-acquired land can seek regularisation through re-allotment, subject to prescribed conditions. The provision applies to properties on land covered by a final acquisition notification and an approved acquisition award.

As part of the proposed relief, BDA has indicated a 50% reduction in charges linked to the prevailing guidance value fixed by the revenue department. The 50% reduction, however, does not apply to corner sites, for which the earlier applicable rates continue.

The application window is proposed to remain open until Dec 17. BDA is also expected to introduce a fully computerised online application process. Applicants will have to upload supporting documents, including sale deeds, encumbrance certificates, khata records, property tax receipts, approved building plans and proof of residence.

However, the benefit would not extend to properties situated on land reserved for parks, playgrounds, civic amenities and open spaces, or land required for roads, Ring Road alignments and mass rapid transit projects. Properties on stormwater drains, lakes and riverbeds, beneath high-tension power lines and other specified categories are also excluded.

Sale deed mela

Another proposal expected to be taken up is an Absolute Sale Deed Mela to help nearly 20,000 BDA site allottees, who have not completed registration of their absolute sale deeds despite the expiry of their 10-year lease periods.

BDA has proposed inviting applications from such allottees by Dec 17 and facilitating registration within 60 days of receiving them, subject to applicable rules. The mela is expected to be organised after the application process, with details of the arrangements to be announced separately.

The authority is also proposing an application-based process for allotment of marginal land, comprising small parcels of BDA-owned land adjoining the sides or rear of already allotted sites. Eligible allottees can apply. BDA aims to complete the allotment process within 60 days of receiving applications.

Hebbal-Mehkri corridor, PRR phase 2 and skydeck on agenda

TOI

The elevated corridor, linking UAS Quarters & Mehkri Circle, may be ready in 18 months

The review meeting will also cover the proposed 2.2km twin tunnels between Hebbal junction and Veterinary College; a 1.8km elevated corridor connecting UAS Quarters and Mehkri Circle; and the proposed 2.3km Goraguntepalya underpass to connect NSIT Bengaluru and BEL Circle. The proposal is at the preliminary evaluation stage, and its integration with Metro Phase 3 infrastructure is also under review.

Other projects on the agenda include Peripheral Ring Road - 2; six proposed residential layouts along the corridor; 250m Bengaluru skydeck (to come up on 57 acres); and 12 ongoing BDA housing projects.

Third suspect held in elderly woman's murder case

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: Byatarayanapura police have arrested a third suspect in the murder of Venkatalakshmamma, 65, who was found dead at her residence in Hosaguddadahalli last month.

Earlier, two key suspects — Kantharaju and Manjappa, both relatives of the victim — were apprehended. According to investigators, the third accused, unnamed pending legal formalities, stood guard outside the residence while Kantharaju and Manjappa carried out the attack inside.

Victim owned multiple real estate assets

Venkatalakshmamma lived alone following the deaths of her husband and daughter. She owned multiple real estate assets, including four houses in Hosaguddadahalli and various land parcels across RR Nagar and nearby localities.

On the day of the crime, the assailants allegedly entered her residence under the guise of an argument over property rights.

The confrontation escalated, leading the suspects to assault her with wooden sticks, inflicting fatal injuries to her head and neck.

They then broke open a storage cupboard inside the house to steal gold jewellery and valuables before fleeing.

Boy forced to send voice messages to conceal parents' murder: Police

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: For five days after his parents went missing, the 10-year-old son of the murdered couple Shankar and Nalini was made to tell relatives and family friends that they were away on a pilgrimage and later on a three-month North India tour.

The messages were not his own. Police said the boy told them that alleged killer Indushekhar dictated what he should say and made him record voice messages using mobile phones belonging to his parents and others.

SERIAL KILLINGS

According to the boy's statement, his father went missing on a Saturday morning, and his mother was nowhere to be found by afternoon. Indushekhar came to pick him up that evening, saying they would go on a pilgrimage. Police said the child trusted Indushekhar because he was a familiar person and had ties with the family. The boy told them that Indushekhar did not allow him to speak directly to relatives. Instead, he handed him the phones and made him record voice messages. Initially, he was instructed to say his parents were at a temple and had handed their phones to people there.

"He told me to say they were going on a North India tour for three more months and no one should bother them," police quoted the boy as having said.

The child also recalled a foul smell inside Indushekhar's car during the period. The boy noticed two or three heavy gunny bags in the vehicle and asked the accused about the stench. Indushekhar allegedly dismissed his questions, saying there were waste materials in the back.

When he tried to look inside the bags, Indushekhar allegedly scolded him and warned him against going near them. Indushekhar later drove towards Nandi Hills and threw the sacks away.

Accused's brother faced murder charges in 2018; died in prison

Rajiv.Kalkod@timesofindia.com

Bengaluru: As investigators continue to uncover details surrounding the serial killings that have shaken Bengaluru, fresh links have emerged connecting the prime accused, S Indushekhar, to a troubling family history of high-profile crime.

Indushekhar is the younger brother of **S Ramesh**, a key figure named in a 2018 investigation that exposed a chilling murder tied to a major land scam. However, Ramesh died of illness as an undertrial prisoner in Bengaluru central prison.

What had happened?

On Sept 18, 2018, a security guard named Venkataswamy walked into Avalahalli police station in tears, reporting that his 40-year-old wife, Sudharani, had set herself on fire. Just seven hours after he arrived, police registered a murder case following a formal complaint from Sudharani's father, Muniyappa. By Sept 25, the investigation had uncovered the conspiracy: Sudharani's death was directly linked to a multi-crore land scam.

The masterminds behind the plot were realtor S Ramesh and his associates Shankarappa, S Krishnamurthy, and M Keshavamurthy. Ramesh had identified a lucrative plot of land in Belathur valued at around Rs 12 to 15 crore. The land belonged to a man named Nanjappa, whose whereabouts were unknown. To seize the property, the group enlisted a stamp vendor to forge ownership documents. They recruited a 90-year-old man named Venkataramanappa to impersonate Nanjappa at the Banaswadi sub-registrar's office and executed a fake will in Ramesh's name.

The gang struck a deal with a physician, who agreed to issue a fake death certificate under Nanjappa's name once presented with a corpse. To secure a body, the conspirators targeted an elderly man named Krishnappa at a bus stop in Kolar. They lured him to Bengaluru under the pretext of offering him a higher-paying job. On Sept 14, they administered a fatal overdose of medication to him, causing severe gastroenteritis that killed him the following day.

The gang then hired Venkataswamy to take the victim's ashes to Srirangapatna and perform the final rites for a financial payout. Suspicious of the secret ritual, Sudharani repeatedly questioned her husband until Venkataswamy confessed the entire murder plot to her. Fearing exposure, Venkataswamy informed Ramesh and the gang, leading to Sudharani's murder.

More monsoon rain for hinterland

Warming Temp Shifts Showers From Western Ghats To Interior K'taka, Finds Study

Niranjan.Kaggere
@timesofindia.com

Bengaluru: Changing climatic conditions in the peninsular region appear to be producing an unexpected beneficiary in Karnataka's hinterland, where shifting monsoon patterns over the years are bringing more rain to agricultural regions in the interior.

Contrary to the 10-15% decline in rainfall in coastal Karnataka and the western slopes of the ghats, both northern and southern interior districts are receiving an additional 100-200 mm of monsoon rainfall, according to a recent study by agrometeorologists from Bengaluru.

An analysis of rainfall data from 1901 to 2020, along with projected rainfall patterns up to 2035, by a group led by Prof MB Rajegowda, former professor of agrometeorology at the University of Agricultural Sciences (UAS), GKVK, Bengaluru, has revealed a dramatic redistribution of monsoon showers in the state. The researchers believe this could reshape Karnataka's agricultural landscape in the coming decades, with the Western Ghats acting as a crucial trigger for shifting patterns.

> Rising temperatures over the land and in the atmosphere cause clouds blocked along the western slopes to expand, lose density and rise higher. Subsequent cloud formations push them towards the eastern side of the ghats, allowing rain-bearing clouds to cross the mountain range and reach interior regions
> **MB Rajegowda** | FORMER PROFESSOR, UAS, GKVK

Releasing the study report in Bengaluru, Rajegowda said Karnataka's average annual rainfall increased from 1,140mm during 1900-1950 to 1,218 mm during 1980-2000, while the mercury levels went up by an average of 1.5 degrees Celsius. "The gain in rainfall has come at the expense of the coastal and Western Ghat regions. These areas have recorded a 10-15% decline in annual rainfall, while the interior districts have witnessed a significant rise in monsoon precipitation," Rajegowda explained.

Other climatic events like cyclones also contributed to the increased rainfall and its redistribution.

The study attributes the gradual shift to the changing movement of moisture-laden monsoon clouds across the Western Ghats. "Nearly 75% of the clouds originating over the Indian Ocean and entering the western coast through the Arabian Sea release their moisture over the coastal belt and the western slopes of the ghats. The remaining 25% cross the mountain range and move towards the plains in the hinterland," the study stated.

Rajegowda said, "Rising temperatures over the land and in the atmosphere cause clouds blocked along the western slopes to expand, lose density and rise higher. Subsequent cloud formations push them towards the eastern side of the ghats, allowing more rain-bearing clouds to cross the mountain range and reach the interior regions." This is driven by an uneven rise in temperature.

Incidentally, the changing rainfall pattern has coincided with a considerable expansion of the state's agricultural and horticultural sectors. "The area under agriculture has nearly doubled, increasing from 50-60 lakh hectares in the 1950s to 100-105 lakh hectares in 2020. Agricultural production surged from 40-50 million tonnes to 130-135 million tonnes during the same period," the study revealed. Following a similar trend, horticulture also witnessed a major expansion, with the area under cultivation reaching 22-24 lakh hectares and production touching 180-185 million tonnes in 2020.

Relying on various models projecting rainfall patterns up to 2035, the study found that the changing climatic conditions could bring another geographical twist. "Rainfall over the coastal belt and the western slopes of the ghats will continue to decline in the coming decades, while interior Karnataka could receive more monsoon showers. The state's average annual rainfall is projected to reach 1,235mm between 2020 and 2035, compared with 1,218mm during 1980-2020," the study highlighted.

Rajegowda also said there was no need to implement the recommendations of the Gadgil and Kasturirangan committees exactly as proposed or make them binding, particularly when the very regions studied by the committees were witnessing a gradual decline in rainfall.

Women outnumber men in 152 of state's 224 assembly seats

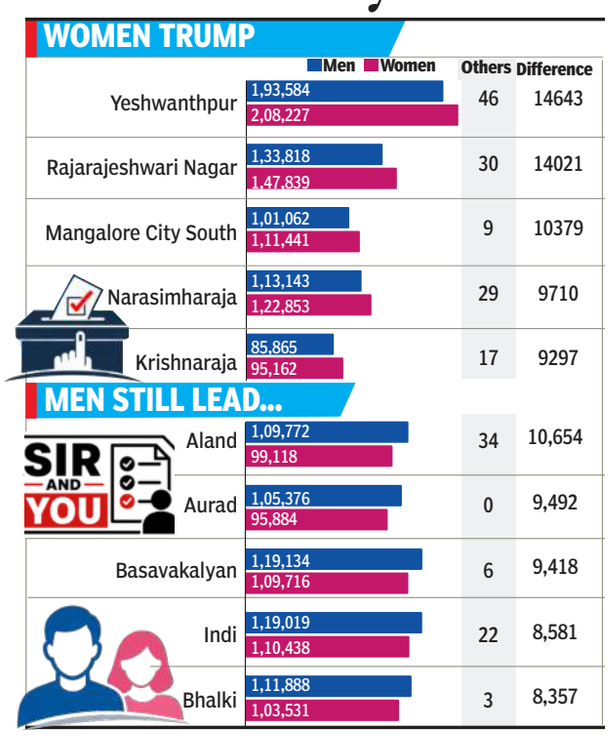
Pearl.DSouza@timesofindia.com

Bengaluru: Women outnumber men in Karnataka's electorate in 152 assembly constituencies, with the gender gap especially pronounced in Bengaluru, the final special intensive revision (SIR) electoral roll shows.

Only 72 of the total 224 constituencies have more male than female voters, most of them in north Karnataka, highlighting a regional divide in the state's electoral profile.

Yeshwanthpur (Bengaluru Urban) has the highest female voter advantage in the state, with 14,643 more women than men. Rajarajeshwarinagar (Bengaluru Central), follows with a gap of 14,021. Mangaluru City South in Dakshina Kannada has 10,379 more women voters, followed by Narasimharaja in Mysuru, where the difference is 9,710.

On the other side of the gender divide, Aland in Kalaburagi has the highest male voter advantage, with 10,654 more men than women. Aurad and Basavakalyan in Bidar follow with 9,492 and 9,418 more men respectively. Indi in Vijayapura has 8,581 more male voters.



Bidar and Haveri stand out, with all six assembly constituencies in each district having more male than female voters. In other districts, the gender balance varies across constituencies, with most having a female majority. The constituency-level pattern in southern Karnataka is also reflected in the child population, with districts in the region recording more female than male children, as per NFHS-5 data.

Brawl on road: Students clash over cigarette

Bengaluru: Chaos prevailed outside a private university campus near Chikkahadage Cross on Chandapura-Anekal main road when 10-15 college students were seen attacking each other outside the campus Saturday. Alerted by the public, police intervened and dispersed the youngsters. A video clip of the attack, incidentally recorded by one of the students, has gone viral on social media.

Police took some students to the station and obtained undertakings that they would not repeat the offence. "Considering their future, we decided against registering a case. We have warned them that criminal cases will be registered if they are involved in similar incidents ," an officer said. TNN

Ashoka accuses Congress of threatening Narayanaswamy

Bengaluru: Leader of opposition in the legislative assembly R Ashoka Sunday accused the Congress of exposing its "true face" by allegedly using goons to threaten Legislative Council Opposition Leader Chalavadi Narayanaswamy by sending machetes and knives to his residence. He demanded that police register an attempt-to-murder case and arrest those responsible.

The controversy follows Narayanaswamy's alleged remark at a public meeting in Kolar that BJP workers would cut Congress members into pieces and throw them into the Arabian Sea. After Congress workers protested, the issue escalated on Saturday when unidentified persons allegedly sent machetes and knives to his residence through an online delivery platform. Narayanaswamy alleged Congress workers or hired goons were behind the incident, claiming the parcels were sent through cash-on-delivery orders. TNN

Mekedatu project needs only cooperation, not TN nod: CM

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Hassan: Amid the ongoing Cauvery water-sharing dispute, with Cauvery Water Regulation Committee (CWRC) and Cauvery Water Management Authority (CWMA) asking the state to release 3,000 cusecs per day for the next 15 days, chief minister **DK Shivakumar** Sunday said the Mekedatu project does not require permission from Tamil Nadu, but only its cooperation.

Speaking to reporters after offering prayers at Hasanamba Temple, he responded to the Tamil Nadu chief minister Vijay's letter to the Union govt opposing the project. Tamil Nadu leaders appear unaware that the project would benefit their state more than Karnataka, he stated.

He clarified that Karnataka would use the water only for Bengaluru's drinking water requirements. "The project site is in my constituency, near the Hanur border. It is also designed to generate 400 MW of electricity," he said.

He added that 5,400 hectares of forest land would be submerged due to the dam construction and arrangements had already been made to provide alternative land. The CM said Supreme Court had already upheld Karnataka's rights over the project; only approval from the Union environment and forest authorities remained pending. He said he has held several discussions with the Union Jal Shakti ministry and will soon meet the Prime Minister. He also said Tamil Nadu's review petition had been rejected by the SC. Karnataka is committed to releasing 177 TMC of Cauvery water annually as directed, he pointed out.

Meanwhile, defending the increase in milk and curd prices, he said it was intended to support farmers and that prices in Karnataka remained lower than in other states.

Darshan delay: Devotees hurl slippers

Hassan: An unusual incident unfolded during chief minister DK Shivakumar's visit to Hasanamba temple with his wife Sunday afternoon.

Around noon, the CM performed special prayers inside the sanctum sanctorum, during which entry through the general darshan queue was temporarily halted. Thousands of devotees, many of them women, who had been waiting for hours, grew furious over the delay. Their anger intensified when visuals of Shivakumar inside the sanctum were telecast on a screen near the queue. Several women criticised the CM for making devotees wait, with some questioning why elected representatives should cause them hardship. "People elect a CM to protect their interests, not to cause them hardship," one woman said. In protest, a few devotees even removed their slippers and hurled them at the television screen. The incident has since gone viral on social media platforms. TNN

DC seeks thorough probe, action for those found guilty

▶ Continued from page 1

He urged the CM to order an investigation into the incident and demanded that the police seize mobile phones of the staff and middleman. CM said minister Shivalingegowda had expressed his frustration about the allegations and said the DC was impartial in her role.

In a Facebook post, the DC claimed she had never indulged in unauthorised activities and would never do so. "If any mistake has been committed by my PA or anyone in his section, then appropriate action will certainly be taken (against them)," she said. Latha Kumari said a thorough investigation should be conducted and those found guilty must face disciplinary action.

ALMANAC (9.11.2026)

Monday- Tula Masa 22 Shri Parabhava Nama Samvatsara – Dakshinayana – Sharath Ritu - Tithi: Ashwayuja Krishna Amavasya h. 12-32 Nakshatra: Svati h. 7-24 Yoga: Saubhagya h. 26-57 Karana: Naga h. 12-32.28 Jumadu'l awwal Kali Day 1872888 Govardhana Puja,
Rahu Kalam 7.30am-9am

— KL Vidya Shankara Somayaji

BJP to protest price hike at Freedom Park on Nov 11

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

SEEKING ROLLBACK

Bengaluru: BJP will stage a day-long protest at Freedom Park in Bengaluru on Nov 11, demanding the rollback of recent hikes in prices of milk, curd, ghee and bus tickets, party state president BY Vijayendra announced Sunday.

The protest will be held from 10am to 6pm, and will see the participation of BJP MLAs, MPs, MLCs and state office-bearers. The party will subsequently organise marches at district headquarters and protests in every assembly constituency, he said.

Accusing the Congress govt of repeatedly burdening people with price hikes, Vijayendra said its three-year tenure had seen increases in petrol and diesel taxes, liquor prices, water tariffs, wildlife safari tickets and fees for services at govt hospitals.

Questioning the recent hike, he said cost of milk has been increased by Rs 8 per litre, while various milk products have become costlier by Rs 12 to Rs 13. Ghee price has increased by Rs 180 per kg and curd by Rs 14, he claimed.

He said the govt should bear the additional Rs 7 per litre incentive paid to dairy farmers instead of transferring the burden to consumers. Vijayendra also criticised the bus fare hike, claiming commuters in some areas would face increases of 70-80%. He alleged that unpaid dues under the Shakti scheme had pushed transport corporations into financial distress, affecting bus services, particularly in rural areas. Questioning the govt's appeal to private companies to adopt 2,000 govt schools, he said dependence on corporate social responsibility funds reflected its failure to provide adequate resources for education and development.

OMCs run social media campaigns to rebut Karnataka ethanol tests

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: The oil marketing companies (OMCs), facing mounting criticism in Karnataka after tests conducted by the Congress-led state govt allegedly found ethanol content exceeding the prescribed E20 limit in petrol samples collected from select fuel stations, launched a social media campaign Sunday to counter the allegations.

While Indian Oil Corporation (IOCL) shared testimonials from its Karnataka dealers claiming they had received no complaints about E20 fuel, Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Ltd (HPCL) took to social media to showcase customer feedback. Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd (BPCL), meanwhile, went a step further by sharing photographs of on-the-spot tests conducted at its E20 retail outlets.

"A test conducted by BPCL's Sales Officer at Sree Siva Shankari Fuels, Tumkur, in the presence of customers recorded 19% ethanol in the petrol sample tested. Trust evidence. Share facts," read a post by BPCL Mysore.

Meanwhile, HPCL's Bengaluru zone said it was raising consumer awareness through live demonstrations. "True credibility is earned through open testing in front of our esteemed customers. Ethanol testing being shown to customers at HPCL Retail Outlet B R Mali, Jamkhandi. HP hain Jahan, Bharosa hain Wahan!" the OMC posted.

In Ballari, HPCL said it was educating consumers by highlighting the benefits of E20 fuel, its quality and compatibility.

Oppn raises doubts over testing labs

▶ Continued from page 1

Vijayendra asked the state govt to cooperate with oil-marketing companies in conducting joint tests to establish the facts.

He said Indian Oil, Bharat Petroleum and Hindustan Petroleum had issued clarifications following the state govt's claim that ethanol content in petrol samples tested in Karnataka was higher than the prescribed limit. The companies had reportedly tested samples at 700-800 fuel stations across the country but had not found problems alleged by the state govt, Vijayendra said.

Leader of the opposition, R Ashoka, wondered whether Karnataka had laboratories equipped to conduct high-quality tests and raised doubts over the reliability of the samples being examined.

"Nobody knows where the samples were collected from — govt godowns or petrol bunks. If they were collected from bunks, who can guarantee that additional ethanol was not mixed with the fuel?" he asked.

DCs asked to convene meetings, arrange poll-related training for appointed officials

▶ Continued from page 1

According to directions issued by the SEC Saturday, assistant commissioners or officers in equivalent rank will be appointed ROs for ZP constituencies, while tahsildars or officers in the same rank will handle TP constituencies.

The DCs have been asked to convene preliminary meetings and arrange election-related training for the appointed officers. They must also submit the list of ROs and AROs to the SEC by Nov 16 for approval.

For ZP elections, an officer of the rank of assistant commissioner or equivalent must be appointed RO for each taluk. In taluks with more than 10 ZP constituencies, two ROs may be appointed. Tahsildar-level officers or those of equivalent rank, excluding the concerned taluk tahsildar, should be appointed AROs.

Pic for representation

SEC DIRECTIVE

For TP elections, one tahsildar or an officer of equivalent rank must be appointed as RO for every 15 constituencies. A deputy tahsildar or an officer of equivalent rank should be appointed as ARO.

Officials selected for election duty, apart from ROs and AROs, should also have prior experience in conducting elections. The DCs have been directed to organise training for all election officials and staff. The commission has instructed DCs not to change officials assigned election duties without its prior approval. The lists of ROs and AROs will be notified after the commission approves the proposals submitted by the DCs

TIMES inter act

real estate

FOR SALE

BANGALORE

60X50FT PREMIUM A-KHATA SITE FOR SALE IN HOODI [3000sqft], Ideal for building your dream home or investment.Cont:+91 8861626688

jobs

SITUATION VACANT

MARKETING, ADVERTISING & SALES

SALES

VFM HONDA : 2W dealer requires SALES EXECUTIVES. Must have Min. 3 years exp in consumer goods sales, pleasing personality and communication skills and MS Office. CTS Rs. 360,000/-++ p.a. Apply to MANDEEP@VFM.GROUP

personal

CHANGE OF NAME

I, Shanmugam L @ Shanmugam Singarpet, S/o. P. S. Lingam, Residing at No. 35, 3rd Main, 8th Cross, Ganesha Block, Nandini Layout, Bengaluru - 560096, have changed my name to SHANMUGAM vide Affidavit dated 04.11.2026 sworn before notary Rajeshwari, Bengaluru.

CHANGE OF NAME

I, NITYA PREETHAM LULLA, residing at No. 1/3, Vandhana Gaikwad's Tranquil, Rachana 6-5-1/3, Pipe Line A Cross, Malleshwaram, Bangalore North, Bangalore – 560003, do hereby declare that I have sworn an affidavit before the Notary Public at Bangalore stating that in the Birth Certificate of my minor daughter JAANVI SACHDEV, born on 19/02/2012, registered under Registration No. SH1/B/2012/00405/002331, the mother's name was erroneously recorded as NITYA SACHDEV instead of NITYA PREETHAM LULLA. Hereafter, she shall be known and recognized as NITYA PREETHAM LULLA for all purposes.

I, Mrs. CHANDRIKA K. PILLAI, also known as Mrs. CHANDRIKA DEVI, born on 10.08.1952, W/o. Late N.S. Krishna Pillai, residing at No. 26, Karthikeya, 1st C Cross, Hennur Gardens, Near Hennur Bande, Kalyan Nagar Post, Bengaluru – 560043, Karnataka, hereby declare that Mrs. CHANDRIKA K. PILLAI and Mrs. CHANDRIKA DEVI refer to one and the same person, that is, myself. Henceforth, I shall be known, addressed and referred to as Mrs. CHANDRIKA DEVI for all purposes and in all records. This declaration is made vide affidavit dated 04.11.2026, sworn before Notary K. VENKATESHAN, Bengaluru.

I, LINGARAJ FAKIRAPPA YAVAGAL R/O Westend Heights, DLF Newtown, Bangalore-560068, have changed my name to LINGARAJ YAVAGAL for all future purposes.

Bennett & Coleman THE TIMES OF INDIA

Readers are recommended to make appropriate enquires and seek appropriate advice before sending money, incurring any expenses, acting on medical recommendations or entering into any commitment in relation to any advertisement published in this publication. All creatives marked as Advertorial, Spotlight and Promotional Features are to be treated as Advertisements. The Times of India Group doesn't vouch for any claims made by the Advertisers of the products and services. The Printer, Publisher, Editor, and the owners of The Times of India Group publications shall not be held liable for any consequences, in the event such claims are not honoured by the Advertisers.

TIMES TRIBUTE
PAYING HOMAGE TO THE DEPARTED SOUL
To book your ad | Logon to: ads.timesofindia.com or Call: 18001205474 (Toll Free) | Scan QR Code

IN REMEMBRANCE

SRI. M. BHOOMI REDDY
09.11.1931-22.08.2014

SMT AMMAYAMMA
08.12.2011

SRI. M. BHOOMI REDDY
CLASS I KPWD CONTRACTOR

Dharmadhikari of Sri Prasanna Someshwara Swamy Temple, Marathalli, Founder Trustee of Sri Rama Temple & Shiva Temple, New Thippasandra

Fondly remembered by : Family

TO BOOK AN OBITUARY AD
PLEASE CALL 18001205474 (Toll Free)
TO BOOK ONLINE LOG ON TO Ads.timesofindia.com
Scan QR Code

TIMES NATION

THE TIMES OF INDIA, BENGALURU | MONDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2026

'NOTEBANDI' DEVASTATED ECONOMY, 'VOTEBANDI' DESTROYING POLITY: CONG SLAMS PM MODI

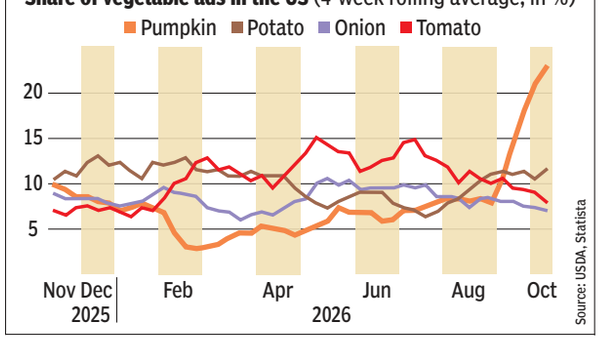
NCP MERGER APPEARS TO BE IN FINAL STAGES, ROLES OF VARIOUS LEADERS WOULD SOON BECOME CLEAR: SHIRSAT

STATOISTICS A slice of life in numbers

Halloween brings a pumpkin-sized ad rush in US

Advertising for pumpkin and squash surged around Halloween (Oct 31), together accounting for more than a fifth of vegetable ads tracked by the US dept od agriculture in mid-Oct 2026. Potatoes, onions and tomatoes remain amongst the other most advertised veggies yr-round

Share of vegetable ads in the US (4-week rolling average, in %)



Delhi celebrates Diwali under haze, AQI nears 'severe' mark

Air Smelling Of Smog & Cracker Smoke: Netizens

New Delhi: Despite restrictions, several parts of Delhi continued to witness cracker-bursting till late Sunday evening as people celebrated Diwali, with reports of fireworks emerging from areas including Pitampura, Burari, Mayur Vihar and the posh Lutyens' Delhi.

Ahead of Diwali, Delhi govt had appealed to people to comply with Supreme Court's directions on the sale and use of green firecrackers. District magistrate (East), in an order, permitted the bursting of green firecrackers only on Nov 7 and 8, between 6am and 7am and 8pm and 10pm.

Residents reported the use of firecrackers in outer Delhi's Pitampura and Burari, with the intensity particularly high in Burari. Similar reports came from Mayur Vihar, while people in the Bishambardas Marg area and Lutyens' Delhi said fireworks continued, although the intensity had reduced slightly as the day wore on.

A local reported cracker-bursting to be non-stop in the Jangpura area. Lound sounds were heard across sectors of Rohini till way past permissible time.

The city's air quality remained in the very poor category, with the instantaneous Air Quality Index (AQI) recorded at 371 at 7 pm, close to the severe threshold. The city's average AQI for the day settled at 376 in the 'very poor' category, compared to 369 on Saturday, amid a layer of smog and reduced visibility.

IANS

THE COST OF SPARKLE: The air quality in the national captial is forecast to turn 'severe' on Monday following Diwali celebration

The court prohibited bursting of firecrackers within 300 metres of hospitals, nursing homes, health centres, old-age homes, educational institutions and other notified silence zones.

Only CSIR-NEERI-certified green firecrackers were permitted for sale, with the administration directing that they be sold exclusively at locations designated by Delhi Police. The administration had also announced joint patrolling and enforcement teams comprising district officials and Delhi Police personnel to check unauthorised sale and use of prohibited firecrackers.

Meanwhile, Air Quality Early Warning System has forecast that Delhi's air quality is likely to slip into the 'severe' category from Nov 9 and remain there for the subsequent few days. AGENCIES

One child dead, 269 treated for burns in TN during festivities

Chennai: One child succumbed to burn injuries, and 269 people were treated for firecracker-related burns across Tamil Nadu during the Diwali festivities, according to official data tracking emergencies over a 24-hour window.

As per the official bulletin, the state 108 emergency ambulance network received 16,079 calls between 7 am on Nov 7 and 7 am on Nov 8. Of the total distress calls, 2,475 were related to accidents, 396 for minor injuries, and 98 specifically for burn injuries.

To manage the festive emergency load, 1,283 ambulances were deployed on active duty across the state.

Govt hospitals recorded a total of 1,387 inpatient admissions during this period. The admissions included 956 for accidents, 321 for minor injuries or assaults, and 110 for burn injuries. One burn-related fatality was recorded, involving a child under the age of 15. PTI

Firecrackers go off on bike, four injured in UP

Bahraich: Four youths were injured when firecrackers being transported on a two-wheeler exploded near Padma Market in Kotwali Nagar area late Saturday. One of them sustained serious injuries and was admitted, while the other three were discharged after preliminary treatment. Kotwali City SHO Brijendra Mishra said preliminary reports suggested that two youths were travelling with firecrackers when explosion occurred. Two others standing nearby were also injured. The exact cause of the explosion is yet to be confirmed. TNN

Lift operator dies in fire in Mum bldg

Mumbai: A 46-year-old lift operator, Dhanpat Mahatu, died of suffocation after a fire broke out in a 17th-floor flat of Runwal Elegante, a highrise residential complex in Andheri Lokhandwala, around 9.45pm Saturday, reports **Richa Pinto**.

The fire, confined to electric installations and household articles in C wing's flat no. 1701, was doused within an hour. Mahatu was rescued from the lobby and rushed to Cooper Hospital, where he was declared 'brought dead' at 3.54am.

Residents said Mahatu was helping people who had taken a lift though smoke was spreading in the building.

3 TMC workers arrested over unrest outside Abhishek's house

Kolkata: A day after vandalism and mob attacks at Trinamool MP **Abhishek Banerjee**'s house over his birthday celebrations, three Trinamool supporters were arrested on Sunday. Four FIRs have been registered in the case, and two of these were registered suo motu by Kolkata police.

While Abhishek has filed one FIR against BJP supporters, he has been named in an FIR lodged by a BJP worker. Among the two cases lodged by cops themselves, one pertains to the alleged slapping of police officers.

The three arrested were remanded to eight days' police custody. TNN

Parth meets Pawar Sr twice in two days as NCP netas seek to revive merger talks

Pune: Deputy CM Sunetra Pawar's elder son and Rajya Sabha member Parth Pawar Sunday met his granduncle and NCP (SP) chief Sharad Pawar for the second day at the latter's Mumbai residence amid renewed speculation that a disgruntled section of NCP was attempting to revive merger talks with the rival faction, **reports Alim Shaikh**.

Parth held discussions with the veteran leader for nearly two hours, fuelling speculation about a possible reunion of the two NCP factions. The two had a nearly two-hour meeting on Saturday also, followed by a separate meeting between Sharad Pawar and senior NCP (SP) leaders in the evening.

The second meeting, attended by Jayant Patil, Shashikant Shinde, Amol Kolhe, Anil Deshmukh and Jitendra Awhad, lasted nearly three hours. Most of these leaders were also involved in merger talks with late Ajit Pawar.

Parth Pawar & Sharad Pawar

After meeting Sharad Pawar, Kolhe and Awhad told reporters that there was no discussion about a merger and that the NCP (SP) leaders had met their party chief only to inquire about his health. Pawar was discharged from hospital Saturday. NCP national working president Praful Patel said he would meet Sharad Pawar after Nov 10 in Mumbai, adding to the buzz surrounding the proposed merger.

100 fall ill after eating pani puri & tikki from street vendor in UP

Lucknow: Nearly 100 people, including children, women and elderly residents, fell ill after allegedly consuming contaminated pani puri and tikki sold by a street vendor in UP's Siddharthnagar district.

The affected people complained of vomiting and diarrhoea within hours of consuming the food on Friday evening and were taken to Madhav Prasad Tripathi Medical College. Around 35 to 36 children were among those admitted, three of whom were initially critical but are now stable.

Dr Bilal Ahmed, posted in the medical college's emergency ward, said the exact cause of the food poisoning was yet to be established. Siddharthnagar CMO Sanjay Dohre visited the affected villages. TNN

Bursting crackers can cure several diseases: BJP MLA

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Kolkata: Days after CM Suvendu Adhikari issued a special message on bursting loud firecrackers during Kali Puja and Diwali celebrations, BJP's Tollygunge MLA Papia Adhikari claimed that bursting firecrackers can cure several diseases.

She had gone to inaugurate a Kali Puja in her constituency. As she began speaking, a firecracker went off loudly in front of her.

Continuing with her speech, she said, "You will see that bursting firecrackers will cure several diseases." "Our CM has said we will burst firecrackers. How can Kali Puja be complete without firecrackers? We will definitely burst crackers. However, we will follow the guidelines by the police," she said.

PTI

MLA Papia Adhikari said Bengal will follow guidelines issued by police to burst firecrackers

Earlier, the CM said that firecrackers will be burst during the festival.

However, he urged everyone to ensure that eco-friendly or green crackers are used and that noise pollution regulations are followed.

Assam dists revoke Diwali dry day orders

Cachar and Sribhumi administrations revoked Diwali and Kali Puja dry day orders within 24 hours, prompting criticism on social media. The districts initially declared Nov 8 and 9 as dry days and ordered licensed liquor outlets to remain closed. On Sunday, however, revised orders allowed the establishments to operate normally during the two festivals. The new notifications, issued on Nov 8, superseded orders issued a day earlier. Cachar administration said the revised order was issued in public interest but did not state the reason for the reversal. TNN

Diwali turns tragic as roof collapse kills 3

Kanpur: Diwali festivities turned into tragedy for a family in Uttar Pradesh's Kanpur Sunday morning when the roof of their house collapsed, killing three members, including a 20-day-old baby. A fourth family member suffered minor injuries.

Police said the roof collapsed, trapping Vinodni Shukla (60), her son Harsh (32), daughter-in-law Anshika (28), and grandson Aarav under the debris. Before police and rescue team arrived, family members and neighbours pulled them out and rushed them to Kalyanpur CHC, where doctors declared Vinodni, Anshika and Aarav dead. The family initially refused to allow post-mortem, but police later persuaded them to consent. TNN

Odisha minister: No concrete proof yet from Indonesia for claim over rescued orangutans

Bhubaneswar: Neither Bhubaneswar: Neither Indonesia nor any other country has so far provided documentary evidence to establish ownership of five baby orangutans rescued from a forest in Odisha two months ago, state forest minister Ganesh Ram Singh Khuntia said Sunday.

"All five baby orangutans are doing well and growing. No one should disturb them. We want them to stay in Odisha, and visitors will get an opportunity to see them at Nandankanan Zoo," he said.

Five baby orangutans were rescued from a forest in Odisha

The minister said some countries might stake a claim to the animals under international wildlife trade regulations, but they would have to furnish concrete evidence to establish that the rescued animals originated from their territory.

"The Indonesian govt has raised its claim as a routine matter. We will seek evidence to establish that the orangutans originated from their country. If they provide the proof, the animals may be handed over to them," Khuntia said. He added that the state govt had submitted details of the rescued animals to the Centre for necessary action. "Odisha has a conducive environment for orangutans. So, we want them to stay here," he said.

The five baby orangutans were rescued from Bichitrapur forest in Balasore district on Sept 8 and subsequently shifted to Nandankanan Zoo, where they have been kept in quarantine. PTI

4 days after being brought back, Buxa tigress digs tunnel and flees again

Krishnendu Mukherjee & Pinak Priya Bhattacharya | TNN

File pic

The tigress, introduced to Buxa from Valmiki tiger reserve in Bihar, had left the enclosure on Oct 4 as well. She was brought back from Assam on Nov 3

Kolkata/Jalpaiguri: In a fresh challenge to Bengal's ambitious tiger reintroduction programme in Buxa, the three-year-old tigress brought back from Assam's Raimona landscape on Nov 3 has escaped from her 2.2-hectare acclimatisation enclosure again on Sunday afternoon.

The tigress, said sources, "dug a hole beneath the enclosure's foundation" and slipped out around 1.30 pm on Sunday, barely four days after foresters brought her back following a 10-day operation in the neighbouring state. The Nov 3 rescue, during which she was darted, was her third tranquillisation in 34 days.

Till last reports came in, sources said the tigress was moving eastwards towards Assam and had crossed Bala river. If she retraces her earlier route, the tigress will have to cross Jayanti and Raidak rivers before reaching Sankosh. Once across Sankosh, she could move further into Assam or head towards Bhutan.

The latest breach of the enclosure boundary raises fresh questions about the security of the acclimatisation facility and the challenges of keeping the wild tigress confined.

Asked if it is possible for a big cat to breach enclosure by digging under the fence, a former Wildlife Institute of India scientist said: "Yes, if the foundation is not done properly. Tigers are not great at digging like the dog family or hyenas."

The tigress has already been tranquillised thrice — once during the capture at Valmiki on Sept 29, then on Oct 1 to refit her collar that came off during relocation and again on Nov 3, during the capture in Assam. The latest escape comes after an eventful month for the big cat, identified as T-138 and later named BTR-TF1. Brought from Bihar's Valmiki Tiger Reserve, the tigress was released into the wild at Buxa's 25th Mile enclosure on Oct 2.

Avenger, tiger that outfoxed capture attempts for 6 yrs, kills farmer in Maharashtra

Prasad.Joshi@timesofindia.com

Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar: The tiger that killed a farmer in Ashti taluka of Maharashtra's Beed district on Saturday had twice survived attempts to tranquilise it, forest officials said. Known as Avenger, the male tiger has travelled nearly 500km across six districts since leaving its birthplace in 2023, making it one of the most elusive dispersing tigers recorded in Maharashtra.

Born in Tipeshwar Wildlife Sanctuary in Yavatmal district in 2022, Avenger left his natal territory in May 2023 and moved through Yavatmal, Dharashiv, Latur, Solapur, Ahilyanagar and Beed. He travelled largely through scrubland, ravines and agricultural fields near water streams.

He was first recorded in Dharashiv in Dec 2024, in Yedshi Ramling Wildlife Sanctuary and the Barshi forest range. Within weeks, he had killed 16 livestock animals and a wild boar, but had not attacked any human. Concerned about his presence in a human-dominated landscape, the forest head office in Nagpur ordered his capture on Jan 10, 2025, under Section 11(1)(C) of the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972. The plan was to tranquilise him, fit a radio collar, conduct a health check-up and relocate him to Sahyadri Tiger Reserve, which would have become the first reserve in Maharashtra to receive a relocated tiger. A specialised team was deployed and they used drones, thermal drones and more than 30 camera traps to track him. The team managed to dart Avenger twice, but failed to capture him. The operation was called off on April 5, 2025.

FOREST FUGITIVE: Since leaving its birthplace Tipeshwar sanctuary in 2023, Avenger has covered nearly 500km across six districts

The forest department will seek fresh permission from its head office in Nagpur to resume the rescue operation. Two teams of forest staff from Ashti and Patoda have been formed to inform residents about precautions.

ET THE ECONOMIC TIMES

FOUNDERS' GROWTH RETREAT

RESET • NETWORK • GROW

For founders who lead, build and think ahead.

4th - 7th December, 2026

Mumbai - GOA - Mumbai

An Exclusive 4-Day Founder Experience

EXECUTIVE WELLNESS
Stargazing • Rhythmic Connection • Meditation

STRATEGIC MASTERCLASSES
Road to IPO • Team to Tribe • Neuroscience

CURATED FOUNDER NETWORK
Peer Alliances • Meaningful Conversations

BEYOND BUSINESS
Astronomy under the stars and premium cruise experiences.

FOR

FOUNDERS • PROMOTERS • BUSINESS OWNERS • GROWTH-STAGE LEADERS

RESERVE YOUR SEAT

FOR REGISTRATIONS
Ravi Sharma
+91 95828 20303
ravi.sharma1@timesinternet.in

FOR PARTNERSHIPS
Joydeep Ghosh
+91 97129 41218
joydeep.ghosh@timesinternet.in

A TIMES INTERNET PRODUCT

Manufacturing Joy?

CITY CITY BANG BANG

SANTOSH DESAI

Normally we need light so that we can see, but on festivals light is used to be seen. When we light up our homes with traditional diyas or LED lamps, light up public buildings and institutions, or festoon a Christmas tree, we want the lighting to be spectacular. This is light as symbol, not function.

Every festival across cultures has its own vocabulary. Yet the grammar underneath them is remarkably similar. We dress up like mithais, covered in silver foil and zari, and then eat the real ones. A Christmas tree laden with presents and a woman laden with gold at a wedding belong to different traditions, yet they both are expressing the same sentiment. There is a fullness to both, a sense of life having more to offer than it ordinarily does.

It is interesting that festivals are a time of joy but in truth all of us may not necessarily feel joyous at that particular time. What festivals do is make public joy both possible and visible. Whatever our mental state might be- tired, anxious, pre-occupied or disconnected, festivals jolt us out of ourselves. Lights need to be put up, gifts ordered, endless WhatsApp messages with diya visuals need to be responded to. We have no choice but to get into the festive spirit of things. Perhaps this is the most interesting thing about festivity. It is engaged in the mass manufacture of happiness. And it does so by constructing the ambience where joy is the eventual outcome that is aimed for. How does a festival do this? Largely by changing the setting in which feeling occurs. Everyday and familiar surroundings evoke familiar feelings- worry, fatigue, obligation. There is a need to change these so as to elicit a new set of feelings. So the house is painted, rangolis drawn, torans and buntings put up. For a few days we are placed in a world that does not resemble the one that otherwise occupies us, and we exchange our regular self for a temporary new one, primed to squeeze enjoyment out of every experience.

An important marker is our increased consumption of energy. Food is fried, sweetened, enriched with ingredients used more cautiously at other times. We light up our homes with a furious disregard for electricity bills. We live a higher wattage existence. We stay awake longer and talk more loudly. Noise is an important marker of enjoyment- loud parties, blaring music and firecrackers announce fun to the world. Life is overdressed, overfed, but not quite sated, for in festivals nothing is ever quite enough.

The loosening of restraint is deliberate, both in economic and cultural terms. We worry less about measuring things, we spend on perishable things, like flowers and fireworks, and we behave in a more uninhibited way, whether in the liberties we take during Holi or the licensed gambling at Diwali.

A big part of the festive experience is the synchronised participation of the collective. A surge of common feeling, of people doing the same thing, dressed in the same kind of clothes at the same time. The idea of the individual is temporarily suspended, its edges briefly blurred for us to experience a kind of dissolution into the collective. Celebrations paint the ambience with vivid hues; the individual is part of the whole. Joy is more convincing when we see it on others; every lit house validates our own excesses.

The manufacture is not only for the present. Many of the signs of festivity, the abundance, the gold, the full table, are signs of fertility, not surprising in cultures with an agrarian past. All celebrations might be located in the present but are rooted in hope for the future. We wish each other the very best on festivals in the hope that prosperity and happiness will be ours. Celebrations are also a display of gratitude, of communicating that one is cognisant of one's good fortune and is not taking it for granted.

In the recent past, festivals have become an arena for cultural conflict. Politics plays its part, but there is a deeper tension. On the one hand, festivals were built to overwhelm the individual, and a little inconvenience was part of the protocol. But as our primary definition of the self becomes more pronouncedly individualistic, we expect happiness to be made to order, on our own terms and with our consent, the way we expect so much else to be.

On the other hand, as we become more affluent and our regular life becomes better lit and more indulgent, we need to work that much harder to communicate the specialness of festivals. The show of abundance becomes a competitive sport. More lights, louder music, parties that go on till later, fireworks that seem endless.

We get sandwiched between a sentiment that is overly protective of the individual and one that ignores the very real problems caused by excess. There is no easy answer for this, for what is at work are competing mental models of the self as against the collective, and of joy as symbol as against joy as cost. This is going to be a difficult negotiation.

But a life lived without these interruptions of public joy would admittedly be less meaningful. Festivals are designed to create islands of happiness in our lives, make us lose our individual identities and forget our immediate circumstances to immerse ourselves in something larger. Happiness is too important and too uncertain to be left entirely to chance.

santosh365@gmail.com

Rajnath Singh pays homage to war heroes in Sikkim

Gangtok: Defence minister **Rajnath Singh** visited Sherathang near Nathu La in Sikkim on Sunday and paid homage to fallen soldiers at the war memorial.

Addressing Army personnel stationed at the India-China border, Singh said such memorials served as a lasting tribute to war heroes who made the supreme sacrifice for the nation and would continue to inspire generations of young Indians.

Lauding the courage and dedication of security personnel deployed along the frontiers under difficult and challenging conditions, he said the country could celebrate Diwali peacefully because of the armed forces.

He also paid tribute to the families of armed forces personnel who lost their loved ones while serving the nation, acknowledging their contribution and sacrifice. "India stands with you for the contribution you have made," Singh said. PTI

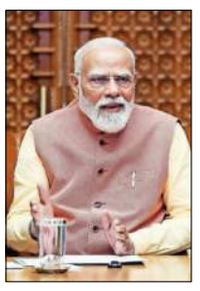
Political will since 2014 drove anti-insurgency success, says PM

▶Continued from page 1

He described the milestone as a victory of sound policies, political resolve and the bravery and restraint of security personnel. "More than 1,000 jawans sacrificed their lives in Chhattisgarh", he said, recalling the scale of Maoist violence, adding there was a time when more than 230 districts across 20 states were affected.

From Bihar and Odisha to Maharashtra, Madhya Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh and Chhattisgarh, vast regions had lived under the shadow of violence, he said. "After sunset, life would come to a standstill. People could not step out of their homes. Naxals had even snatched away people's right to vote," he said.

Modi recalled the April 2010 Dantewada massacre in which 76 CRPF personnel were killed and another attack that year in which he said 44 civilians lost their lives. He accused previous govts of treating the insurgency as an incurable problem and abandoning tribal communities to their fate. "Some had accepted that bullets would continue to fly, jawans would die and innocent people would suffer. No country can confront its enemies with an attitude that things will simply continue this way," he said.



"Naxals have been eliminated, but the danger has not yet passed. Ideological Naxals are still instigating people against the country's Constitution and democracy. They have infiltrated several political parties and organisations. We must identify and defeat them

NARENDRA MODI | Prime Minister

He credited the change in India's counter-insurgency strategy to the political will demonstrated after his government assumed office in 2014. "We gave our security forces the freedom to take every necessary decision," he said, adding the govt had taken several national security decisions, including measures not widely known to the public, to disrupt funding networks supporting Maoists and separatist organisations. He also alleged that elements within the earlier political and administrative system had provided support to Left-Wing Extremism, which his govt worked to eliminate.

Linking the decline in insurgency to development, Modi said Maoists had prevented schools, hospitals, medical facilities, mobile towers and industries from coming up in areas under their influence. Modi said the govt had, therefore, pursued security operations alongside a special development campaign.

According to him, more than 15,000km of roads had been constructed in areas affected by Naxalism, along with over 9,500 mobile towers. Nearly 175 Eklavya residential schools had been opened for tribal students, while 50 industrial training institutes and approximately 50 skill development centres were established to improve employment opportunities. He also cited the establishment of thousands of post offices, bank branches and ATMs in previously underserved regions.

Drought shrinks strawberry acreage by 40% in Mahabaleshwar

Sandip.Dighe@timesofindia.com

Strawberry cultivators in Mahabaleshwar and Panchgani, which together produce 80% of the country's fruit, face an uncertain winter, with unusually high temperatures and water shortages threatening the crop and the seasonal tourism built around it.

Uttekar family grows strawberries on their farm in Haroshi village and sell it at a roadside stall

The region received just 3,564mm of rainfall this monsoon against its usual 5,438mm. By Sept-end, both towns were declared drought-affected for the first time in recent history. Borewells have dried up and daytime temperatures remain above normal.

"This is an El Nino year, characterised by higher-than-usual daytime temperatures. Mahabaleshwar is not exempt," says SD Sanap, a scientist with the IMD.

Cultivation has already shrunk 40% in Mahabaleshwar, from the usual 720 hectares to just over 280 hectares, with a similar reduction in Panchgani. "Farmers fear they may not have sufficient water by Jan or Feb, when the strawberry season peaks. That's why they haven't planted more," says Maya Lende, tehsil agriculture officer in Mahabaleshwar.

Each acre requires an upfront investment of Rs 2-4 lakh, with plantation running from Sept to Dec. "The crop offers good returns if conditions are good, but in weather like this, it becomes a gamble," says Prakash Jadhav, a grower near Panchgani.

7 years after Israeli firm's DPR, JICA roped in for Marathwada Water Grid project

Prasad.Joshi@timesofindia.com

Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar: Maharashtra govt said a preliminary project report for Marathwada Water Grid would be prepared afresh, seven years after the then govt in 2019 said the detailed project report (DPR) was ready.

The seven-year gap — and what happened to the first report, for which Rs22 crore of public money was paid to an Israeli firm — is now the central question hanging over the project supposed to make Marathwada drought-free, say water rights activists.

CM Devendra Fadnavis on Nov 6 met a senior delegation of Japan International Cooperation Agency (JICA) in Mumbai and directed officials to accelerate the project. He told them to upload the preliminary project report immediately and forward it to the Union finance ministry's department of economic affairs.

TOI

The 7-year gap — and what happened to the first report, for which ₹22cr was paid to an Israeli firm — is now the key question hanging over the project supposed to make Marathwada drought-free, say activists

JICA has responded positively to a loan of around Rs20,000 crore for the first phase of the project, an official release said. It stated that the state planned to complete Marathwada Water Grid's execution by 2029. The announcement has revived an old claim. In 2019, then water supply and sanitation minister Babanrao Lonikar had said the DPR for the water grid was ready and the work in the first phase would begin before the Assembly elections that year. Lonikar refused to comment on recent developments related to the project.

The CM also could not be reached for comments on the issue. The 2019 DPR was prepared by an Israeli firm. It claimed to have studied 35 years of taluka-wise rainfall data and water availability in every medium and large water body across the eight districts of Marathwada.

"Rs22 crore was said to have been paid to the firm for the DPR. The work never started. The state govt must make public what happened with the earlier plan before making a fresh announcement," water rights activist Narhari Shivpure said.

Maha teacher sold house, land to help poor youth achieve success

Ardhra.Nair
@timesofindia.com

Pune: Renuka Kekan grew up learning to read lips in a dry cotton belt village in Maharashtra's Akola district. She is over 80% hearing impaired. When the doctor suggested a hearing machine, her father was reluctant as he felt the device would signal her disability and could mark her future.

Renuka secured AIR 948 in the recent civil services exam results, becoming the first girl from her village or even taluka. "My parents no longer care about the hearing aid. I owe my success to the Manobal programme that offered three years of free accommodation, counselling, subtitled lectures and customised training," she added. Nineteen students from the same programme were on the UPSC list. It is one of several run by Deepsthamb Foundation that provides persons with disabilities, orphans, transgenders, and poor students free residential education, counselling and employment opportunities in New Delhi, Pune and Jalgaon.

The organisation began in 2009 after an unsettling observation two decades ago by its founder Yajurvendra Mahajan. In 2005, 25-year-old Mahajan was teaching at a competitive exam coaching centre in Pune. He saw that students from poor backgrounds studied under the pressure of survival, scraping together money for fees, living in cramped rooms and saving on meals.

Mahajan quit his job and went back to Jalgaon. He sold the house and farm he had inherited from his father, and took in 10 underprivileged students and taught them from a rented house. The next year, all 10 cleared the MPSC exam and became Class I and II officers. In 2019, Mahajan opened a branch in Pune and another in Delhi last year. The three campuses and online courses now host hundreds of students who arrive with stories of loss, rejection or quiet resilience.

Toll in OIL's Assam facility fire rises to 4 as another injured worker dies

Dibrugarh: The toll in the fire incident at an Oil India Ltd (OIL) facility in Assam's Dibrugarh district increased to four, with another injured worker succumbing on Sunday, an official said.

Three others who were also injured in the blaze on Friday are undergoing treatment in a critical condition.

One person was killed in the fire on the day of the incident, while two died the next day. A mechanical helper, Sailen Gogoi, who was undergoing treatment at a private hospital here, died during the day, taking the toll to four, the official said

All the victims were employees of Spectron Engineering Private Limited, a Mumbai-based company engaged by OIL.

A fire had broken out on November 6 after an explosion during maintenance work at OIL's intermediate tank farm in Tengakhat, the public sector undertaking said in a statement. PTI

FIR filed in Gzb blast case; police verify terror group's claim

Ghaziabad: Ghaziabad police have registered an FIR against unidentified persons at Indirapuram police station over Friday night's blast at the Vasundhara Police Outpost and are verifying a social media post by "Tehrik Ul Mujahideen", which has claimed responsibility for the explosion that damaged window panes and injured one person, police said.

Sub-inspector Vikas Singh, who was on duty when the blast took place, registered the case, police said on Sunday.

The Indirapuram Police and other investigative agencies are probing several angles, including the possible involvement of Shahjad Bhatti's terror network in the NCR and Delhi, police sources said on Sunday.

Police recovered an abandoned scooty from an elevated road, suspected to have been used by those involved in the blast. PTI

DIRECTORATE OF MINORITIES
Maulana Azad Bhavan, No.16C, Miller Tank Bed Road, Vasantnagar, Bengaluru - 560 052.

No: DOM/DEVP/MAMS/Nursery Kit/CR-40/2026-27 Date: 07.11.2026

Announcement of Short Term Re-Tender

Short Term Re-Tender has been invited by the Directorate of Minorities for Supplier to supply Nursery Kits to the students of studying in LKG and UKG classes of Karnataka Maulana Azad Public Schools working under Minority Welfare Department in the academic year 2026-27. Details are given below. Interested bidders should apply through online mode under e-Procurement Portal.

Sl. No.	Details	Date/Time
1.	Date of Tender Publication	09.11.2026
2.	Tender Amount:	Rs. 412.50 Lakhs.
3.	EMD Amount:	Rs.6,18,750/-
4.	Pre-bid meeting:	16.11.2026 at 11:00 a.m.
5.	Last date and time for submission of tender:	24.11.2026 by 5:30 p.m.
6.	Date and time of Technical bid opening:	26.11.2026 at 10:30 a.m.
7.	Date and time of Financial bid opening:	30.11.2026 at 11:30 a.m.
8.	Place of tender opening and contact address:	Maulana Azad Bhawan, No.16C, Miller tank Bed Road, Vasantnagar, Bengaluru - 560052.
9.	Telephone No. to be contacted	080-22535901/902 080-22535918.

Other details can be obtained from the website of the Directorate of Minorities https://dom.karnataka.gov.in and e-Procurement Portal.

Sd/-
Director
Directorate of Minorities, Bengaluru

DIPR/CP/3630/MAA/2026-27

DIRECTORATE OF MINORITIES
Maulana Azad Bhavan, No.16C, Miller Tank Bed Road, Vasantnagar, Bengaluru - 560 052.

No: DOM/DEVP/MDRS/MAMS/Shoe/CR-05/2026-27 Date:07.11.2026

Announcement of Short Term Re-Tender

Short Term Re-Tender has been invited by the Directorate of Minorities for Supplier to supply two pairs of Shoes(one pair of Black colour shoe and one pair of white colour shoe), two pairs of Socks & Belt to the students of Residential Schools/College and Maulana Azad Model Schools working under Minority Welfare Department in the academic year 2026-27. Details are given below. Interested bidders should apply through online mode under e-Procurement Portal.

Sl. No.	Details	Date/Time
1.	Date of Tender Publication	09.11.2026
2.	Tender Amount:	Rs. 925.13 Lakhs.
3.	EMD Amount:	Rs.13,87,699/-
4.	Pre-bid meeting:	16.11.2026 at 11:00 a.m.
5.	Last date and time for submission of tender:	24.11.2026 by 5:30 p.m.
6.	Date and time of Technical bid opening:	26.11.2026 at 10:30 a.m.
7.	Date and time of Financial bid opening:	30.11.2026 at 11:30 a.m.
8.	Place of tender opening and contact address:	Maulana Azad Bhawan, No.16C, Miller tank Bed Road, Vasantnagar, Bengaluru - 560052.
9.	Telephone No. to be contacted	080-22535901/902 080-22535918.

Other details can be obtained from the website of the Directorate of Minorities https://dom.karnataka.gov.in and e-Procurement Portal.

Sd/-
Director
Directorate of Minorities
Bengaluru

DIPR/CP/3628/MAA/2026-27

BANGALORE WATER SUPPLY AND SEWERAGE BOARD

Office of the Chief Engineer (Cauvery Head Works), 8th Floor, Cauvery Bhavan, K.G. Road, Bangalore-560009.

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL

Medium Term Open Access (Only through KPP portal)

No. BWSSB/CE(CH)TE/ACE(CH)/TA-01/1259/2026-27 Dated: 07.11.2026

BWSSB invites Request for Proposals (RFP) is to seek commercial proposal from Power Generating Company or License Traders / Captive Power Projects (CPP) / Merchant Power Plants for **"Supply of Energy of total 100 million units per month for a period of 24 months at BWSSB 220 kV/66 kV Pumping Stations located in Thorekadanahalli (T.K. Halli), Harohalli & Tataguni".**

EMD: **For T.K. Halli Package: Rs. 57.00 lakhs.**
ForHarohalli Package: Rs. 57.00 lakhs.
For Tataguni Package: Rs. 57.00 lakhs

Date & time of Pre-bid meeting: **17-11-2026 at 15:00 hrs.** Last date for submission of bids : **23-11-2026 upto 17:30 hrs.** Date & time of opening of technical bid: **24-11-2026 at 15:00 hrs.** The details regarding the tender and participation in the e-Procurement portal process can be obtained by logging on to **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in** For further details contact the undersigned office during working hours.

Sd/-
Chief Engineer (Cauvery Head Works)

DIPR/CP/YC/3615/2026-27

BANGALORE WATER SUPPLY AND SEWERAGE BOARD

INVITATION FOR TENDERS (Through KPP Portal Only)

BWSSB invites tenders in two stage tender system from eligible contractors for the following works.

Sl. No.	Name of the Works	Amount put to Tender / EMD Amount
	Office of the Chief Engineer (South), 7th Floor, Cauvery Bhavan, K.G. Road, Bangalore - 560 009.	
	No.:BWSSB/EIC/CE(S)/ACE(S)-I/DCE(S)/TA(S)/4970/2026-27 Date:06.11.2026	
1	Providing and Laying of 230/300mm dia GSW/RCC UGD pipeline at Begur Main Road, Devarachikkanahalli Main Road and surrounding area coming under Begur Service Station of AEE S-2-1 Sub Division.	Rs. 157.90 Lakhs / Rs. 2.36 Lakhs
	No.:BWSSB/EIC/CE(S)/ACE(S)-I/DCE(S)/TA(S)/4971/2026-27 Date:06.11.2026	
2	Replacement of existing leaky CI pipeline with providing and laying 100mm & 150mm dia DI pipeline along with DI Control Valve at 6th Main, 7th Main, 8th Main, 9th Main, 7th Cross, 8th Cross, 9th Cross and 11th Cross (Mulki Sundar Ram Shetty Sabangana adjacent and back side area) coming under Vijaya Bank Layout Service Station of AEE(S)- 1-1 Sub Division.	Rs. 111.02 Lakhs / Rs. 1.67 Lakhs
	No.:BWSSB/EIC/CE(S)/ACE(S)-I/DCE(S)/TA(S)/4972/2026-27 Date:06.11.2026	
3	Replacement of existing leaky CI pipeline with providing and laying 100mm & 150mm dia DI pipeline along with DI Control Valve at 2nd Main, 3rd Main, 4th Main, 5th Main, 6th A Cross, 6th B Cross, 9th Cross and 10th Cross (Vijaya Bank Layout play ground adjacent and back side area) coming under Vijaya Bank Layout Service Station of AEE(S)- 1-1 Sub Division.	Rs113.10 Lakhs / Rs. 1.67 Lakhs
	No.:BWSSB/EIC/CE(S)/ACE(S)-I/DCE(S)/TA(S)/4973/2026-27 Date:06.11.2026	
4	Providing and laying 230 & 300 mm dia UGD pipeline inplace of 150/200 mm dia silted up at Aradhana layout, MS Ramaiah City Layout, Nrupathunugha Nagara, Suncity, Raghavendra Layout, Sankranthi Layout, Kothanur and Surrounding area Coming under AML Service Station of AEE(S)-1-1 Sub division.	Rs.111.32 Lakhs / Rs. 1.67 Lakhs
	No.:BWSSB/EIC/CE(S)/ACE(S)-I/DCE(S)/TA(S)/4974/2026-27 Date:06.11.2026	
5	Providing and laying 230&300mm dia UGD pipeline in place of 150/200mm dia silted up at Arakere Mico Layout 1st Stage, Lakshmi Layout, BOB Colony, Puttenahalli and surrounding area Coming under AML S/s of AEE(S)-1-1 Sub division.	Rs.111.61 Lakhs / Rs. 1.67 Lakhs

For all the above works, Last date for receipt of tenders: **24.11.2026 upto 15:00 Hrs.** The Tenders will be opened on: **25.11.2026 after 16.00 Hrs.**

Sd/- Chief Engineer (South)

The details regarding the tender and participatin in the e-procurement process can be obtained by logging on to **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in** For further details contact the above signed office during working hours.

DIPR/CP/JA/3601/2026-27

PUBLIC NOTICE

Public are hereby notified that my client proposes to purchase the below mentioned Property described in the Schedule herein from **Ms. Shalini N. Patel alias Shalini Patel** Daughter of Sri. S. K. Narayana Swamy, 'Sri. Ranga', Sharavathi Nagar, B Block, Main Road, Shivamogga – 577201, who has represented that she acquired ownership in the Schedule Property through Gift Deed from her father Sri. S. K. Narayana Swamy, in terms of a Gift Deed dated 12/09/2008 registered as Document No. JPN-1-03420-2008-09 in Book-I and stored in CD No. JPND32, in the Office of the Senior Sub-Registrar, J P Nagar. Any persons objecting for the proposed sale and persons who are having any right, title or interest in the below mentioned property including by way of any agreement or otherwise shall lodge their objections and/or claims with the undersigned along with supporting documentary evidence within Fifteen (15) days from the date of this publication. Further, claims or alleged interest or objections, if any, which are not received within Fifteen (15) days from the date of publication of this notice shall be considered to have been consciously waived or abandoned for all intents and purposes. Any objections and/or claims and/or response received thereafter will not be binding on my client and they will proceed to purchase the Schedule Property as if there are no claims/objections.

:SCHEDULE:

All that Site bearing Khata No.355 in 2nd Block, Banashankari VI Stage, Bangalore and site measuring East to West 24 metres and North to South 15 metres in all measuring 360 Sq. Mtrs. and bounded by:

East : Property No. 371; **West** : Road;
North: Property No. 356; **South**: Property No. 354.

Sri. KUSUMA R. MUNIRAJU,
Sri. KUSUMA KAUSHIK,
Advocates,
101, "Eden Park",No. 20, Vittal Mallya Road,
Bangalore-560 001.Tel: 080-22217971

Bangalore
Date: 08/11/2026

₹50 crore to treat 3 toddlers. Keralam chips in

From gene therapy to transplants, crowdfunding is helping families in the state bridge critical healthcare gaps through collective generosity, writes Preetu Nair

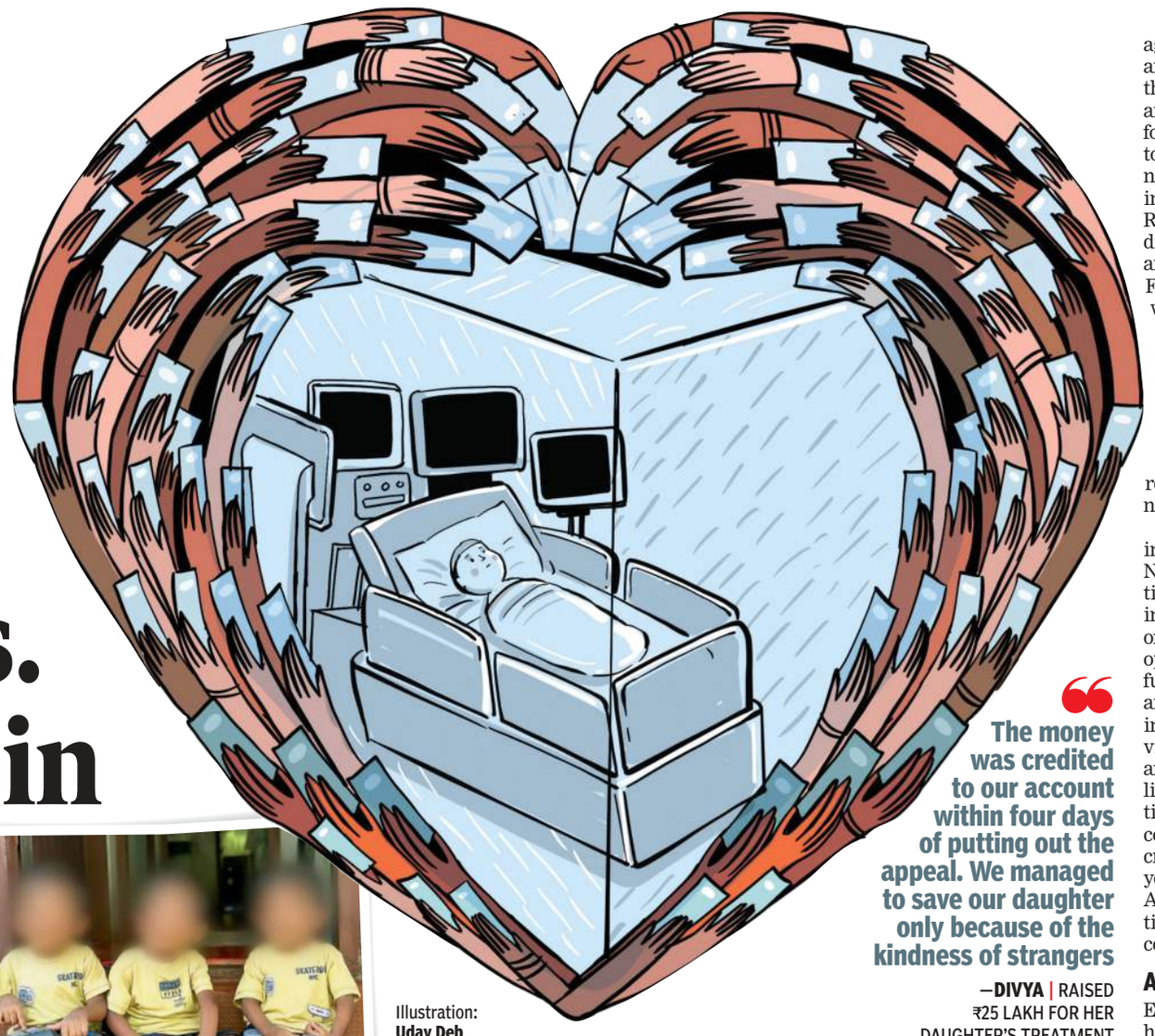


Illustration: Uday Deb

It has been a little over a week since a village in Keralam's Kozhikode rallied around three toddlers with a rare genetic disorder. Rs 50 crore is needed for their treatment; already, more than Rs 7 crore has poured in.

The triplets — David Magnus Arun, Ethan Moses Arun and Oliver Jonah Arun, aged one year and eight months — have spinal muscular atrophy (SMA) Type 2. For their middle-class parents, the cost of treatment seemed insurmountable. The family and its well-wishers initially approached friends and acquaintances. When they realised their personal networks would not be enough, they launched a crowdfunding drive to help the children access gene therapy.

Arun PD, the kids' father, quit his private-sector job to care for the premature triplets; his wife works at a private firm. The couple was devastated when they learnt the cost of treatment, but the response to the campaign has given them hope of reaching the Rs 50-crore target.

"On a personal level, it is impossible for us to raise the money needed to save our children," Arun tells **TOI**. "But crowdfunding has made this task feel achievable. We had heard of people coming forward to support genuine causes. This time, we experienced it ourselves."

For the family, the strength of crowdfunding is in thousands of small contributions, rather than a handful of large ones. "Donations are coming in every second," Arun says. "Most are modest — from Rs 50 or Rs 100. Rs 50 crore may seem like an impossibly large sum, but if 50 lakh people donate Rs 100 each, we can reach the target. It is often ordinary people who open their hearts and pockets to help."

Power Of Many

The triplets' family is among thousands across Keralam, many of them financially weak, who have turned to crowdfunding after they were confronted by serious or terminal illness. Contributions from neighbours, villagers, local organisations and strangers have helped several families meet treatment costs.

For Baasim's family, crowdfunding helped raise Rs 45 lakh for a bone marrow transplant. Now 14, Baasim has Diamond-Blackfan anaemia (DBA), a rare inherited bone marrow failure disorder. His haemoglobin level would fall as low as 3g/dL, against a normal range of 13.5 to 17.5g/dL for males. His transplant was particularly complex, with a high risk of rejection.

"It used to be daily steroid tablets and monthly blood transfusions from the fourth month of his birth till the age of 12. Now, my son can live a normal life," says Saneera Hans, Baasim's mother, a resident of Ambalapuzha. "He is now able to attend regular school and plays football. His father was the donor, yet when the doctors advised us to decide on the transplant before he turns 12 (before hormonal changes), we were stressed. My husband had just returned home as he lost his job in the Gulf, and my son's health started deteriorating fast. A transplant was the only way to save him. The village got together to raise funds through crowdfunding, which facilitated the transplant in less than a month."

Sharanya SS, a resident of Nedumangad, hopes to raise funds for her seven-year-old son Thejus, who has Treacher Collins syndrome, a rare genetic condition affecting facial development, hearing and speech. He will need three facial reconstruction surgeries after turning 10 to perhaps lead a more normal life.

The family has used crowdfunding before. When Thejus was five, Sharanya, a homemaker, and her husband, an autorickshaw driver, raised Rs 8.5 lakh for specialised bone-conduction hearing aids. The devices bypass his closed ear canals and transmit sound to the inner ear.

"For ordinary people like us, crowdfunding brings hope," Sharanya says.

Four-year-old Diya S of Vithura in Thiruvananthapuram district was diagnosed with biliary atresia, a rare and life-threatening liver disease. A transplant was the only way to save her. Her mother, Divya, was ready to donate part of her liver, but the family could not afford the surgery. "We would have lost her when she was just six months old," she says. "She needed an urgent liver transplant, which cost Rs 25 lakh at a private hospital. We had no money."

The family turned to crowdfunding. "The money was credited to our account within four days of putting out the appeal," Divya says. "We managed to save our daughter only because of the kindness of strangers."

HELPING HANDS...

Triplets with spinal muscular atrophy (Kozhikode)
Target **₹50 crore**
Received so far **₹7 crore+**

Boy with Treacher Collins syndrome (Nedumangad)
Family earlier raised **₹8.5 lakh** for specialised hearing aids; will need more for surgery

Teen with Diamond-Blackfan anaemia (Ambalapuzha)
Raised **₹45 lakh** for bone marrow transplant

Girl with biliary atresia (Vithura)
Raised **₹25 lakh** in 2023 for liver transplant

Chef with spreading foot infection
Target **₹2 lakh**, raised **₹60,000**

> **The money was credited to our account within four days of putting out the appeal. We managed to save our daughter only because of the kindness of strangers**
>
> —**DIVYA** | RAISED ₹25 LAKH FOR HER DAUGHTER'S TREATMENT

How Crowdfunding Works

Crowdfunding helps fill gaps in a health system that serves many but does not always provide advanced treatment for chronic, rare, genetic and life-threatening diseases at govt hospitals. The state govt's We Care project assists needy people not covered by existing schemes, while other schemes support rare-disease treatment. Their limitations, however, can leave a funding gap.

Neighbours and villagers are often joined by local organisations, expats and people with no connection to the patient. Appeals circulate through social media, news reports, community groups and online fundraising platforms. NGOs involved in crowdfunding say they receive three to four genuine medical cases a month, with the amounts sought ranging from a few thousand rupees to lakhs and even crores.

But responses vary widely. People donated more than Rs 25 lakh in four days for six-month-old Diya. In contrast, the family of a 43-year-old chef has spent a month and a half trying to raise Rs 2 lakh. So far, it has collected only Rs 60,000.

The diabetic chef developed a leg infection that he ignored while caring for his cancer-stricken father, and for his wife, who had uterus surgery. The infection spread to his brain and affected his speech. Neighbour Nishanth Unni and other volunteers began raising funds.

"But we have realised that crowdfunding moves much slower when the patient is an adult. People respond much faster when it's a child," says Unni.

'Support On Every Front'

Manya Sharma, managing partner at Milaap, a crowdfunding platform that's helped families in Keralam, says fundraising can meet expenses extending beyond hospital admission.

"When a family receives a critical diagnosis, they need support on every front, and crowdfunding is one more layer of that support," Sharma says. "Insurance and govt schemes give families a vital foundation, and crowdfunding builds on top of it, helping families meet the wider needs of a long treatment journey. The impact is often felt most after discharge. Recovery brings recurring medicines, diagnostics, travel to treatment centres and months without an earning member. Fundraising helps families through that whole stretch."

Transparency is key, say those involved in crowdfunding. Donors should be able to understand a patient's medical and financial condition, see how contributions are used and assess their impact. Campaign organisers — family members, friends, colleagues, elected representatives and prominent community members — play a crucial role.

"Almost 75% to 80% of crowdfunding in Keralam is for medical causes," says Nikhil Kumar, member, Kripa foundation, an NGO that helps with crowdfunding. "When it comes to medical treatment of kids and the underprivileged, people open their hearts. But people here also fund education, pets and animal welfare, and to build houses for the poor." People in Keralam have pooled money to support victims of the 2018 floods, rebuild homes after the Wayanad landslide, protect livelihoods and assist vulnerable communities. One of the state's most remarkable collective fundraising efforts raised Rs 34 crore in blood money for Abdul Rahim, a young driver sentenced to death in Saudi Arabia. The state govt also collected donations from individuals, associations and companies during Covid.

A Few Sour Notes

Even as many crowdfunding stories have happy endings, some have sparked controversy. In 2020, a 22-year-old Kannur woman's campaign for her mother's liver transplant drew scrutiny after donations reached Rs 1.2 crore, against the target of Rs 20 lakh. The dispute concerned how the surplus should be handled.

In 2021, Kerala High Court, emphasising the need for govt oversight of medical crowdfunding, asked, "Where's the money going? From where is the money coming? Is there any control or monitoring by the state over this collection of money?" The court clarified that it was not interdicting crowdfunding.

The state has no crowdfunding policy. "As Indians increasingly turn to online medical crowdfunding platforms to meet healthcare costs, it is essential to develop legislation or control mechanisms. There is no central or state regulation or framework in this regard," says Lekha D Bhat, assistant professor, department of epidemiology and public health, Central University of Tamil Nadu, who works on medical crowdfunding in India.

"Donor trust is crucial," adds Mohan G Prachodana, a Thiruvananthapuram-based art director involved in medical crowdfunding. "A donor's most satisfying moment is seeing the patient they helped live a healthy and normal life."

TIMES NATION

Bengal forest dept brings back century-old green-maroon theme dropped by TMC govt

Krishnendu.Mukherjee
@timesofindia.com

Kolkata: West Bengal forest department has started reverting to its century-old green-and-maroon colour scheme, replacing green-and-blue combination introduced in Aug, 2018 when Trinamool Congress-led govt was in office.

Though there has been no official communication if the change will also be extended to signages across its field establishments, there is a visible comeback of the old colour scheme. During a department-organised plantation drive on Saturday, **TOI** spotted green-and-maroon stickers bearing the department's name on planters having plants along a roadside kerb on a central Kolkata footpath.

BACK TO ROOTS: The old colour scheme symbolises the soil and the trees it nurtures

No forest department official was available for an immediate comment on whether a formal notification has been issued or instructions circulated to replace the existing signages. The old colour scheme symbolises the soil and the trees it nurtures.

It was followed as a convention for most of the country. In 2018, the then head of forest force, N K Pandey, had said blue was opted for as the colour conveys the message of water conservation.

China eyes international role for Tiangong as ISS retires

▶ Continued from page 1

As per official Chinese media, after a short stay aboard Tiangong, the Pakistani astronaut will return to Earth aboard Shenzhou-23, which docked with the station in May 2026. The agreement covers astronaut selection, training and participation in Chinese space-station missions. Following a three-stage assessment, Ali and Daud were shortlisted and sent to China for training alongside Chinese counterparts. One will fly while the other remains a backup.

For Pakistan, the mission represents its entry into human spaceflight. For China, it is an opportunity to demonstrate that Tiangong can serve as an international platform for crewed missions as the International Space Station (ISS) approaches retirement. China completed its space station in 2022, having developed an independent human spaceflight programme after being excluded from the ISS partnership. Now, Beijing is looking to extend Tiangong's reach through international partnerships.

The Pakistan mission is an early demonstration of that approach. China has also been working with other countries on space exploration, including lunar missions, and offering opportunities for international participation. The timing matters. The ISS, the world's only mature, multilateral space station, is approaching the end of its operational life. Tiangong could increasingly become an alternative for countries seeking access to human spaceflight, scientific experiments and operational experience in orbit.

The emerging competition, therefore, is not simply about who can build a station or send astronauts into space. It is also about who can attract partners and shape the frameworks for future exploration.

For India, the development adds a geopolitical dimension to its human spaceflight ambitions. Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla's Axiom-4 mission to ISS last year gave India its first human spaceflight experience since Rakesh Sharma (1984). But its next steps remain centred on indigenous capability via Gaganyaan, followed by Bharatiya Antariksh Station, and a crewed Moon landing.

India signed US-led Artemis Accords in June 2023, while China and Russia are pursuing the International Lunar Research Station framework. India's challenge is to work with different space powers without becoming confined to their geopolitical choices. The Pakistani mission also raises a question for New Delhi: whether building indigenous infrastructure alone will be sufficient, or whether India must simultaneously seek greater access to international experience and partnerships. For India, the message is not that it must follow Pakistan's route or choose between Washington and Beijing. The next space race will be shaped as much by partnerships and influence as by rockets and spacecraft. India's ability to safeguard its strategic autonomy will depend on ensuring it has a voice in shaping that future.

Woman found hanging inside UP fin co office; kin allege murder

Arjumand Bano | TNN

Gorakhpur: A 20-year-old woman worker was found hanging inside a finance company's office in Easternpur Colony under Shahpur police station limits late Saturday, triggering protests by her family members and residents, who alleged that she had been murdered.

On being alerted, police reached the spot and sent the body for post-mortem examination.

Her mother arrived the finance company's office when the woman did not return home Saturday night. She found her daughter's slippers and scooter parked outside. When she looked inside, she found her daughter hanging from a noose. The family blamed the office manager for her death.

On Sunday, the family and villagers gathered outside the office and staged a protest, demanding an impartial investigation and action against the accused. The family also said CCTV cameras inside the office were switched off. Circle officer Gorakhnath Ravi Kumar Singh said the cause of the woman's death was yet to be established.

Punjab gangster deported from Ethiopia after 10-mth manhunt

Chandigarh: Punjab Police, with the support of central agencies, has secured the deportation of wanted gangster Gurwinder alias Afridi from Ethiopia following a 10-month international manhunt. He was taken into custody by Punjab Police at Delhi airport and is being brought to Punjab to face the law, police said Sunday. Punjab DGP Gaurav Yadav said this marks the first-ever deportation of a fugitive secured by state police from an African country.

Gurwinder, an alleged key kingpin of Doni Balbir Prabh Dassuwal gang, is accused of directing targeted killings, extortion-related firing incidents and organised criminal networks in Punjab from abroad. He is wanted in more than 30 heinous criminal cases.

"The marks successful culmination of 'Operation SHAHID', a 10-month-long intelligence-led manhunt involving surveillance and tracking across multiple nations in Asia, South America and Africa, executed in close coordination with national and international agencies," Yadav said. PTI

bp

Who says engineering isn't built for everyone?

We're making bp work for women

Engineering has never been about fitting a mould. It's about solving problems.

The best solutions come from people who think differently, challenge assumptions and bring new perspectives to the table.

That's the future we're building at bp.

Scan QR code or visit bp.com/womenofbp

We're with you

CONTRAPUNTO

The one charm about marriage is that it makes a life of deception absolutely necessary for both parties

– OSCAR WILDE

Mass Deception

The scale and speed with which AI can spread falsehoods pose two of the most serious risks to democracy

Last month, Google's parent Alphabet lost $500bn in market value after reporting that growing use of AI summaries had hurt its advertising revenue. That says something about how we get "information" now. Say, you're a voter and want to know something about a candidate. Just a few years ago, you would have turned to Wikipedia and news sites. Now, you get an AI summary before search results. If that isn't enough, you pull up a chatbot. And that can be a problem, as UN warned two years ago, and elections in Israel and US have shown.

The problem with AI is that, while it answers every question with the assurance of an expert, it's highly susceptible to influence – what's called Generative Engine Optimisation or GEO. You can use AI to create hundreds of fake news sites and fill them with fake info about a candidate, so that AI sees more of this slop than genuine reports, and moulds its own views based on it. This is a sneaky trick, and by no means uncommon. It's also alarming when you consider that about 40% of US voters in these midterms got their info from AI summaries.

What you read may be false, and what you see and hear online is equally suspect. During its campaign, Netanyahu's Likud party released over 1,800 AI-generated posts. One of them showed his main rival, Gadi Eisenkot, running past a young man – understood to be his late son, killed in the Hamas-Israel war – to embrace Arab politician Mansour Abbas. Israeli law requires AI content to be so labelled, but it's not a rule everywhere. Besides, proliferation of such content helps crooked politicians. When real scandals surface, they can dismiss them as fake – a liar's dividend.

In US, candidates spent over $130mn on AI content before the midterms, and roughly 80% of campaign strategists made use of AI in their work, which involves drafting campaign messages, gathering info, etc. In Israel, it turned out that parties were using AI robocalls to phish voters. The bots sound so human that you could reveal your doubts, hopes and leanings to them. Candidates anyway have a heap of info about you, which they use to send personalised messages in your language. It's a boon for them in multilingual countries like US and India. That's why use of AI in politics and polls will only increase. The challenge for voters is to stay connected to reality.

Good Over Bad

That's the spirit of Diwali. But when good and bad form a spectrum, doing the right thing can be tricky

A child's view of Diwali is pretty clear – it's time to eat sweets and burst crackers. Then, school blurs it by teaching Diwali's the triumph of good over evil. In this age, when everything's a haze, when there are no absolutes, and no binaries, that child – and grownups too – must learn to recognise good and evil on a spectrum. So, less bad is better than bad, but is it good? The child's parents went shopping for crackers, and chose the SC-approved "green" types. These are good, they said. Or less bad? If it burns, if it whiz-bangs, if it smokes, can it be green?

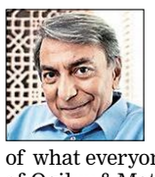
Asking such questions opens a Pandora's box. Is a baked samosa good, or only less bad than a fried samosa? Everybody wants "good": greenest car, greenest beverage in the greenest bottle, sipped with the greenest straw. Then dieselgate – the 2015 emissions scandal – happens. A Korean carmaker is warned not to claim its hydrogen fuel cell car "cleans" the air. MNCs' claims of 100% recyclable bottles made from 100% recycled plastic are proven false. Greenwashing. You virtuously give up cow milk in plastic pouches for almond milk in glass bottles, only to learn almonds have drained California's aquifers, and glass made with Qatari LNG isn't so green either. Cows at least "inhale and exhale oxygen", as many ministers swear.

Nothing is as it seems. You eschew sugar for jaggery, but the sugar patch registers the same spike. What is good? Flipping through an old magazine, you find an ad for cigarettes that are doctors' "preferred brand". In new news, world's most famous brand of rice crisps is made from rice flour, not whole rice, now. They can't find the right kind of rice due to climate change. That's bad definitely. And if you can recognise that, your good-bad meter isn't broken. It's got smarter.

Protest manager

Far-flung authorities coping with unrest could take a tip from a Calcutta adman

Jug Suraiya



As public protests – on issues from electoral controversy to shortcomings of the education system to the rising cost of living – erupt in India and much of Europe, beleaguered establishments might take a cue from the manager of the Calcutta branch of an international advertising agency.

Anshu Banerjee – large, always genial, the embodiment of what everyone's favourite uncle ought to be – managed the Calcutta office of Ogilvy & Mather where Bunny was the copy chief.

I'd pick up Bunny after work and I got to know her colleagues well. Though advertising is a high-pressure job with hair-raising deadlines and last-minute crises, thanks largely to Anshu the O&M office exuded an air of easy camaraderie, in which I became included, rather like a son-in-law being inducted into the intimate circle of his adoptive family.

Another frequent, and welcomed visitor to the office was Gij, who made a living by 'popping' all manner of items.

His main stock in trade was unisex knickers, of colourful hues and patterns, which he would offer for the irresistible price of ₹10 a pop. The office would soon be festooned with a festive bunting of rainbow knickers under Anshu's avuncular gaze.

jugularvein

O&M was a fun place to work. Which posed a problem for the clerical union. What was the point of a union if it didn't have grievances to protest?

So one day, several union members trooped into Anshu's office. Tongue-tied, they stood shuffling their feet.

"You don't know how to protest? I'll teach you," said Anshu. Pumping his upraised fist in the air, he began loudly to chant, "Anshu Banerjee, *kaalo haath bhenge debo, bhenge debo*." (We'll break your black hand). "Now repeat it after me," he admonished. Wind taken out of their sails, the unionists trooped out wordlessly.

What can you do if the protestee steals your thunder and hijacks your protest? The question is all about leading, an office or a nation, and how it's done. Which is a leading question, in more ways than one.

Big Barrel Of Relief?

US midterm results have raised the odds of Iran war fading out. Even otherwise, India's better prepared on sourcing oil than at the start of the war. Note, current account deficit is stable

Neelkanth Mishra

Executive Director, World Bank

Oil markets had feared that there would be a meaningful escalation in the Iran war, after the US midterm elections. Instead, we are now looking at an increased probability of an early resolution of the conflict in West Asia. After all, not only did the swing in favour of Democrats turn out to be much stronger than expected, Republicans themselves are blaming the Iran war's unpopularity as a major factor behind the election result.

Price of Brent crude oil is back below $100 per barrel (bbl), down sharply from $117, which was seen just two weeks back. Price of the oil slated for delivery a year from now, has also declined from $90 to $80. That is only about $10 higher than the average in the last fiscal year.

Uncertainty is far from over, though, and large parts of the energy ecosystem continue to be disrupted, including the Russian energy complex. While still adequate and no longer falling sharply, as supplies have recovered, even if not fully, global oil inventories are more than half a billion barrels lower than before the war, and may take more than a year to replenish after the conflict ends.

In addition, recovery in supplies of crude oil from West Asia has been at much higher freight costs. Insurance and fuel expenses have risen sharply, further exacerbated by the need to have ship-to-ship transfers (one ship navigates the high-risk waters, while a different vessel takes over after passing the Strait of Hormuz), plus disruptions in tanker scheduling and routes.

Goldman Sachs estimates that global average crude freight rates have risen above $20/bbl, from just $3/bbl a year ago. This adds to the landed cost of crude oil.

There is also the rise in refining margins, due to West Asian refinery production getting disrupted, which also adds to the effective price of energy. For example, despite shrinking from a peak of $75/bbl six weeks ago, at $50, diesel margins are still 2.5 times the pre-war level of $20. A combined effect of higher crude, higher freight, and higher refining margins has meant substantial increases in retail fuel prices globally.

For India, the terms-of-trade shock on energy (oil, gas, fertiliser, and edible oil imports) exceeds 2% of GDP. Despite this, growth indicators have been robust. And over the past two months, upgrades to India's growth forecasts have been the strongest among major global economies.

Some of this commendable resilience is due to the fading of monetary and fiscal headwinds, which held back growth in the last two years. This year, with fiscal consolidation behind us and credit formation accelerating, economic expansion was likely to be above trend-growth anyway. But there are several other factors in play as well.

Image: AI

Pressure on the rupee, and the need for RBI to sell dollars to stabilise it, is mostly due to corporates hedging imports excessively, while not hedging exports

As India has surplus refining capacity, it is a net beneficiary of the rise in refining margins. As its oil-marketing companies (OMCs) are majority govt-owned and are also refiners, the diesel margin expansion is not being passed on. By calibrating windfall taxes on exports of refined products, GOI is also sequestering these gains to subsidise some of the rise in crude prices.

But the most significant intervention is fiscal, as govt cushions the economy by limiting the increase in prices of retail fuel and fertilisers. Remarkably, this may not result in any meaningful increase in govt borrowing. Higher disinvestment (like the privatisation of IDBI and the LIC stake sale) is helping, as is the growth in GST collections and corporate taxes (with the latter largely offsetting the weakness in personal income tax growth).

Govt is also likely to dip into the ₹1tn Economic Stabilisation Fund, which it had created last year, and which will effectively push fiscal savings from the previous year to the current year. Together, these measures would suffice to limit meaningful fiscal slippage.

That leaves us with the pressure on the external account. After all, we still need to pay for the higher import bill in dollars, at a time when global capital flows are weak. Such apprehensions have been the major source of weak sentiment around the currency. But data does not show any reasons for concern yet.

We only have comprehensive balance-of-payments (demand and supply of dollars) data for the June 2026 quarter. Despite higher oil prices, current account deficit barely changed to $4.2bn, from a deficit of $3.4bn in the June 2025 quarter. Rise in goods trade deficit from $69bn to $86bn was mostly offset by a growth in the services surplus, and strong growth in remittances.

This continued in the Sept quarter, where the goods deficit rose by $2bn compared to last year, but the services surplus increased by $2.5bn. Once the growth in remittances is factored in, there is unlikely to be a meaningful increase in the current account deficit.

This is not to say that India's import bill on energy is not rising. But it appears that growth in services exports and remittances as well as improvement in goods exports (including refined oil products like diesel), are largely offsetting the impact.

Therefore, pressure on the currency, and the need for RBI to sell dollars to stabilise the rupee, is mostly due to corporates hedging imports excessively, while not hedging exports. These are speculative positions that are likely to unwind, as markets see the rupee not depreciating.

Views are personal

Women's Safety Is Very Much A Men's Issue

Why aren't men taking to the streets demanding women's safety and equality? Men see themselves as 'outsiders' in the struggle, but they are key stakeholders

Swati Sengupta

Delhi's witnessed two types of protest marches the last few months. One, in which, people from various cross-sections – including all genders – have taken to the streets demanding a transparent system in voting process. Two, hundreds who identify as women have demanded safety, reclaiming their right to public spaces.

What's odd in the latter, though not palpably so, are two things. Why are safety and equality only women's demands? Why aren't men displaying placards and posters – distressed, livid, heartbroken – on this issue, the way they demand voting rights as citizens?

Men's involvement in women's demands for equality is detached, half-hearted and confused. Understanding men's role in achieving an equal world for all genders may be key to resolving the crisis.

Are men 'outsiders' in the way a section of dominant groups fight for rights of minorities? But women are not statistically minorities, nor ethnic minorities. They're marginalised – treated unequally, discriminated against, and face extreme forms of violence. Women suffer the 'minority status' forced on them by patriarchy.

Sociologist Gary T Marx and academic Michael Useem in their 1971 paper 'Majority Involvement in Minority Movements: Civil Rights, Abolition, Untouchability', studied the role played by dominant 'outsiders' to change the depressed condition of a minority group along racial or ethnic lines.

As they compared US's civil rights movement (1950s and 60s), American abolitionist movement (19th century), and the one to end untouchability in India (eventually abolished under independent India's Constitution), scholars looked at changing roles of dominant outsider groups. Marx and Useem observed that a comparative study of these three movements showed acute inner tension between dominant 'outsiders' and subordinate groups.

"We were struck by the poignant and ironic parallels in the conflict that often developed between blacks and whites, or untouchables and caste Hindus, working together in a common movement to bring about change," they wrote.

Marx and Useem observed that while dominant group activists frequently played important roles in early formative phases, as their latent conflicts with subordinate groups became more visible, the former were "either excluded or forced to assume greatly reduced roles". Notably, outsiders in these movements had privileges subordinate group members did not. With a "disproportionate share of high status positions", the outsiders had more influence in decision-making, leading to conflict. Another issue was the negative impact of carrying prejudices into the movements, bringing in suspicion, distrust, stereotyping, and so on.

The scholars also mention "men in the feminist movement". It's worth looking at men's participation in women's demands for equality through Marx and Useem's study. A few weeks ago, a young woman in a Delhi protest site told a journalist that men were asked to (physically) stay away from their march because its purpose is for women to reclaim their power and strength.

She said if men were to join them, it would restrict women's movement, and "not allow us to be as free as we want." I find this justifiable – after all, protesting is also a healing process (to whatever limited extent possible).

There have been hundreds of reports of women getting molested in large gatherings that do not restrict men.

It is, however, a grey area. I say this as an insider and sufferer, not as outsider. If men look at themselves or are seen as "outsiders" in women's fight for achieving equality, sooner or later men may be prompted to withdraw themselves for reasons, similar to the three movements studied by Marx and Useem.

The answer is simple – men are *not* outsiders, but stakeholders in this battle. Not because this theory works better, but because they really are!

It is important for men (and women) to understand that an equal world will benefit men as well as women. It's a fight for women *and* men as allies in which both are beneficiaries and stakeholders.

Studies indicate it isn't just men, but women too, who are biased against women. According to UNDP's 2023 Gender Social Norms Index (GSNI), nine out of 10 women and men hold fundamental biases against women. The study covers 85% of world population covering people's attitudes on women in four dimensions – political, educational, economic and physical integrity.

It's important to identify how men will benefit in an equal world. Studies have indicated that promoting gender equality leads to 'greater subjective well-being', policies that promote gender equality lead to better quality of life "for everyone, not just direct beneficiaries of policies (women)".

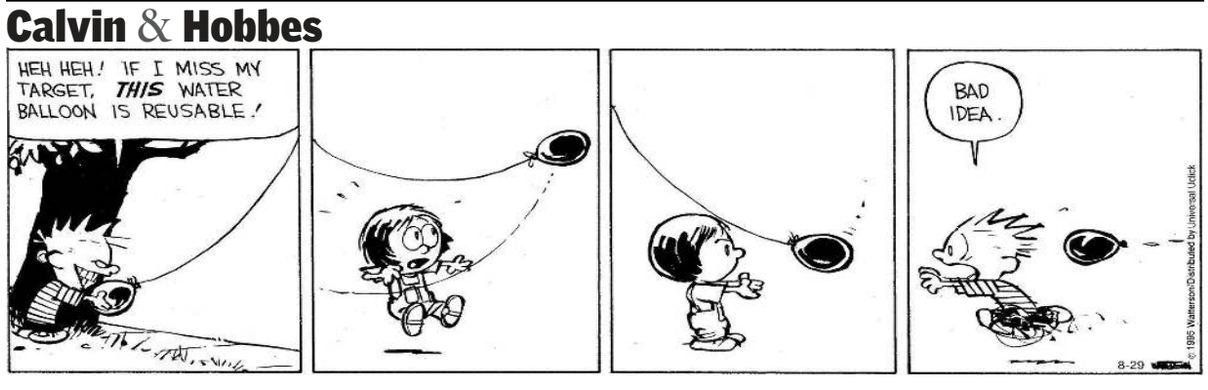
In an unequal world, men have to constantly play unfair gender roles and stereotypes, just like women. Men often find it tiring to breathe free in a brutal world that asks them to carry out illogical expectations of masculinity. They are expected to play a skewed notion of machismo, and it drains them out.

These are challenges most men find hard to handle, and yet unwittingly think they must carry it out because they are expected to.

An equal world, on the other hand, is a world in which all genders breathe free and do well. Men's role in women's demands for equality is best seen as a movement in which men are 'insiders' and all genders benefit directly.

Sengupta works on gender rights

Calvin & Hobbes



Sacred*space*

Life is the fire that burns and the sun that gives light. Life is wind and rain and thunder in the sky. Life is matter and is earth, what is and what is not, and what beyond is in Eternity.

Lucius Seneca

Wear Your Best Accessory Always

Sant Rajinder Singh

Throughout our lives, we learn from our parents, teachers, friends, spouses, and others how to live. Despite having all the knowledge and doing everything in our power to be happy, we find ourselves surrounded by difficulties when things do not go our way. Because we are not happy within, our pain shows on our faces, and as we go around with a sad face, our sadness spreads to those we meet. Whenever we go out, although we are careful to choose our outfits to impress others, we should not forget the most important part of our attire – a broad smile on our faces, despite our circumstances.

Despite our troubles, when we wear a smile, our sadness shrinks. When we meet them with a smile, we can surely ease their suffering. We should understand that each one of us is going through one difficulty or another because of our karmic load. This understanding changes our perspective on hardship and helps us realise that with every misfortune we face, our karmic burden lessens. We can then sail through problems with a smile. Even if we are in pain inside, we should keep smiling and stay positive.

THE SPEAKING TREE

One of the quickest ways to reach this happy, relaxed state is through meditation. When we meditate, we tap into a source of happiness and bliss. Those who experience God call the Divine all consciousness, all truth, and all bliss. Our soul is a drop of that ocean. When we meditate, we are connecting with our soul, our true essence, which is bliss. In meditation, when we focus on the seat of the soul, a doorway opens that leads us into the realms beyond. Carried on a stream of light and sound, the same essence as God, we swim along this river of bliss, which leads to the eternal infinite ocean of bliss.

Immersed in this ecstasy, we are far removed from life's pains and sorrows. Our soul fills with so much happiness that we become one big, eternal smile. When we emerge from our meditation, we carry that happiness with us for the rest of the day. Thus, no matter who we meet or what situation we are in, we are supported by the bliss within. This helps us deal with life problems while maintaining inner happiness. We may still have to deal with outer problems, but we are not affected within.

Further on, the right understanding that enables us to always have a ready and genuine smile is that we should understand that we are souls, parts of God, and not just the body and mind. If we meditate accurately and regularly, we can experience God's power within us. All we need to do is to invert and experience God within us. With this experience, our faith in God solidifies, and we know that God is ever with us and that we are never alone. We become worry-free and enter a state of joy and bliss with a constant smile on our faces. A sincere smile spreads joyous energy wherever we go and is the best accessory in our wardrobe.

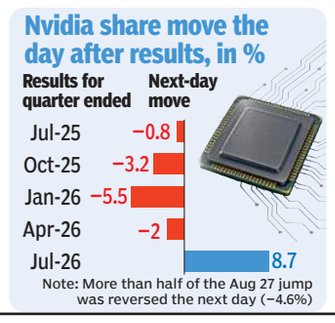
TIMES BUSINESS

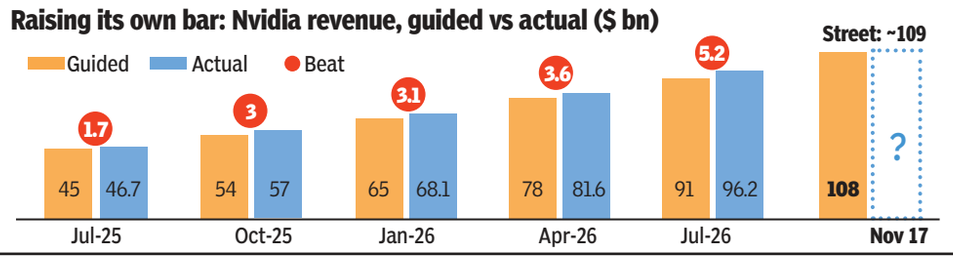
THE TIMES OF INDIA, BENGALURU | MONDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2026

TIPPING POINT
Nvidia's Nov 17 Results Put AI Trade On The Scales

Nvidia has beaten its own revenue forecast in each of the last five quarters, by a widening margin, but its shares fell the next day after four of them. This time the stakes are higher. The stock closed at $186.6 on Friday, about 22% below its Oct 6 record, after the post-midterm selloff in AI stocks. Worth about $4.5tn, Nvidia makes up about 7% of the S&P 500

BAR TO CLEAR: Nvidia has **guided for revenue of $108bn, up about 89% from a year ago**, with no China data-centre sales. The Street expects about $109bn





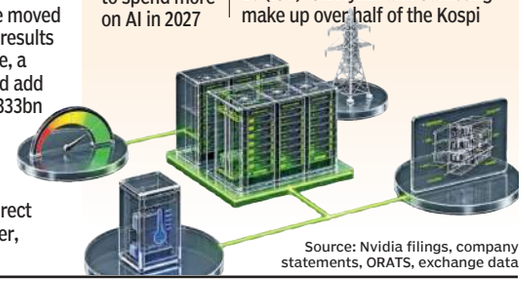
$333bn
Nvidia's shares have moved 7.4% on average on results day. At Friday's value, a move that size would add or wipe out about $333bn

16%
Share of Nvidia's revenue from one direct customer last quarter, per its SEC filing

Upside | Vera Rubin chips are in full production. Alphabet and Amazon plan to spend more on AI in 2027

Downside | Gross margin is guided down to 74%. Microsoft trimmed its 2026 capex to about $170bn, citing data-centre delays

Next test | Asia reacts first on Nov 18 (IST). SK Hynix and Samsung make up over half of the Kospi



Source: Nvidia filings, company statements, ORATS, exchange data

Anthropic strikes $3.4bn power deal

Anthropic has struck a deal worth about $3.4 billion to secure gas-fired power generators for its data centres, the Financial Times reported on Sunday.

The AI startup bought commitments for 1.7 gigawatts of heavy-duty generators in late September from OnePWR Solutions, an equipment supplier based in San Antonio, Texas, the report said. Anthropic did not acquire OnePWR itself, and none of the supplier's employees transferred to the AI startup. However, the deal included the engineering and construction capabilities needed to install the generators, the report added, citing a person familiar with the matter. Reuters could not immediately verify the report. Anthropic and OnePWR did not respond to requests for comment. REUTERS

Adani Ent eyes up to ₹40k cr capex per year till 2028

New Delhi: Adani Enterprises plans to spend between Rs 35,000 crore and Rs 40,000 crore annually over the next couple of years. "We expect to do capex at a run rate of around Rs 40,000 crore. So, we may be somewhere in the range of Rs 35,000 crore to Rs 40,000 crore, which is the rate we expect to continue over the next couple of years," Manan Vakharia, head of finance at Adani Enterprises, said during the company's earnings call. AGENCIES

IOC plans fleet buy to ensure oil, LPG supplies

New Delhi: Indian Oil Corporation (IOC) plans to acquire crude oil and liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) carriers of its own as disruptions to shipping around the Strait of Hormuz and soaring freight costs prompt the oil refiner to strengthen control over its energy supply chain. The company's board has already approved the purchase of a few vessels, director of finance Anuj Jain said. AGENCIES

Tata Steel Q2 net profit jumps 16%

New Delhi: Tata Steel posted a more than 16% year-on-year rise in consolidated net profit to Rs 3,700 crore in the Sept quarter. During the quarter, the company's consolidated revenue increased to Rs 65,436 crore from Rs 58,689 crore in the year-ago quarter. AGENCIES

Distribution ring-fenced from impact of new Irdai norms: LIC

'IDBI Bank Sale Not To Have Significant Impact On Business'

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Mumbai: LIC has said it is in an advantageous position under Irdai's new distribution norms and it also has taken steps to ring-fence the performance of bancassurance channels despite the impending sale of IDBI Bank — its largest bank distribution partner. Officials cited low expense ratio, diversified distribution network and declining dependence on IDBI Bank.

LIC CEO and managing director R Doraiswamy said the insurer's cost structure gave it an advantage over competitors, even if they reduced distribution costs. "Anybody else reducing the cost of distribution alone will still have to do a lot of work to bring their overall expense ratio to be under that. So, we stand to be on a distinctly advantageous position, and will be closely watching the market as it unfolds," he said in an analysts' call.

On the proposed IDBI Bank stake sale, Hemant Buch, executive director, marketing, bancassurance and alternate channels, said LIC did not expect a significant decline in business sourced through the lender. IDBI Bank's contribution has moderated from historical highs to around 20% of LIC's total bank-driven business and about 30% of its bancassurance volume.

> We would like to protect the interest of our agents in as much as whatever is possible within the regulatory framework, and that is why we have given our specific recommendations on some areas which concern the points raised by the agents' groups as well. We hope that there will be a good discussion, and when the version of draft regulations are released
>
> —R Doraiswamy | MD & CEO, LIC

"While IDBI will continue to deliver value for us and remain a valued and esteemed partner, we do not foresee much depletion in terms of their contribution and overall impact on the volume of bancassurance-driven performance," Buch said. He added that LIC was expanding its partnerships with other public and private sector lenders. Govt has recently approved sale of LIC and govt stake in IDBI Bank to Fairfax group.

Doraiswamy also said product pricing did not depend solely on the total expenses built into a policy. He said competitors relying more heavily on non-agent distribution channels or lower distribution costs would still need to reduce their overall expense ratios to match LIC's cost structure.

"We would like to protect the interest of our agents in as much as whatever is possible within the regulatory framework, and that is why we have given our specific recommendations on some areas which concern the points raised by the agents' groups as well. We hope that there will be a good discussion, and when the version of draft regulations are released," said Doraiswamy.

"In last couple of years, in fact, dependence on IDBI has, in fact, moderated. What it used to be around 50% to bank-driven business and almost 40% to total bancassurance business of corporation, it has moderated to around 20% of total and 30% to bank. Further moderation also is, in fact, taking place despite the, in fact, using the fact that IDBI continues to grow, but then, in fact, we also continue to grow with direction coming from, in fact, other partners," said Buch.

Irdai's proposed overhaul of insurance distribution, which seeks to sharply cut commissions, tighten expense limits, curb bank-led sales incentives and restrict loan-linked insurance bundling, has triggered resistance from insurers, banks, brokers and agents who fear loss of revenue, jobs and disruption to established distribution models, even as the regulator seeks to curb mis-selling and reduce costs for policyholders.

Mehli-Chandra meet focused on rebuilding trust, restoring equation

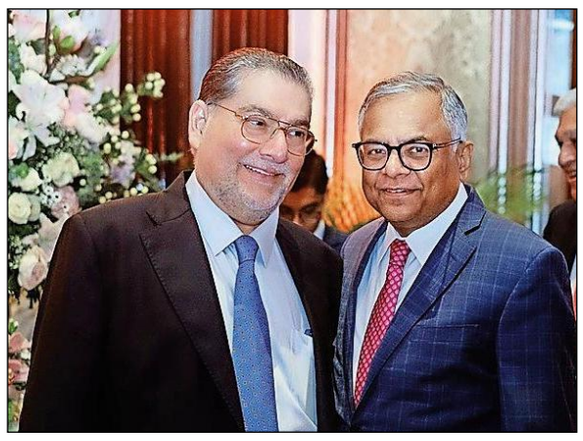
▶Continued from page 1

Mehli's challenge against his removal is pending before the Maharashtra Charity Commissioner (MCC).

Mehli and Chandrasekaran's conversation last week was focused on rebuilding trust and restoring a working equation. Mehli later left for Dubai, with both sides appearing keen to move beyond a difficult period in one of Tata Group's most significant internal relationships.

For much of the past decade, Mehli and Chandrasekaran were regarded as allies. After the dramatic ouster of Cyrus Mistry as chairman of Tata Sons in 2016, Mehli played a key role in the legal fight that followed between Cyrus and Ratan Tata. When Ratan Tata had to choose a successor, he picked Chandrasekaran, assisted by Mehli. Mehli later backed Chandrasekaran's second and third terms as chairman of Tata Sons. The third term, however, became contentious after Noel Tata, who succeeded Ratan Tata as chairman of Tata Trusts, opposed Chandrasekaran's reappointment.

Mehli and Chandrasekaran's relationship survived differences in personality and style. Those who know Mehli describe him as intensely loyal, fiercely independent and refreshingly blunt. Friends admire his willingness to say in a room what others prefer to whisper outside it. Critics point to a temperament that can run ahead of diplomacy. The redeeming feature, according to people who have worked closely with him, is that his anger rarely lingers.



MENDING FENCES: Mehli Mistry (left) and N Chandrasekaran appear keen to move beyond a difficult period in one of Tata Group's most significant internal relationships

Chandrasekaran is a different kind of leader. Publicly measured and understated, he has cultivated the image of a consensus-builder since arriving at Bombay House. Yet colleagues say beneath that calm exterior lies a highly competitive executive with sharp political instincts and an acute understanding of institutional power.

Then came the post-Ratan Tata era. Ratan Tata's death in Oct 2024 altered the balance of influence within Tata Trusts. Disagreements that had previously been settled privately soon surfaced within the trusts.

Mehli and fellow Tata Trusts trustees Darius Khambata, Pramit Jhaveri and Jehangir Jehangir argued that information on Tata Sons covered under Article 121 of the company's Articles of Association had not been shared with them, limiting their ability to take informed decisions. The four trustees voted Vijay Singh off the Tata Sons board.

Concerns about the emerging situation prompted a visit to Delhi by Noel, Tata Trusts vice-chairman Venu Srinivasan, Khambata and Chandrasekaran, who briefed senior government officials on governance issues within the trusts.

Mehli, who was inducted into Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT) and Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT) by Ratan Tata and remained one of his most trusted advisers, increasingly found himself at odds with the emerging power structure. He was eventually voted out of the two trusts by Noel, Srinivasan and Singh, who is also a vice-chairman of the trusts.

Among the relationships most affected was Mehli's equation with Chandrasekaran. Differences emerged over how developments within the trusts were characterised and communicated to external stakeholders, with Mehli maintaining that his interventions were driven by governance concerns. Communication between the two subsequently became infrequent.

People said Chandrasekaran later made efforts, through intermediaries and directly, to reopen channels of communication with Mehli. Mehli remained a respected figure among trustees, a prominent voice within the Parsi community and an influential presence in discussions concerning the Tata legacy.

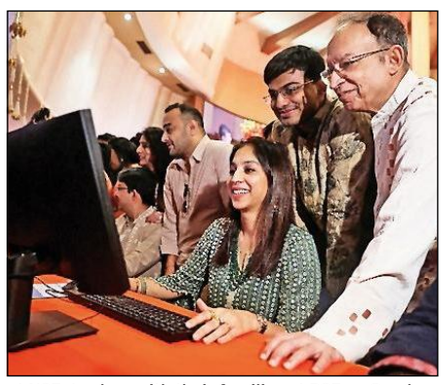
Mehli has challenged the end of his trusteeship before the Maharashtra Charity Commissioner (MCC), where the matter is pending. He, however, never withdrew his support for Chandrasekaran's stewardship of Tata Sons. In filings before the MCC, he said he had backed Chandrasekaran's reappointment for a third five-year term and was a signatory to the resolution approving it.

Chandrasekaran's second term as chairman ends in Feb 2027. His third term is linked to his continuation as a director of Tata Sons, which requires the trusts' approval at the company's annual general meeting (AGM). However, Tata Sons was unable to hold its AGM on Aug 18 after it failed to secure the requisite quorum. The impasse followed restrictions imposed by the MCC on SRTT, preventing it from joining SDTT in nominating a joint representative for quorum purposes.

Sensex, Nifty end in the red in Muhurat trading

For The First Time Since 2017, Both Indices Down On Deepavali; Halt 7-Day Winning Run

Uma Kadam



NEW YEAR, BETTER LUCK: Bell ringing ceremony at NSE; traders with their families at BSE on Sunday

Partha.Sinha@timesofindia.com

Mumbai: For the second time in 10 years, sensex and Nifty both closed lower during the special hour-long trading session on Deepavali which marked the start of Samvat year 2083, one of the Hindu calendars which is followed by the Gujarati trading community who dominate the city's share market.

In Sunday's low-volatility, low-volume trading session, sensex opened higher at 81,299 points, was up nearly 300 points from its Friday close, touched a high of 81,442 points, and then profit-taking at higher levels pulled it down to below the 81K mark. Finally, it settled at 80,999 points, down 29 points on the day.

The last time sensex had closed in the red during Muhurat trading was in 2017. Nifty on NSE also followed a similar trajectory and closed 44 points lower at 24,986 points. For Nifty too, it was the first negative close during the Muhurat session since 2017.

The age-old tradition on Dalal Street is that during the Muhurat trading session on Deepavali, domestic investors only buy stocks—even if that order is for one stock—and should never sell. So usually during the Muhurat trading session, leading indices close higher, even if with marginal gains. However, there have been exceptions. And, Sunday's session for the start of Samvat year 2083 was one of those rare ones.

The day's lower close for these indices came after a seven-session rally that added over 10% to take each of the indices to multi-month high levels. The day's modest consolidation appears to reflect natural profit-booking following an exceptional week of gains, said Ponmudi R, CEO of Enrich Money. "Rallies of such magnitude rarely sustain their momentum indefinitely without a period of consolidation, and a single symbolic trading hour was unlikely to buck that pattern."

In Sunday's session, while some of the leading large-cap stocks closed lower, pulling the leading indices lower, midcap and smallcap stocks witnessed buying. As a result, BSE's midcap index closed 0.5% higher while the smallcap index closed 1.5% higher. In turn, the aggregate market capitalisation of all the companies listed on BSE jumped by about Rs 2.6 lakh crore with the current figure at an all-time high of Rs 506 lakh crore, exchange data showed.

The day saw, going by decades-old tradition, families of brokers, traders and other market players going to the exchanges, participating in Lakshmi Puja at the bourse, and some even putting in symbolic trades.

Electronic receipts for silver, platinum soon?

Ashishkumar Chauhan, MD, NSE, said the bourse launched trading in electronic gold receipts (EGRs) on Friday, the day of Dhanteras, traditionally an occasion for buying gold, silver. On the first day itself, over 1.8 lakh EGRs were traded. Chauhan said that in future, similar products could be launched.

MARGINAL FALL: RITUAL RINGS IN SAMVAT 2083

Samvat year	Muhurat date	Sensex close	Points chg	% chg
2083	Nov 08, 2026	80,999	-29	-0.04
2082	Oct 21, 2025	84,426	63	0.1
2081	Nov 1, 2024	79,724	335	0.4
2080	Nov 12, 2023	65,259	355	0.6
2079	Oct 24, 2022	59,832	525	0.9
2078	Nov 4, 2021	60,068	296	0.5

- Dalal Street's trading community follows the Vikram Samvat calendar. Samvat year 2083 began on Sunday, on the day of Diwali
- Traditionally, during the Muhurat session, traders and investors tend to only purchase stocks, even if in small quantities, and largely refrain from selling any of their holdings
- As institutional investors are absent due to Diwali holiday, indices rarely close lower in Muhurat sessions

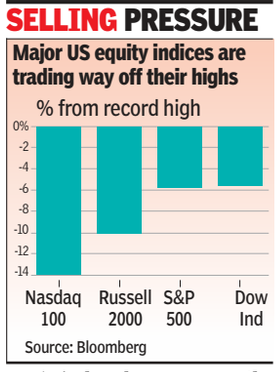
China to India: AI slump revives forgotten trades

The unravelling of the AI trade after the US midterm elections is forcing investors to rethink their Asia playbook, reviving demand for out-of-favour Chinese and Indian stocks as well as companies poised to benefit from easing inflation and trade tensions.

Aberdeen Investments favours markets powered by stronger domestic growth, including India and Vietnam, and sees upside in Chinese technology firms. Hedge fund Lotus Asset Management is long Hong Kong equity futures, while Allianz Global Investors is looking at healthcare and consumer companies.

SELLING PRESSURE

Major US equity indices are trading way off their highs



Asia has been among the hardest hit by the market fallout from the Democrats' sweep of Congress. Many of the region's biggest stocks — from Samsung Electronics Co and SK Hynix Inc to TSMC — are critical suppliers to the global AI build-out, leaving local markets especially exposed as investors brace for greater scrutiny of the industry.

"I expect investors to diversify more broadly and reduce their concentration in the AI trade," said Rajeev De Mello, global macro portfolio manager at Gama Asset Management SA. "This should be supportive of China and other markets where valuations are less demanding." India could also benefit, although its dependence on imported energy remains a headwind, he added. AGENCIES

Cheaper Scotch raises stakes for desi whisky

Supriya.Roy@timesofindia.com

Bengaluru: Cheaper Scotch is putting Indian whisky makers under pressure, even as lower import duties offer savings to companies that use it in their blends. For small distillers that make their own spirits, an imported label can now cost substantially less than a locally made bottle.

Huli's rice malt whisky was launched in Karnataka at Rs 2,650 for 750ml. By comparison, J&B Rare was priced at Rs 1,375 at Bengaluru retailer Tonique in October, according to TOI's earlier reporting. At these prices, J&B Rare cost Rs 1,275 less, or about half as much. Tonique said the price had fallen from Rs 2,835, attributing the reduction to local bottling.

"The smaller players will not be able to survive," said Huli Spirits founder Aruna Urs. Her Mysuru distillery makes spirits from locally sourced paddy and jaggery and does not import Scotch.

Arun Kumar Parasa of Unistil Alcoblends said falling Scotch prices had adversely affected the Indian single malt industry. Lower duties on bulk Scotch imported by some small and medium distilleries would benefit them "very marginally", he said.

The distinction is between making spirits locally and buying imported whisky for bottling or blending. Bulk Scotch arrives in large containers and can be bottled here or used as an ingredient in Indian whisky.

A lower import bill can help these manufacturers, while cheaper finished bottles intensify competition for other producers.

Jason Holway, senior consultant at drinks research firm IWSR, expects the price gap to narrow further. "Depending on the state, cheaper blended Scotches are expected to become more attractively priced than they used to be and may not be much more expensive than domestic premium brands using Scotch as an ingredient."

India's trade agreement with Britain cut Scotch import duties from 150% to 75%. Customs officials subsequently questioned whether certain bulk shipments qualified for the lower duty. On Nov 2, commerce secretary Rajesh Agrawal assured manufacturers that the duty benefits would be protected, with commerce and revenue officials to work on resolving the classification dispute.

An industry executive, speaking on condition of anonymity, said Indian buyers were also negotiating better purchase prices from Scotland. The executive estimated that the duty reduction could lower retail prices by roughly 8-10%, depending on state taxes and companies' pricing decisions. Distribution difficulties and advertising restrictions remained longstanding hurdles for small manufacturers, the executive added.

IWSR's figures also show the limits of India's shift towards expensive whisky. Its premium-and-above category, defined as Rs 2,899.01 or more per 750ml bottle, accounted for less than 1% of whisky consumed by volume in 2025, Holway said.

THE WHISKY PRICE PUZZLE

Big price gap: J&B Rare at Rs 1,375 costs nearly half as much as Huli whisky at Rs 2,650

Limited benefit for distillers: Lower duties on bulk Scotch offer only marginal savings to some small and medium manufacturers

Retail prices may fall further: Duty cuts could reduce Scotch prices by 8-10%, depending on state taxes and pricing decisions

Premium-and-above brands **account for less than 1%** of India's whisky consumption **by volume**

India's crypto tax could hurt blockchain innovation: Buterin

Akshay.Bhagwat
@timesofindia.com

Mumbai: India's cryptocurrency tax regime could hamper blockchain innovation and undermine the country's potential to become a hub for building core blockchain infrastructure, Ethereum co-founder Vitalik Buterin said.

Speaking on the sidelines of Devcon, Ethereum's annual global developer conference, in Mumbai, the 32-year-old Russian-Canadian programmer said the 30% tax on crypto gains and 1% tax deducted at source (TDS) on transfers could disproportionately burden smaller developers and discourage innovation. Buterin pointed to proposals in the US for a de minimis exemption on small-value transactions and tax exemptions in some countries for assets held for over a year. India needed a regulatory framework that allowed developers to experiment without excessive compliance burdens, he suggested.

He believes India can move beyond supplying developers to global technology companies. Its large Ethereum developer community, open-technology culture and govt-backed open-source initiatives offer grounds for optimism, he said.

Buterin, who proposed Ethereum in 2013 at the age of 19, helped expand blockchain's use beyond digital currency. The platform, launched in 2015, allows developers to build applications using blockchain technology.

"There is a lot of excitement from people who want to build open technology, both inside Ethereum and outside, and we wanted to engage with that," he said, explaining India's choice as the venue for Devcon. He also sees scope for blockchain to complement India's digital public infrastructure, particularly UPI and govt services.

TIMES GLOBAL

THE TIMES OF INDIA, BENGALURU | MONDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2026

LIFE SHRINKS OR EXPANDS IN PROPORTION TO ONE'S COURAGE
— ANAIS NIN

DWAYNE JOHNSON CELEBRATES MOM'S 78TH B'DAY, SAYS HIS NUMBER ONE JOB IS TO KEEP HER HAPPY

JUSTIN TIMBERLAKE SAYS A FRIEND'S STORY INSPIRED 'WHAT GOES AROUND...', A SONG HE WROTE IN 20 MINS; DENIES ANY LINK TO BRITNEY BREAKUP

Trump's $1.5tn defence budget to be blocked by Democrats

Trump: May Not Order Iran Attack If Talks Progress

Republicans' midterm defeat is crushing any remaining hopes that Congress would approve President Donald Trump's unprecedented $1.5 trillion defence budget request amid an unpopular war in the Middle East.

Democrats, who won solid majorities of both chambers of Congress on Tuesday, were already largely opposed to the 44% increase from the previous fiscal year and are now signalling they will block any efforts to push it forward.

At the same time, Republican lawmakers returning to the lame-duck session before the new Congress is seated in Jan may not be able to muster the support or political will to ram through the massive defence spending package, especially amid Pentagon's unpopular war against Iran that cost many of them their jobs.

"We must push for the development of a more realistic and sustainable approach to our national security — one that does not require a defense budget in excess of $1 trillion or one paid for with draconian cuts to critical domestic programs," Representative Adam Smith of Washington, the incoming chairman of House Armed Services Committee, said in a statement after the election.

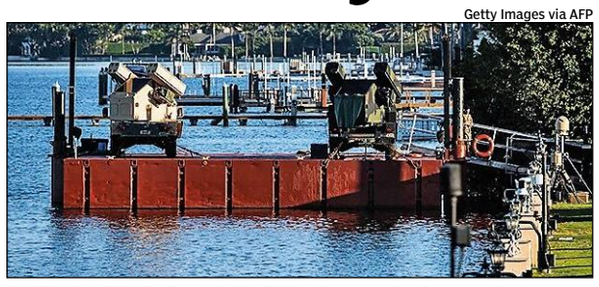
The Democratic resistance risks imperilling some of Trump's splashiest defence ambitions, including Golden Dome missile shield and his Trump-class battleship plan, and bodes poorly for defence contractors — some of which also face the prospect of congressional scrutiny over alleged conflicts of interest with the Trump administration.

Shares of major contractors, including Lockheed Martin and Northrop Grumman, fell this week as the mid-term results eroded expectations of a ramp-up in US military spending.

Trump on Sunday said he was highly unlikely to order fresh attacks on Iran as long as talks to end the conflict progress, CNN reported. "It depends on whether or not they sign a very strong agreement," CNN cited Trump as saying in a phone interview. "The answer is, highly unlikely it's going to be necessary."

Meanwhile, the US military has announced it will create a 20-member task force to find ways to disrupt land routes into Iran that it says are used for shipments of weapons and illicit materials. IRGC said US's latest bid "will fail" and will not bring about economic collapse in Iran. BLOOMBERG

Getty Images via AFP



SHIELDS ARE UP: Two US AN/TWQ-1 Avenger Air Defense Systems are deployed on the shoreline of Mar-a-Lago, US President Donald Trump's private resort, in Palm Beach, Florida on Sunday

Trump asks DOJ to look into Dems for 'threatening a lot of people'

Washington: President Donald Trump ordered US justice department on Saturday to look into Democrats for "threatening a lot of people" with impeachment and other forms of punishment, saying in a social media post that their actions amount to a "criminal act," without providing evidence.

Democratic candidates routed Trump's Republicans in midterm elections on Tuesday, giving them control of Congress starting in January. Party leaders have promised to reassert Congress' oversight of the executive branch once they are in power by holding hearings and conducting investigations into Trump administration actions.

In his post, Trump accused Democrats of sending "threatening letters to many people, all innocent." Members of Congress have released copies of letters seeking documents on matters such as donations for the large ballroom Trump is building. REUTERS

Dem leader Jeffries backs call to impeach Pete Hegseth

House Democratic leader Hakeem Jeffries backed impeaching US secretary of defense Pete Hegseth, saying he's a "hard yes" on a measure that may be introduced as soon as this week.

"The so-called Secretary of Defense has abused his power, undermined our national security and engineered this reckless and costly war of choice in Iran, which has skyrocketed prices on the American people and made the country less safe," Jeffries said Sunday on ABC's This Week. House Democrats plan to discuss the potential resolution on Tuesday when they convene for the first time since winning both chambers of Congress in the midterm elections, he said.

The effort to oust the Pentagon chief has gained steam on both sides of the aisle since the midterm elections, as the Iran war Hegseth championed helped lead to a broad defeat for Republicans on Nov 3.

Kentucky Republican Thomas Massie, who will leave Congress after a primary defeat to a challenger backed by President Donald Trump, said last week that he will "definitely" reintroduce articles of impeachment when the House reconvenes. BLOOMBERG

Bid to disrupt Diwali fest part of a broader anti-Indian campaign

▶ Continued from page 1

Congresswoman Pramila Jayapal, who has herself faced racist attacks asking her to go back to India, said, "Diwali is an important holiday and our community should feel safe to celebrate it. This hateful display has no place in our city or this country."

Suhag Shukla, executive director of the Hindu American Foundation, said she'd "laugh these losers off as clowns looking for some Instagram likes if their fellow white nationalist hadn't almost shot up a Hindu temple in Chicago".

Indeed, Lang is a familiar figure in violent far-right activism, coming to prominence after participating in the Jan 6 attack on the US Capitol. He was accused of assaulting police officers with a baseball bat and a stolen riot shield and faced 11 federal counts, including assaulting law enforcement officers, before he was pardoned by President Trump along with other people prosecuted for offences connected to Jan 6. Since then, he has built a following through confrontational demonstrations, including carrying a roasted pig outside NYC Mayor Zohran Mamdani's residence in an apparent attempt to offend Muslims and Jews.

The Seattle episode is part of a broader anti-Indian and anti-Hindu campaign that has been gathering momentum, particularly in Texas, where the rapid growth of Indian-American communities has become fodder for nativist provocateurs. In Frisco, a Dallas suburb with a substantial Indian population, public meetings have been transformed into platforms for denunciations of an alleged "Indian takeover". Residents have been branded invaders, H-1B visa holders accused of stealing American jobs, and Hindu temples, including one with a giant Hanuman statue, have been portrayed by some far-right activists as evidence of an assault on "Christian America", an idea that is implicitly backed by the prominent people in the Trump orbit.

Jake Lang, who gate-crashed the fest, is a familiar face in violent far-right activism, coming to prominence after participating in the Jan 6 attack on the US Capitol. He was accused of assaulting police officers with a baseball bat and a stolen riot shield and faced 11 federal counts

The electoral consequences of the attack on minorities, including Indian-Americans, have been significant, particularly in Texas, even though Indian-Americans constitute only around 2% of the Texas population. Initial surveys indicate that Asian-Americans (who make up around 5% of the population) and Latinos (who make up 40%) moved sharply towards Democrats in the 2026 midterms, reversing gains Trump had made with the groups in 2024.

Democrats captured the governor's mansion and a Senate seat after decades in the wilderness, delivering a stunning blow to a Republican establishment that had spent years courting Indian-American voters while increasingly accommodating anti-Indian rhetoric.

The highlight of the Republican rout was the defeat of Bo French, the Republican candidate for Texas railroad commissioner, who had used social media to complain about the presence and success of Indian Americans in Texas schools and businesses, portraying brown students at the University of Texas as evidence of a demographic problem.

While Washington state, where Seattle is located, is a Democratic bastion, and Seattle itself is a haven for liberals and progressives (Jayapal polled more than 87% of votes in the recent mid-terms to win a sixth term in Congress), community activists fear far-right extremism is now an ever-present danger across the country. HAF's Suhag Shukla noted that "having security precautions and an exit plan in place during religious and cultural events is today's reality".

Ironically, while Lang's theory of the Republican defeat is that Hindus have flipped Texas blue, in Seattle, Jayapal's Republican challenger was also an Indian-American, Nirav Sheth, who polled nearly 12.2% of votes to Jayapal's 87.4%. Apparently, MAGA's Great Replacement theory is getting complicated: even the Republicans' candidates are beginning to look like the people Lang wants deported.

Saudi turns to Syria for help to fight Houthis

Damascus: Syria is preparing to send fighters to Saudi Arabia to deploy along its border and potentially help it fight Iranian-backed rebels in neighbouring Yemen, three officials with knowledge of the plans said.

Syrian military advisers have already deployed to Saudi Arabia, but no fighters have been sent to Yemen, according to a regional officials. Officials in Saudi Arabia did not immediately respond to requests for comment.

Syria, which has a supply of battle-hardened fighters after a long civil war, has so far stayed on the sidelines.

Saudi has an array of US-supplied fighter jets and missile defences but has been unable to defeat the Houthis in past rounds of conflict.

Saudis provided funds to Syrian rebels during that country's civil war and have promised much-needed financial assistance for Syria's postwar reconstruction. AP

Houthi attack on Riyadh financial dist damages Aramco skyscraper

Yemen's Houthis on Sunday claimed an attack on the financial district of the Saudi capital Riyadh, with eyewitnesses saying they saw damage to a skyscraper belonging to oil giant Aramco.

Aramco facilities and infrastructure have been repeatedly struck by the Houthis in recent months, with tankers, refineries, storage areas and the company headquarters all targeted by the group.

"Aramco tower in KAFD has been targeted, that's the sure thing," an eyewitness told AFP, referring to King Abdullah Financial District. Two other witnesses confirmed seeing damage to the building.

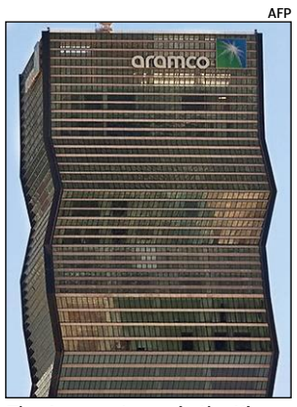
A 2022 truce that had paused fighting in Yemen's long-running conflict fell apart in July, and Saudi Arabia has since traded blows with the Houthis, who have struck Saudi airports, energy infrastructure and military sites. The Iran-backed Houthis seized the Yemeni capital Sanaa in 2014, with the Saudi-led coalition entering the conflict a year later in support of govt.

"The Yemeni Armed Forces carried out four qualitative military operations, using a number of ballistic and cruise missiles and drones," the Houthis said in an English-language statement, listing targets including the financial district, Riyadh airport, Aramco oil storage tanks and the eastern Saudi city of Abqaiq.

King Abdullah Financial District is one of the most visible manifestations of the kingdom's ongoing economic and social reform drive, with towering glass skyscrapers, high-end retail outlets and green spaces dotting the area.

KAFD is home to some of the kingdom's biggest homegrown companies and blue-chip international firms like Goldman Sachs. The headquarters of the kingdom's influential sovereign wealth fund — Public Investment Fund — and the Saudi stock exchange are also located in the heart of the district. Targeting the area, which is also home to residential buildings and a large metro station with heavy commuter traffic during the morning rush hour, would mark a major escalation by the Houthis. AFP

AFP



The Aramco tower in the King Abdullah Financial District

Hacked records show war claimed 400,000 Russians

Russia has recorded the deaths of about 400,000 of its people fighting in Ukraine since the full-scale invasion almost five years ago, according to confidential data held by the country's statistics agency, Rosstat.

The information comes from more than 11 million death certificates with accompanying details such as residence, age and where people died. The data was obtained by the Belarusian pro-opposition group Cyber Partisans and the Ukrainian hacker operation Silent Crow. It was subsequently shared with Bloomberg News and a small group of other outlets. Between Feb 24, 2022, and late Aug 2026, almost 392,700 death certificates in the data explicitly link the fatalities to the war.

President Vladimir Putin has gone to great lengths to avoid acknowledging the scale of Russian fatalities in Ukraine. BLOOMBERG

Eisenkot faces coalition challenges

▶ Continued from page 1

I am confident that my partners and I fully grasp the gravity of the hour and the urgent need to swear in a new govt," Eisenkot said in a speech upon receiving the mandate. "We possess the skills and experience necessary to steer Israel back to safe shores."

While the announcement doesn't guarantee that Eisenkot will be the next Prime Minister, Herzog's decision is another blow to Netanyahu, who lost his parliamentary majority in the election.

Eisenkot has three options: a power-sharing agreement with Netanyahu, support from Arab-led parties — something several members of his bloc do not support — or an agreement with the ultra-Orthodox parties, which demand military exemptions for their community.

At the ceremony in Jerusalem on Sunday, Eisenkot said the conditions for parties joining his governing coalition are support for Israel as a Jewish and democratic state, for its declaration of independence, for military or national service, and recognising the Hamas militant group as a terrorist organisation.

That appeared to be directed mainly at two parties that cater to Israel's Arab minority, which surged to 19 seats.

Only one Arab party, Ra'am, has ever joined a governing coalition, in 2021. Ra'am has said it will support Eisenkot, but the party does not have enough seats on its own to push Eisenkot into the majority. Breaking with decades of precedent, the second Arab-led party, the Joint List, said it will support Eisenkot from outside the coalition to end Netanyahu's grip on power. One of Eisenkot's partners, the more conservative Yisrael Beytenu party, already has said it will not join a coalition with Arab-led parties.

Israel's new members of Knesset will be sworn in on Tuesday evening. AGENCIES

Turkey's message as COP31 opens today: Electrify, recycle, skip coal

As the COP31 climate summit approaches, host nation Turkey is putting electrification front and centre, touting its renewables boom while pushing its Zero Waste agenda as a way to reduce methane emissions. But local environmental campaigners say it sidesteps the "elephant in the room" of Turkey's ongoing reliance on coal and obscures the fact it has effectively become "Europe's dumping ground" for plastic waste.

When the UN summit opens Monday in Antalya, COP31 President Murat Kurum, who is also Turkey's environment minister, will be pushing Ankara's flagship initiative to make electricity account for 35% of global energy demand by 2035. The non-binding "35 by 35" target is key to a 10-point Action Agenda that Turkey says will speed up the shift to renewables while shoring up energy security.

"This year's energy crisis has shocked us ... everyone now understands that energy that you import is energy that you do not control. Electrification is the answer," Kurum said on Thursday.

COP31's aim is "to usher in the age of electricity", he said.

Turkey has made huge advances in renewables infrastructure in recent years, with energy minister Alparslan Bayraktar on Thursday unveiling an ambitious $500 billion roadmap to electrify its economy and expand its installed wind and solar capacity fourfold to 175 gigawatts.

Yet with a third of its electricity derived from coal, no date for phasing it out and plans to expand two existing coal-fired power plants alongside its electrification drive, COP31 will be a test for Turkey's climate leadership, campaigners say.

Turkey's first nuclear plant is due to come online by the year's end, with plans to set up two more. Both Turkey and COP31 co-host Australia, which is steering the negotiations, have set targets for reducing heat-trapping emissions, but neither has adopted a national "roadmap" explicitly detailing plans to exit fossil fuels. AFP

Reuters

The venue of the UN climate change conference, known as COP31, in Antalya, Turkey

Poland calls 'far-right' gunman's shooting rampage 'terror' attack

Poland on Sunday launched a terrorism probe as mourners brought candles and flowers to Krakow's cordoned-off Main Market Square in tribute to six people killed by a gunman who authorities said was "fascinated by far-right ideologies".

The 24-year-old Polish man opened fire at random Saturday in the historic centre of the country's second city, in what Prime Minister Donald Tusk called an act of "terrorism".

A 32-year-old British man and a 51-year-old Austrian woman were among the dead, the Malopolska region's governor Krzysztof Kleczar told reporters. The four others killed were Polish. Among the 15 wounded were nationals from Germany, Portugal and Russia, an interior ministry spokeswoman said.

Three more bodies were found at the suspect's home in Ostrowiec Swietokrzyski, around 150km northeast of Krakow. Police said they were his parents and a sister. The gunman was wounded in a shootout with police and was in critical condition.

The National Prosecutor's Office said it had launched a terrorism investigation."It's one of the safest places on Earth, genuinely... I did not expect anything like this to happen to us. Our city will never be the same," said Weronika Filar (27), a Krakow resident. AFP

Swift telescope burns up, months after a robot sent to save it failed

Nasa's Neil Gehrels Swift Observatory took its final look at the sky on Oct 20, 2026, from about 275km above Earth, before re-entering the atmosphere and largely burning up on Nov 4 after a failed rescue attempt.

Nasa ended Swift's mission on Oct 23 after its orbit sank so low that atmospheric drag prevented its telescopes from holding steady. It re-entered above Indonesia, ending two decades of observations of powerful cosmic explosions.

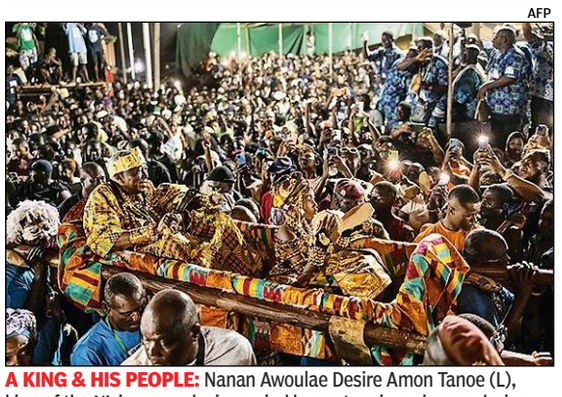
LINK, a commercial robotic spacecraft built by Katalyst Space, had been sent to grab Swift with one of three arms and boost it from about 275 kilometres to 600 kilometres. But LINK lost two of its three reaction wheels in late July. Coupled with propulsion problems, the failure sent it into an uncontrolled spin.

Engineers used thrusters to slow the rotation from about 9 degrees per second to roughly 1.5 degrees per second, Nasa said. However, this consumed propellant, and Katalyst said LINK no longer had enough to capture Swift and raise it safely. Nasa and Katalyst abandoned the attempt in Aug. LINK approached within 12 to 15km and tested its arms and electric thrusters, but never reached Swift and re-entered in Sept.

Solar activity had expanded Earth's upper atmosphere from 2024, increasing drag and accelerating Swift's descent. Nasa awarded Katalyst a $30 million contract in Sept 2025, leaving less than a year to design, build, test and launch LINK on July 3, 2026. THE CONVERSATION

WORLD DIGEST

AFP



A KING & HIS PEOPLE: Nanan Awoulae Desire Amon Tanoe (L), king of the N'zima people, is carried by porters in a pirogue during the Abissa festival in Grand-Bassam, a Unesco World Heritage site in Ivory Coast, on Saturday. Abissa is an annual festival celebrated by the N'Zima Kotoko people. The king holds customary rather than legal power: as guardian of tradition, he presides over rituals such as the Abissa, and oversees community and customary land matters

Japan man with 'grudge against society' stabs bookshop worker

Japanese police arrested a 33-year-old man who admitted to stabbing a bookshop worker in Osaka on Sunday, a spokesman told AFP, adding that the suspect said he "held a grudge against society". The man, identified as Satoshi Okamoto, allegedly used a kitchen knife to stab the worker — who called police immediately afterwards — at a branch of national chain Maruzen & Junkudo in the heart of Japan's second city. The suspect, who had remained inside the store until his arrest, admitted the stabbing and told officers, "I held a grudge against society as a whole", according to the police spokesman.

10 killed in Brazil after car falls into lake

Ten people, including five children, were killed when a car plunged into a lake near Rio de Janeiro, Brazilian officials said on Sunday. The tragedy occurred on Saturday evening in the municipality of Barra Mansa, some 140km from Rio.

Migrant boat sinks off Senegal, 21 killed

A small boat carrying migrants sank off northwestern Senegal killing at least 21 people in the latest tragedy along the dangerous Atlantic Ocean route from Africa to Europe, authorities said. The Senegalese interior ministry said in a statement that only one person had been rescued in addition to the 21 bodies recovered.

Water-bombing copter crashes; one missing

A helicopter battling Indonesian wildfires crashed into a river on Sunday as it scooped water, with two crew members rescued and one still missing. The crash in Borneo Island's South Kalimantan province was the second in several days.

China's using clean tech to shape global climate fight, growth

Beijing/Washington DC/ London: China sent $132 billion in clean technology and investment to the developing world last year, by far the largest contribution to carbon-dioxide reduction of any country. In fact, the nation's green-manufacturing juggernaut, built in part through heavy subsidies from Beijing, nearly matches the current total of grants, loans and private finance that all wealthy countries sent to poorer ones in 2024 to help fight climate change, according to a Reuters analysis.

The total included clean-tech exports and an estimated $40 billion in Chinese FDI in clean-tech projects in developing countries, based on data compiled by researchers at London School of Economics. It nearly matched the $137 billion in climate finance wealthy nations provided poorer countries in 2024 under UN pledges, according to OECD.

The figures are not directly comparable. China's contribution comprises commercial clean-energy transactions, while climate finance also supports areas such as climate-resilient agriculture and recovery from disasters. Most global climate finance takes the form of loans, a 2024 Reuters investigation found.

Reuters calculated Chinese clean-tech exports using customs data for countries OECD classifies as developing. Once deployed, last year's exports will help Global South avoid 257 million metric tonnes of carbon dioxide emissions annually, equal to France's yearly CO2 emissions, according to Lauri Myllyvirta, co-founder of Helsinki-based Centre for Research on Energy and Clean Air. This year's exports are on track to avoid 337 MtCO2 there.

China remains the world's biggest greenhouse-gas emitter because of its population, heavy industry and reliance on coal. However, subsidies that helped it dominate solar panels, batteries, electric vehicles and wind turbines have also made it a major force in cutting emissions.

Li Shuo, head of China Climate Hub at Asia Society Policy Institute, said China's manufacturing boom offered another pathway beyond rich-country finance: lowering clean-technology prices through innovation and scale until developing countries adopt it for economic reasons. "You can align it to your economic agenda," he said. Beijing has shown little interest in turning commercial strength into diplomatic leadership since Trump withdrew the US from international climate cooperation in 2025.

China's manufacturing scale has meanwhile made renewable energy cheaper across the developing world. Ethiopia banned combustion-engine car imports in 2024 largely to reduce its fuel import bill. Pakistan imported 17 GW of Chinese solar last year, roughly matching Germany's installations that year. Nearly two-thirds of China's solar-panel exports and the cells used to make them went to developing countries. REUTERS

TIMES SPORT

THE TIMES OF INDIA, BENGALURU | MONDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2026

TOP-RANKED ELENA RYBAKINA HAS WITHDRAWN FROM THE WTA FINALS FOR MEDICAL REASONS

EGYPT COACH HOSSAM HASSAN SACKED AMID CONCERNS OVER TEAM'S IMAGE & STABILITY

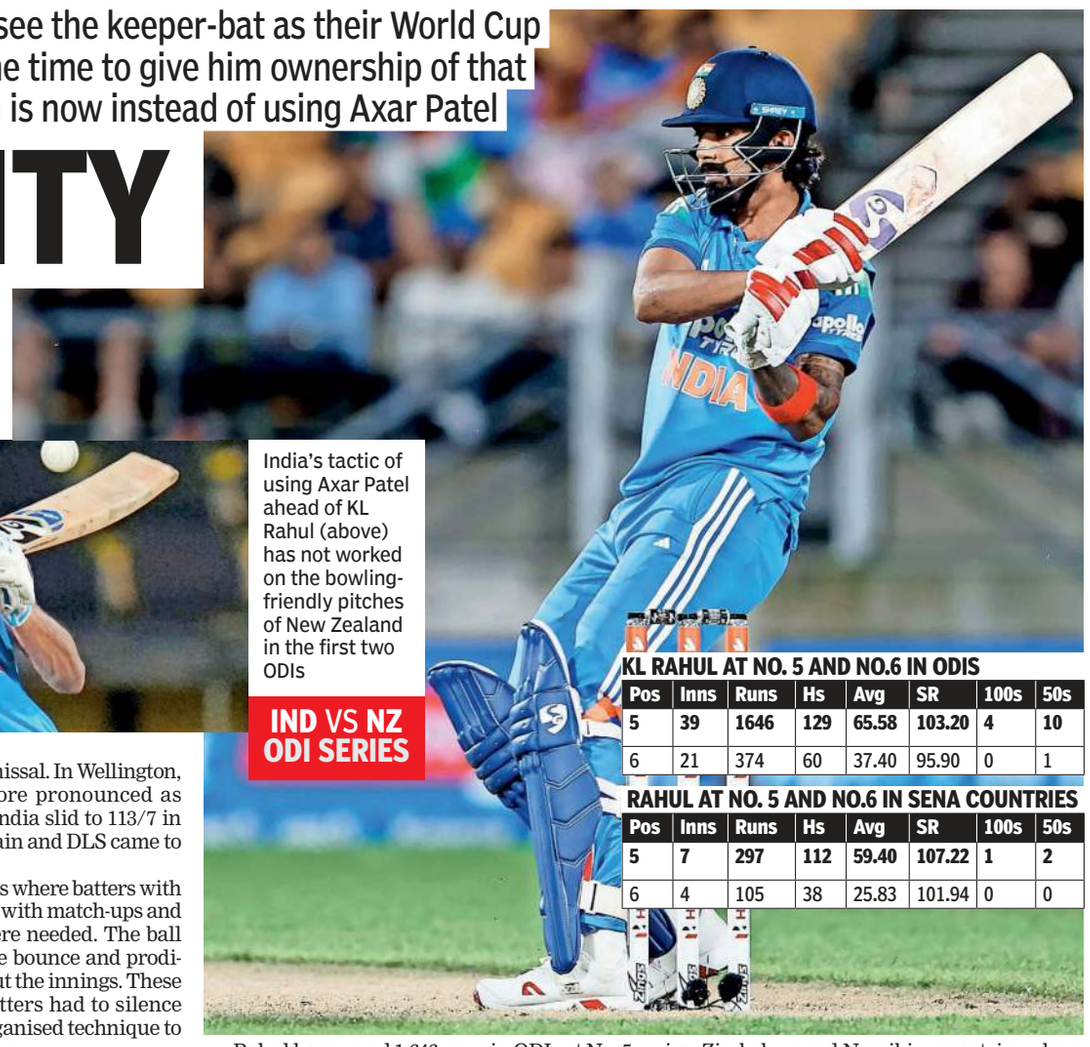
WANTED: ROLE CLARITY FOR RAHUL

If India see the keeper-bat as their World Cup No. 5, the time to give him ownership of that position is now instead of using Axar Patel

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

India's tactic of using Axar Patel ahead of KL Rahul (above) has not worked on the bowling-friendly pitches of New Zealand in the first two ODIs

IND VS NZ ODI SERIES



KL RAHUL AT NO. 5 AND NO.6 IN ODIS

Pos	Inns	Runs	Hs	Avg	SR	100s	50s
5	39	1646	129	65.58	103.20	4	10
6	21	374	60	37.40	95.90	0	1

RAHUL AT NO. 5 AND NO.6 IN SENA COUNTRIES

Pos	Inns	Runs	Hs	Avg	SR	100s	50s
5	7	297	112	59.40	107.22	1	2
6	4	105	38	25.83	101.94	0	0

There have been copious amounts of chatter on social media and many column inches devoted in newspapers discussing how the ODIs in New Zealand could act as a dress rehearsal for the 2027 World Cup in South Africa, Zimbabwe and Namibia.

Many feel the conditions in New Zealand mirror those that India may encounter in southern Africa this time next year. Judging by the bounce and movement that one saw in Auckland and Wellington in the first two ODIs, the argument may not be too far away from the truth. The Indian team management, though, may have stumbled upon an uncomfortable truth.

Their best No. 5 batter features in the XI, but he is not batting there.

For far too long in his 12-year international career, KL Rahul has been seen as Indian cricket's utility man. Someone who can fill gaps rather than command a role. He has opened, batted in the middle order, kept wickets, played as a finisher and even served as a stop-gap solution whenever injuries or team combinations demanded adjustment. In many ways, he has been used as India's "spare tyre". Someone who is always available when needed but rarely afforded the security other batters enjoy.

The irony is that whenever Rahul has been handed a clearly defined role, he has thrived. Let's take Test cricket. He was shuffled around for years until Gautam Gambhir's management backed him as a specialist opener from the 2024-2025 Border Gavaskar Trophy. The result was immediate. With clarity came consistency; Rahul's numbers improved significantly.

But they now face a similar decision in ODI cricket. The first two ODIs against New Zealand reinforced why Rahul may be better suited to No. 5 than No. 6, especially outside the subcontinent. In Auckland, India's middle-order wobbled after Virat Kohli's dismissal. In Wellington, the collapse was even more pronounced as Kohli departed early and India slid to 113/7 in pursuit of just 135 before rain and DLS came to their rescue.

These weren't conditions where batters with brute force and adventures with match-ups and left-right combinations were needed. The ball seamed, there was variable bounce and prodigious movement throughout the innings. These were conditions where batters had to silence their ego and rely on an organised technique to survive and take the team home.

Rahul's value lies there. Shreyas Iyer and Rahul were India's most convincing batters in Wellington because they could absorb pressure. Rahul's unbeaten 26 will not feature in his CV, but it was the innings India needed most.

Axar Patel, by contrast, never looked comfortable. Twice in this series he has been promoted to No. 5, and twice he has struggled to make an impact. The role made sense in India and in the Champions Trophy in UAE and the 2024 T20 World Cup, where wickets were slower, as he could hit spinners and break up a bunch of right-handers. It looks far less convincing on pitches offering assistance to fast bowlers.

The numbers prove the point.

Rahul has scored 1,646 runs in ODIs at No. 5 at an average of 68.58 with a strike rate exceeding 103. Axar averages 30.41 in the position. Overseas, Axar's average falls to under 20.

One understands why the team management likes the idea of Axar as a floater. It happened in the Rahul-Dravid and Rohit Sharma era too. India value a left-right combination to use the unequal dimensions of certain grounds. And, with Hardik Pandya unavailable to bat at No. 6, they need batting depth till No. 8. But in trying to compensate for Hardik's absence, are India compromising another position? If Hardik at No. 6 and Rahul at No. 5 is the World Cup blueprint, why wait until 2027 to implement it?

The World Cup will be played in South Africa, Zimbabwe and Namibia, countries where early starts, fresh pitches and quality seam bowling will place the middle-order under relentless scrutiny. There technique will trump theories.

India should be using this period to give Rahul ownership of the role rather than treating him as a floating solution. Despite Axar's white-ball skills being on the wane lately, he remains a valued asset. However, his optimum use could be lower down the order where his finishing ability and left-arm spin provide balance. Why burden him with the responsibility of rebuilding an innings in the event of a top-order collapse?

Rahul has adapted to what the team needed for far too long. Perhaps it is time the team adapts to what Rahul does best.

Prasidh strikes after India A pile on runs, tighten grip on NZ A

TOI

Tilak Varma celebrated his 24th birthday by scoring a fine 81 not out for India A vs New Zealand A at Lincoln

Lincoln: India A strengthened their hold on the third unofficial Test against New Zealand A with a dominant all-round display on the second day, declaring their first innings at 464/5 before reducing the hosts to 36/2 by stumps. The visitors' commanding position was built on contributions throughout the batting order, with Yashasvi Jaiswal's century from day one complemented by valuable half-centuries from Dhruv Jurel, Tilak Varma and Washington Sundar.

Resuming on 284/3, India A continued to bat with authority. B Sai Sudharsan, who began the day on 77, looked set for a century before Zak Gibson cleaned him up for a patient 88 off 255 balls. Jurel carried on confidently and completed his fifty before falling for 54, caught in the deep off a top-edged short ball.

Tilak and Ravindra Jadeja then ensured there was no let-up in scoring, taking India A past 330 by lunch. Gibson provided New Zealand A a breakthrough when Jadeja edged to slip, but that only brought Washington to the crease.

With the hosts missing injured frontline pacers Jarrod McKay and Danru Ferns, Tilak and Washington capitalised. The pair added an unbroken partnership, steadily wearing down the attack while also increasing the scoring rate after tea. Tilak struck a fluent unbeaten 81, while Washington reached 56 not out as India A declared at 464/5, looking to maximise bowling time.

The focus then shifted to India's pace attack, with Jasprit Bumrah playing his first first-class match in nearly a year. Though Bumrah bowled a probing six-over spell without reward, Prasidh Krishna made an immediate impact.

The tall quick dismissed Rhys Mariu with a delivery that jagged back through the gate before trapping Curtis Heaphy leg-before after earlier seeing a chance off the same batter spilled in the slips. Prasidh's sharp spell left New Zealand A reeling at 36/2 at the close. AGENCIES

Brief Scores: India A 464/5 dec (Yashasvi Jaiswal 102, B Sai Sudharsan 88, Tilak Varma 81*, Washington Sundar 56*, Dhruv Jurel 54; Zak Gibson 2-73) vs **New Zealand A 36/2** (Prasidh Krishna 2-12).

Badoni replaces injured Patidar in India A squad; Rinku named vice-captain

RINKU SINGH

New Delhi: Ayush Badoni has replaced Rajat Patidar in the India A squad for the ACC Rising Stars Asia Cup after the middle-order batter opted out of the 50-over tournament owing to ongoing injury concerns. The BCCI also named Rinku Singh as vice-captain of the side for the eight-team competition, scheduled to be held in Doha, Qatar, from Nov 19 to 29.

According to the BCCI, Patidar informed the board that he should not be considered for selection in the 50-over format as he continues to manage existing injuries. The men's selection committee subsequently brought in Badoni as his replacement and handed the vice-captaincy role to Rinku.

India A have been placed in Group B alongside Pakistan A, Nepal A and the United Arab Emirates A. They begin their campaign against Nepal A on Nov 20 before taking on Pakistan A on Nov 22 and UAE A on Nov 24.

The top two teams from each group will advance to the semifinals on Nov 26 and 27, with the final slated for Nov 29.

Revised India A squad: Abhishek Sharma, Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, Prabhsimran Singh (WK), Tilak Varma (Captain), Rinku Singh (Vice-Captain), Kumar Kushagra (WK), Suryansh Shedge, Shahbaz Ahmed, Vipraj Nigam, Harsh Dubey, Tanush Kotian, Harshit Rana, Prince Yadav, Arshad Khan, Ayush Badoni. AGENCIES

Hamza's hundred eclipses Rajput's ton; Pak pip India

Al Amerat: Hamza Zahoor struck a composed unbeaten century to overshadow Arjun Rajput's fighting 107 and steer Pakistan to a three-wicket win over India in a Group A clash of the ACC Under-19 Asia Cup on Sunday. Zahoor anchored the chase superbly, sharing a match-defining 107-run sixth-wicket stand with Hasnain Dar (38) as Pakistan overhauled India's target of 209 with 11 balls to spare.

"I wanted to stay till the end and I knew I could win the match for my country," Zahoor said after guiding Pakistan to a thrilling victory.

The victory lifted Pakistan to the top of the table with four points from two matches, while India remained second in the standings with two points.

Pakistan appeared in trouble at 61/5 after left-arm spinner Manal Chauhan (3/32) struck twice in quick succession. His dismissal of Abdul Qadir was particularly impressive, with the ball brushing past the outside edge before crashing into the off stump.

U-19 ASIA CUP

However, Zahoor and Dar rebuilt patiently, blunting the Indian attack through a mix of caution and calculated aggression. Zahoor was the chief architect, using his reach effectively and showing intent against both pace and spin. He was especially severe on the quicks, confidently using his feet and clearing the ropes with a stylish six over midwicket off Ishan Sood.

"I am not surprised by Hamza. I know his capability," Pakistan captain Farhan Yousaf said.

Zahoor also displayed deft touch, guiding the spinners into the gaps and keeping the scoreboard moving. Even after Dar departed at 168, leaving Pakistan needing another 41 runs, Zahoor remained unfazed. Fittingly, he sealed the chase and completed his century with a crisp cover-driven boundary off Kavya Patel.Earlier, Rajput's lone-handed century rescued India after a top-order collapse. Having elected to bat, India slumped to 42/4, losing skipper Lakshya Raichandani, Aaryavir Sehwag (22), VK Vineeth and Yashbardhan Chauhan cheaply.

Rajput steadied the innings through partnerships of 44 with Anvay Dravid (10) and 64 with Chauhan (11), dominating both stands with positive strokeplay. His 107 carried India to a respectable total before late contributions from Kavya Patel (23) and Sood helped the side reach 208 in 46.3 overs.

For Pakistan, Ali Raza (3/37), Rizwanullah (3/24) and Niqab Shafiq (3/42) shared the bowling honours,striking in regular intervals, while Mohammad Sayyam picked up the final wicket to fall in India's innings. AGENCIES

Brief scores: India U-19 208 in 46.3 overs (Arjun Rajput 107; Ali Raza 3/37) lost to Pakistan U-19 209/7 in 48.1 overs (Hamza Zahoor 100*; Manal Chauhan 3/32) by three wickets.

ACC

HEROIC KNOCK: Pakistan U-19 batter Hamza Zahoor (left) exults after hitting the winning runs and completing his century against India U-19 in the Asia Cup match at Al Amerat on Sunday

Sandpapergate: Khawaja says he did not throw teammates under the bus

Sydney: Former Australia opener Usman Khawaja has defended his explosive claims that the entire Australian team bore responsibility for the 2018 Sandpapergate scandal, insisting he was not trying to implicate or "throw anyone under the bus".

Ahead of the release of his autobiography, Khawaja reignited debate around the controversy by saying responsibility extended beyond the three men punished by Cricket Australia: Steve Smith, David Warner and Cameron Bancroft. "When I mentioned it was all of us, that's implying that whether we like it or not, we're all responsible for what happened together as a team," Khawaja wrote in an Instagram post on Sunday. "We need to take that collectively. That is all."

The 39-year-old, who retired earlier this year after 88 Tests, stressed that the trio who served bans were not the real victims. "I haven't thrown anyone under the bus," he said. "These three guys (Smith, Warner and Bancroft) took the blame for all of us. They're the victims ... people telling them that they're cheats, getting nailed by the crowd. Public humiliation."

Khawaja had alleged that Australia also used similar tactics during the preceding Test in Port Elizabeth. His remarks drew a strong response, with former coach Darren Lehmann rejecting suggestions that there was widespread knowledge of the plan, while Cricket Australia said it remained comfortable with the findings of its original investigation, which concluded only Smith, Warner and Bancroft were aware. Khawaja also explained why he waited eight years to speak and claimed he wanted to do so in 2018 after the suspensions but was persuaded otherwise by Smith.

"Smudge being the man and leader he was, he talked me out of it. He wanted to take the blame," Khawaja said. AGENCIES

Hodge century puts Windies on brink of series sweep

Sylhet: Kavem Hodge struck an unbeaten 140 as West Indies tightened their grip on the second and final Test against Bangladesh, reaching 345 for three in their second innings and leading by 315 runs at stumps on the fourth day in Sylhet on Sunday.

Resuming on 7 for no loss, West Indies rarely looked troubled. Opener Brandon King made 61 and shared an 85-run stand with Joshua Da Silva (36) before Taijul Islam broke through.

King brought up his sixth Test fifty but fell to Mehidy Hasan Miraz with the score on 119.

Bangladesh briefly sensed an opening after claiming quick wickets, but Hodge and debutant Kevin Wickham steadied the ship.

Brief scores: West Indies 356 & 345/3 (Kavem Hodge 140*, Kevin Wickham 78, Brandon King 61; Taijul Islam 2-118) lead Bangladesh 386 by 315 runs. AGENCIES

Bancroft keen to move on from Khawaja's claims

Perth: Cameron Bancroft is focused on moving forward and letting his performances do the talking after former teammate Usman Khawaja reignited debate around the 2018 ball-tampering scandal.

Khawaja, in extracts from his autobiography Sabr, claimed sandpaper was discussed and used during the second Test against South Africa at Gqeberha before the infamous Cape Town Test. He also alleged that Bancroft, then only six Tests into his career, volunteered to tamper with the ball.

Responding to the renewed scrutiny, Western Australia coach Beau Casson said Bancroft was keen to leave the episode behind and concentrate on his cricket. "The situation's a long time ago. I think he's keen to move on and let his bat do the talking," Casson told reporters. "The way he's handled it over the past couple of weeks, and over the years gone by, speaks volumes. He certainly sets the example of how to go about being a professional cricketer."

Bancroft served a nine-month ban, alongside Steve Smith and David Warner. While Smith and Warner rebuilt lengthy international careers, Bancroft's return was brief, with his last appearance for Australia coming during the 2019 Ashes tour. It remains unclear whether he will respond publicly to Khawaja's latest claims. AGENCIES

Norris take pole in rain-hit qualifying

McLaren's outgoing world champion **Lando Norris** grabbed pole position for the Sao Paulo Grand Prix with a brave and well-judged drive in Saturday's rainswept qualifying at Interlagos. The 26-year-old Briton outpaced Mercedes' George Russell by 0.204 seconds to claim his third consecutive pole at Interlagos in a storm-hit session that lasted two-and-a-half hours.

FORMULA ONE

New world champion Kimi Antonelli was third for Mercedes, but he will start Sunday's race from the front row as Russell faces a five-place grid penalty for taking new power-unit components.

It is the 20th pole position of Norris's career and his third in succession in Brazil.

"It's been a long day," said Norris. "It's been a great qualifying, to be on pole again here, two years in a row! Different conditions to last year, but I am very happy."

Russell was disappointed not to take pole after being told by Mercedes to ease off on his final push lap. "Congrats to Lando, but it was definitely my pole lap. We should have finished the lap."

Charles Leclerc was fourth for Ferrari but also faces a penalty of 10 places for taking a new engine. Racing Bulls' Liam Lawson was fifth ahead of Audi's Nico Hulkenberg. AFP

Anuj becomes India's 100th grandmaster

IM From MP Gets Direct Title By Winning ASEAN Plus Tournament

Amit.Karmarkar@timesofindia.com

Pune: Anuj Shrivatri has become India's 100th grandmaster. The 22-year-old from Katni, Madhya Pradesh, and India No. 76 underlined the virtue of opportunism by finishing first in the 7th ASEAN Plus Individual Open Chess Championship Governor Henry S Oaminal Cup in the Philippines on Sunday. A direct GM title was on offer for the player who finished first in this nine-round Swiss League tournament. The requirement of three GM norms over 27 games (including the one in a Swiss League event) and touching Elo 2500 was not needed. Anuj's peak rating was Elo 2483 this June.

CHESS

Many players worldwide have attained the GM title this way, as some tournaments are given this privilege by the world governing body, FIDE. Divya Deshmukh also became India's fourth female GM by doing well in the Women's World Cup, not through the more conventional and arduous route of rating and norms.

x/ChessBase India

TON MAN: Anuj Shrivatri

Fourth seed Anuj (Elo 2450) had lost to home player Arca Karlo in the first round - like Vidit Gujrathi's opening defeat in the successful campaign of FIDE Grand Swiss that gave him a Candidates berth in 2024 - and then won six of the next eight rounds to tally 7 points. He finished half a point ahead of Vietnamese GM Nguyen Duc Hoa. The top prize was $3,000.

The tournament pitted only two players among the top 10 seeds against Anuj. He did not face any higher-rated player, posting a performance rating of 2586 (a normal GM norm requires 2600) and a possible rating gain of 15 points to his existing Elo of 2450.

India is not the first country to attain a milestone of 100 GMs. Russia (more than 250), USA, Ukraine and Germany have reached a century of GMs. Soviet Union had produced more than 90 GMs when it was dissolved in 1991.

Ayush Sharma, Neelash Saha, Nitish Belurkar, Mohd Imran, and Ajay Parvathareddy were probably better placed to become India's 100th GM, as they had attained either the norms or the rating requirement. But unfancied Anuj stole a march to etch his name into the record books as India's 100th GM. More than 2000 players have been awarded a GM title in the history of the sport. Anuj became an IM way back in 2019. The ASEAN Plus tournament needed four GMs and six IMs in each round for the first-place player to earn a GM title.

Usha complains to IOA electoral officer

New Delhi: Indian Olympic Association (IOA) president **PT Usha** has lodged a complaint with the Electoral Officer alleging that former archer Dola Banerjee violated the Model Code of Conduct by circulating a WhatsApp message soliciting votes for a panel of four candidates in Monday's Sportspersons of Outstanding Merit (SOM) elections.

POLITICKING

In her complaint, Usha objected to a WhatsApp message circulated through an account bearing Banerjee's name, seeking support for the 'New Bharat Panel' and specifically asking voters to elect four named candidates, along with their ballot serial numbers and roll numbers.

Usha cited Clause 1.9 of the Model Code of Conduct, issued on Oct 30, which states that the promotion of a candidate shall exclude any form of publicity, including the use of new media or social networks. She contended that the circulation of the message amounted to targeted solicitation of votes through social media and appeared to fall within the ambit of the clause.

Usha has urged the election authorities to examine the communication, establish the circumstances under which it was created and circulated, and seek an explanation from the concerned persons. PTI

SNAP SHOTS

Taniya settles for silver

India's Taniya had to settle for a silver medal at the Youth Olympic Games after going down to China's Zhao Min in the women's 75kg beach wrestling final in Dakar, Senegal, on Saturday. Taniya lost 1-2 to Zhao on Victory by Points (VPO), despite taking an early 1-0 lead.

Niveditha bags bronze: Niveditha Nair clinched the individual bronze medal in the women's 25m standard pistol event at the ISSF World Championship 2026 in Doha, Qatar, on Sunday. Tamil Nadu's Niveditha finished on the podium with a score of 567-13x.

Alcaraz wins Paris Masters: Carlos Alcaraz avenged his loss to Ben Shelton in the US Open last eight as he edged the American 7-6(5) 7-5 to win the Paris Masters on Sunday, clinching his ninth ATP 1000 title. Alcaraz controlled the contest from the baseline, while Shelton was left frustrated by an erratic forehand. Alcaraz saved six break points and failed to convert two, as the first set remained deadlocked until the tiebreak, where Shelton overshot the baseline three times on his forehand, allowing the Spaniard to take the set. The two traded breaks in the second set before Shelton overshot two lobs to lose the final game.

Liu wins Hong Kong Open: American Claire Liu defeated Alexandra Eala 6-3, 6-0 to win the Hong Kong Tennis Open on Sunday. The 26-year-old Liu, playing her second final after Rabat, Morocco in 2022, needed just 1 hour, 33 minutes to wrap up her first WTA title without losing a set over her five matches.

Ferrer to join Ruud's coaching set-up: Spain's former world number three David Ferrer will join Casper Ruud's coaching team for the 2027 season, the Norwegian said on Saturday.

Messi wins second MLS Golden Boot: Inter Miami's Lionel Messi won his second consecutive MLS Golden Boot award on Saturday after the defending champions took second place in the Eastern Conference with a wasteful 3-3 draw against Charlotte on the final day of the regular season.

Tenerife bid tearful farewell to De Miguel: Thousands of mourners gathered at Tenerife's stadium on Saturday to bid farewell to striker Jesus de Miguel, with captain Enric Gallego struggling through tears to honour a teammate who died aged 30 after suffering a cardiac arrest following a collision during a match last week.

SUNDERLAND SHOCK FOR CHELSEA

Liverpool Cruise Past Palace In Premier League; Serie A Leaders Lazio Drop Points

Chelsea suffered a shock 1-0 defeat at Premier League strugglers Sunderland, while Liverpool got back on track with a 3-1 win against lowly Crystal Palace on Sunday. Xabi Alonso's Chelsea arrived at the Stadium of Light hoping to bolster their bid to qualify for the Champions League via a top-four finish.

Instead, they departed redfaced after an embarrassing loss to third-bottom Sunderland,

FOOTBALL ROUND-UP

who celebrated a league victory for only the second time this season. Fifth-placed Chelsea have already been beaten four times in 10 league matches under former Real Madrid boss Alonso.

Chelsea were rocked in the 36th minute when Enzo Le Fee converted a penalty after Brian Brobbey was up-ended by Levi Colwill. Blues boss Xabi Alonso was furious that Chelsea were not given a foul on Cole Palmer in the build-up to the spot-kick.

Liverpool had been beaten by Arsenal in the Premier League and Fenerbahce in the Champions League before arriving in south London, sparking pointed questions about Andoni Iraola in the former Bournemouth manager's first season in charge at Anfield. But Alexis Mac Allister headed Liverpool in front at Selhurst Park from Dominik Szoboszlai's cross after 40 minutes.

Florian Wirtz bagged Liverpool's second with a composed finish from Bradley Barcola's cross in the 54th minute. It was Wirtz's first league goal this season and only the second in all competitions for the inconsistent German playmaker this term. Alexander Isak finished off Wirtz's pass in the 89th minute to wrap up fourth-placed Liverpool's much-needed victory after a two-game losing streak. It was Liverpool's fourth consecutive away league win this season.

On Saturday, Manchester City slumped to a third consecutive Premier League defeat as Liam Delap's double lifted Nottingham Forest out of the relegation zone with a 3-1 win at the City Ground.

AP

ON TARGET: Enzo Le Fee (second left) scored the winner for Sunderland

REAL MADRID HAVE IT EASY

Real Madrid cruised to a 3-0 win at struggling Valencia in LaLiga on Saturday as Federico Valverde, Arda Guler and Kylian Mbappe found the net. It was Real's eighth consecutive win, another confident, efficient display building on their El Clasico victory at the Camp Nou two weeks ago.

NAPOLI HOLD LAZIO

Serie A leaders Lazio dropped points for just the second time this season in Sunday's 1-1 draw away to struggling Napoli, while AC Milan climbed into the top four with a 2-1 win at Genoa. Davide Frattesi gave the Romans a deserved lead but Napoli drew level early in the second half through an Alfonso Pedraza own goal. **Select results: EPL:** Brighton 2 (Gomez 15, Gross 42-pen) bt Brentford 0; Crystal Palace 1 (Nketiah 90+5-pen) lost to Liverpool 3 (Mac Allister 40, Wirtz 54, Isak 89); Sunderland 1 (Le Fee 36-pen) bt Chelsea 0. **Saturday:** Nottingham Forest 3 (Cunha 6, Delap 18, 73) bt Manchester City 1 (Cherki 52). **Spanish league:** Elche 0 lost to Real Betis 2 (Riquelme 81, Bartra 89). **Saturday:** Valencia 0 lost to Real Madrid 3 (Valverde 28, Guler 36, Mbappe 75). **Italian league:** Napoli 1 (Pedraza 48-og) drew with Lazio 1 (Frattesi 28). Saturday: Roma 3 (Hermoso 27, Walukiewicz 30-og, Mora 58) bt Sassuolo 0. AGENCIES

Indian pair falter in final

Chennai: India's Vaishnavi Adkar and Rutuja Bhosale had to settle for a runners-up finish at the WTA 250 Chennai Open after going down 2-6 0-6 to the Swiss combination of Simona Waltert and Naima Karamoko in a one-sided women's doubles final here on Sunday.

The Indian pair struggled to match the quality and intensity of their opponents, with Karamoko almost im-

CHENNAI OPEN WTA

pregnable at the net and Waltert providing solid support from the baseline to seal the title in convincing fashion.

Karamoko's quick hands, sharp anticipation and ability to finish points at the net made life difficult for the Indians, who also hurt their chances with a string of unforced errors and an inability to convert crucial points in closely-contested games. The Swiss pair made an aggressive start, with Waltert striking confidently from the baseline, particularly with her backhand, while Karamoko dominated the exchanges at the net. PTI

Southern Blues, BOI storm into quarters

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: Southern Blues men's and women's teams claimed contrasting wins to reach the quarterfinals of the State Association Cup here on Sunday. In the men's category, they edged past Dakshina Kannada 64-61, with Adi top-scoring with 20 points. However, the Southern Blues cruised in the women's section, thumping BCYA 59-15. Among men, Bank of Baroda also made the cut. **Results (Pre-quarterfinals): Men:** DYES Bangalore 73 (Manoj 11, Kushal 10) bt Appaiah BC 46 (Pranshu 11) HT: 48-25; Southern Blues 64 (Adi 20, Venkat 11) bt DK 61 (Shailen 12, Amruth 12) HT: 31-25; Young Orion's SC 105 (Shashank 22, Ajin 19, Sugan 13) bt Hoop 7 BC 63 (Samarth 31, Pranesh 16) HT: 44-26; GST & Customs 78 (Pratyanshu 23, Dheeraj 16) bt HBR BC 63 (Rohan 24, Sanketh 16) HT: 45-30; Mandya 80

BASKETBALL

(Shashank Gowda 18, Shashidhar 16, Shashank Rai 15) bt Vivek's SC 74 (Thyagi 33, Anshul 13) HT: 33-38; MNK Rao Park BC 83 (Ujwal 22, Dhruva 18) bt BOSCH 64 (Arvind 25, Sudeep 13) HT: 39-41; Bank of Baroda 63 (Anilkumar 14) bt Bangalore Vanguards 32 (Naveeth 10) HT: 36-12; JSC 73 (Sanketh 24, Rohit 18) bt Chikkamagalur BC 59 (Rehan 13, Nishanth 13, Chanakya 10) HT: 34-35. **Women:** DYES Vidya Nagar 57 (Deepika 22) bt YMMA 18 (Ankita 8) HT: 32-8; Bangalore Vanguards 67 (Aditi 17, Mahek 14, Priyanka 12) bt Mounts Club 34 (Nidhi 13) HT: 40-19; Rajmahal BC 56 (Aadya 21, Sanvi 16) bt Vimanapura SC 55 (Konika 12, Samyukta 11) HT: 25-25; Beagles BC 64 (Ayra 21, Anidhya 10) bt Yelahanka New Town BC 23 (Deeksha 14) HT: 29-8; Southern Blues 59 (Nidhi 16, Anvitha 12) bt BCYA 15 (Tharunya 13) HT: 35-9; JSC 62 (Sanjana 18, Deblina 13) bt Mysore B 42 (Kushi 15) HT: 31-21; Mysore A 46 (Kusuma 16, Yashaswini 10) bt Mandya 30 (Anushka 9) HT: 31-11.

Rajveer & Karan sparkle in Rajajinagar Cricketers' win

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: Rajveer Mehta's unbeaten double ton helped Rajajinagar Cricketers register a dominant 187-run win over City Gymkhana in the KSCA U-14 inter-club cricket tournament here recently. Riding on Rajveer's 168-ball 201 (14x4) and Karan Gowda's ton (105, 120b, 6x4), Rajajinagar scored 329/3 in 50 overs.

In reply, City Gymkhana were restricted to 142/9 in 50 overs, with Sankalp Yadav, Mohith BV, and Karan Badaradinni each scalping two wickets.

Brief scores: Rajajinagar Cricketers: 329/3 in 50 overs (Rajveer Mehta 201n.o (168b, 14x4), Karan Gowda 105 (120b, 6x4)) **bt City Gymkhana: 142/9 in 50 overs** (Gagan Maiya 42, Bhairav Gowda 30; Sankalp Yadav 2-21, Mohith BV 2-18, Karan Badaradinni 2-28).

Bangalore United CC (1): 138 all out in 49 overs (Niranjan SR 2-27, Unmukt Das 3-30, Vanij Periwal 2-26) **lost to Vijaya CC, Malur: 139/5 in 38 overs** (Viren Sancheti 43, Karthik VM 35n.o; Charith B 2-5, Alston Ron Albuquerque 2-28).

Coles CC: 228/6 in 50 overs (Rajveer Rai 51, Dwit Kukarvadiya 100n.o (131b, 8x4); Rishaan Shetty 2-34) **bt Whirlwind Cricketers: 147 all out in 49.2 overs** (Thanmay P 44; Darsh Patel 2-12, Saksham Agarwal 2-22, Vihaan Mittal 3-22).

South End SC: 49 all out in 21.1 overs (Md Reza 4-20, Jeet D 4-10) **lost to Young Lions Club: 51 for no loss in 5.4 overs**.

Century Cricketers: 151 all out in 47.1 overs (Pothula Reddy 52; Ayush 2-18, Advay Mehrotra 2-15, Arnav Deepak 3-17) **lost to Wilson Garden CC: 154/3 in 28.5 overs** (Bhuvan Kundur 43, Kian Bajaj 31n.o).

Bangalore SC: 265/8 in 50 overs (Ojas Jha 54, Kriday Taneja 53, Panav Chawla 35; Akshay Anandan 4-33, V Dharsan 2-60) **bt Jolly Cricketers: 84 all out in 34.3 overs** (Aarush Jangi 2-15, Abhyudaya Nandy 2-26, Vishist PJ 5-3).

Palar SC, Kolar: 197 all out in 49 overs (Abhinav HS 61, Kotarvedu Reddy 30; Avik Jha 2-23, Pratham Kulkarni 3-35, Daksha G 2-40) **bt Mount Joy CC: 81 all out in 29.4 overs** (Gaurav V 4-14, Kotarvedu Reddy 2-32, Sohan Gowda 2-8).

Herons CC: 300/5 in 50 overs (Nikhil Jayaram 137n.o (144b, 14x4), Aryan Chauhan 39; Chiranthan Srinivas 2-54, Nehal Bagmane 2-22) **bt Friends Union CC (2): 101 all out in 40.3 overs** (Syed Ulla 3-29, Moksh Parekh 4-6).

Jayanagar Cricketers: 191 all out in 46 overs (Sampreeth Rathod 37, Poonish Harihar 51, Rithuraaj M 32; Gauraansh Mehta 2-35, Aditya Gorthi 2-35, Avneet 3-32) **bt Friends Union CC (1): 152 all out in 29.5 overs** (Ngurang Tamser 69; Irfan S 3-49, Vishwas CH 3-30, Nikil 3-39).

Yankees CC: 77 all out in 29.1 overs (Akshay Raghavendra 2-31, Lakshya Singh 2-18, Thanush M 3-6, Siraboina Ganapathi 2-7) **lost to Social Cricketers: 78/3 in 13.3 overs** (Prathviraj Choudhary 35n.o, Avirat Saha 2-25).

Engrades CC: 189 all out in 49.1 overs (Bhuvan Prasad 38, Shashank Reddy 40; Abhay Reddy 2-22, Saiful Ajam 2-37, Vishwas S 3-31, Agasthya Gowda 2-33) **bt Chintamani SA: 146 all out in 47.4 overs** (Nikhil Shankar 3-23, Vaibhav Jain 2-22).

Efficacy clinches Rajyotsava Cup

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: Top favourite Efficacy (Trevor Patel up), from Sulaiman Attaollahi's yard, won the opening plum of the season, the Rajyotsava Cup at the winter races here on Sunday. Darius Byramji-trained Fine Silver (Ashhad Asbar up) claimed the Bangalore City Police Cup.

The November Plate 1200M: Anzac Parade 1, Victoria Moon 2, Hold Your Breath 3, Amazing Storm 4. 2l, 2-3/4l, 1-1/4l. T: 1:16.48.

BENGALURU RESULTS

Tote: Rs 53 (W). 13, 13, 11 (P). Fc: Rs 334. Q: Rs 204. Shp: Rs 36. Thp: Rs 43. Trinalla: Rs 299 & 118. Exacta: Rs 1809 & 1339.

The Gomos Plate 1400M: Quattro 1, Irish Coffee 2, Lux Aeterna 3, Felisa 4. 10l, 3/4l, Snk. T: 1:28.59. Tote: Rs 13 (W). 10, 16 (P). Fc: Rs 30. Q: Rs 16. Shp: Rs 19. Thp: Rs 25. Trinalla: Rs 31 & 20. Exacta: Rs 74 & 43.

The Udupi Plate 1400M: Knotty Imperador 1, Glorious Strides 2, Mister Brown 3, Circle Of Dreams 4. 4-1/2l, 2l, 2-1/2l. T: 1:28.14. Tote: Rs 60 (W). 26, 13, 11 (P). Fc: Rs 288. Q: Rs 228. Shp: Rs 35. Thp: Rs 35. Trinalla: Rs 1175 & 460. Exacta: Rs 1664 & 551.

The TB Hanumantharaj Memorial Trophy 1200M: Hazel 1, Doncaster Belle 2, Joondalup 3, All Attraction 4. Not Run: Deep Respect. 2-1/4l, 1/2l, 1-3/4l. T: 1:15.77. Tote: Rs 177 (W). 28, 10, 17 (P). Fc: Rs 1024. Q: Rs 257. Shp: Rs 30. Thp: Rs 42. Trinalla: Rs 4330 & 7423. Exacta: c/o (Rs 18125).

The Rajyotsava Cup 1400M: Efficacy 1, Galahad 2, Emphatic 3, Ricardo 4. 2-3/4l, Nk, Snk. T: 1:27.66. Tote: Rs 31 (W). 10, 18, 13 (P). Fc: Rs 174. Q: Rs 106. Shp: Rs 40. Thp: Rs 51. Trinalla: Rs 1337 & 1194. Exacta: Rs 5049 & 6491.

The Bengaluru City Police Cup 1400M: Fine Silver 1, Tyche 2, Shining Path 3, Sigrid 4. Not Run: Knotty Spirit. 2-1/2l, 2-1/2l, 8-1/2l. T: 1:28.94. Tote: Rs 40 (W). 14, 13, 29 (P). Fc: Rs 121. Q: Rs 45. Shp: Rs 36. Thp: Rs 63. Trinalla: Rs 607 & 427. Exacta: Rs 2502 & 1038.

The Malaprabha Plate 1200M: Jade Mountain 1, El Rey 2, Big B 3, Darrington 4. 1-1/2l, 2l, 3-1/2l. T: 1:15.17. Tote: Rs 32 (W). 12, 26, 11 (P). Fc: Rs 119. Q: Rs 50. Shp: Rs 43. Thp: Rs 54. Trinalla: Rs 253 & 154. Exacta: Rs 4402 & 2594.

The Jog Falls Plate 1400M: Fortissima 1, Valor Queen 2, Kaori 3, Joyful Spirit 4. 1-1/4l, 1-3/4l, 3/4l. T: 1:29.64. Tote: Rs 49 (W). 20, 11, 14 (P). Fc: Rs 216. Q: Rs 41. Shp: Rs 35. Thp: Rs 48. Trinalla: Rs 701 & 394. Exacta: Rs 82110.

Jackpot: Rs 70,05,637; **Runner-up:** Rs 1120; **Mini Jackpot**: Rs 6204; **First Treble**: Rs 1942; **Second Treble:** Rs 1115.

This newspaper is published by Manjeet Singh Dhami from Bennett Coleman & Co Ltd., Elixir Chancery Building, 1st, 2nd and 4th Floor, 135, Residency Road, Shanthala Nagar, Bengaluru – 560025 (Phones: Office: EPABX - 080-42200000, Editorial: 080-46787878) on behalf of Bennett Coleman & Co Ltd., edited by Neelam Raaj and printed by Sekar S at Bennett Coleman & Co Ltd., The Times of India Press, No. 9/10/11-A, 4th Main, KIADB Bommasandra Industrial Area, Anekal Taluk, Bangalore - 560 099 (Ph : 080-22899999). Regd office: Dr. D.N. Road, Mumbai - 400001. All rights reserved. Reproduction in whole or in part without written permission is prohibited.
REGD. NO. CPMG/KA/GPO-31/2003-05, RNINO. 45466/85

Take a break, reimagine life goals to overcome midlife meltdown

To help readers cope with their anxieties in these stressful times, TOI's ***Talk it Out*** *series brings expert counsellors to answer your mental health queries. This week's advice is from consultant psychiatrist* ***Dr Susan Nivia***

I'm a 41-year-old man from Ahmedabad, married with two kids. As a working professional with a decent income, I have my own house and no obligations. My parents live with me but have their own income and savings. At times, I don't feel like working anymore as one question keeps coming to mind: How much is enough to have a comfortable life? Often, I also get thoughts of quitting everything and just vanishing. I know I won't ever do that, but how can I stay positive and keep working energetically at a stage when the purpose of life seems unclear? Please help.

— Anonymous

Image: AI

One often thinks about the purpose of life but it's a question that comes more to mind when life has become routine, with the same tasks being performed almost in auto mode. A much-cherished life is all about having memorable experiences. Though every moment of life cannot be exciting, a few such moments can go a long way in making for an interesting life. Start with 'life projects'. These are small projects that you can work towards keeping a target duration of a few weeks, a few months, or even a year. It can be as simple as trying to work on your fitness goals, home renovations, family vacations to exotic places, or hobbies that you have long forgotten. Living a full life starts with doing things that will benefit your physical and mental health. Once you start these 'life projects', you will want to then look at how you can contribute towards society, which will turn these into 'lifeterm projects'. Building memorable moments requires a conscious effort on your part too. Try to break out from the auto mode loop, life will feel fulfilling again.

I feel that I haven't really lived my teenage years. I know it's common to get overwhelmed or have FOMO, but that's not the issue in my case. I'm a 17-year-old girl, an introvert who only speaks when comfortable. I was never really forced into playing sports or having hobbies. This led me to a point where I take part in no extracurricular activities. And I have not really experienced a lot of so-called 'teenage experiences', not because my parents are strict but because I'm so closed off myself. I don't know if there is something wrong with me. I love my parents and truly appreciate everything they have done, but I feel that maybe if I move out of the city for university and live on my own, I will thrive. Is it wrong to feel that I'm truly free when I am alone?

— Anonymous

In therapy, there is a skill called 'opposite action', which is all about doing the opposite of what a negative emotion urges someone to do. For example, when one feels anger, portraying a calm demeanour instead of acting out the anger helps in defusing it and controlling the outcome of the initial negative emotion. As you have identified wanting to be alone, you should perhaps try to do the opposite by joining group activities and engaging with your peers instead. The goal here is not to turn into an extrovert but to grow and make valuable connections with others, while also having your alone time to reflect and plan your future. I can see that by wanting to leave the safety net of your family and move into university life, you are already trying to do the opposite of something you may have recognised as affecting you. Being introverted is not the problem; shutting yourself out to opportunities that can bring about an exciting future is.

I study in class 11 with physics, chemistry, math and computer science as my subjects. I am an average student. School goes on till 1.30 pm and I have coaching classes from 4 till 8 in the evening. At the end of the day, I am pretty exhausted and have little time for homework or self-study. I want to go abroad (either Japan or South Korea) for higher studies after school, so I am very eager to learn new languages. I also want to take guitar lessons but I am not able to manage these other pursuits since the stream I chose is already so time-consuming. What can I do to include all this in my day, leaving enough time to prepare for scholarships abroad and exams, without compromising on school and coaching?

— Anonymous

With so many activities trying to crowd your day, prioritisation is key to getting a proper schedule in place. As you are at a very important juncture of your education, study time would be your topmost priority. At the same time, your mind will benefit from a creative pursuit such as learning the guitar. A dedicated study time with breaks for guitar lessons, while also starting on basic language courses in a single day can be quite a burden for you. So, instead of looking at daily creative pursuits, keep your weekdays for your studies and coaching classes while on the weekends, you can do dedicated guitar classes and language courses. And during small study breaks on weekdays, you can keep strumming the guitar chords you have learnt and also keep some language flash cards that you can skim through. That way, you would cover your academic course work, prepare for scholarships and opportunities abroad, and also get to do the things you love.

TalkitOut

WANT SOME ADVICE?

Sharing can help your recovery so write to us at **talkitout@timesofindia.com** with your question, name and place. But if you wish to stay anonymous, do indicate that in your email.

You can also visit bit.ly/TOITalkItOut or scan this QR code to send in your concern.

THE SPEAKING TREE

Asht Lakshmi: Prosperity, Within & Without

The eight Lakshmis form a complete picture of a well-lived life. Their inner meaning points us towards contentment, generosity, poise, love and wisdom, while their outer meaning reminds us that wealth, family, strength and success are worthy aspirations, writes SURAKSHIT GOSWAMI

Goddess Lakshmi is among the most widely worshipped deities in Hinduism and is revered in eight forms known as Asht Lakshmi. Each form has two dimensions. Its inner meaning lies in qualities that make a blessing truly meaningful, while its outer meaning is reflected in tangible blessings devotees seek: wealth, grain, progeny and victory. Together, these dimensions suggest that true abundance lies not only in what we possess but also in who we become.

1. Adi Lakshmi: Primordial Goddess

Spiritual and true meaning: The realisation 'I am not the body, I am the soul, and I have existed from the beginning.' This awareness of one's timeless nature is the deepest wealth, and tradition holds that a guru is essential to arrive at it.

Gross meaning: The primordial Lakshmi, often identified with Maha Lakshmi and Vishnu's consort in Vaikunth. She is the source from whom all other forms arise, offering foundational grace and divine support.

2. Dhan Lakshmi: Goddess of Wealth

Spiritual and true meaning: Being content with what one has, without ever having to depend on others for money. It encompasses *jnan dhan,* wealth of spiritual knowledge and richness of love.

Gross meaning: Financial sufficiency and economic prosperity. Devotees pray to her for security and an end to money worries.

3. Dhanya Lakshmi: Goddess of Grain and Harvest

Spiritual and true meaning: A person blessed by her is neither miserly nor reluctant to spend on food or personal well-being, and finds joy in giving. Wealth that is neither enjoyed nor shared has not been truly received.

Gross meaning: Agricultural bounty, nourishment, and food security. She ensures that granaries and kitchens remain full.

ARUNDYUTI DAS BASU

4. Gaj Lakshmi: Elephant-Lakshmi

Spiritual and true meaning: Dignity of personality and steadiness of mind. Like the elephant, such a person is calm and unhurried, commanding attention through his presence.

Gross meaning: Royalty, power, and dignity, symbolised by the elephant, traditional companion of kings.

5. Santan Lakshmi: Goddess of Progeny

Spiritual and true meaning: May you be spiritually reborn through the Guru's words, and, having received the Guru's wisdom, become a source of spiritual awakening for others through your own words. May you nurture a spiritual family.

Gross meaning: Associated with lineage and fertility, this manifestation blesses childless couples and parents who regard raising children as a sacred duty. Devotees pray to her for healthy, long-lived children and family harmony.

6. Veer Lakshmi (Dhairya Lakshmi): Goddess of Courage

Spiritual and true meaning: Strength, enthusiasm and good health, along with courage to overcome inner enemies such as laziness, desires, and vices.

Gross meaning: Valour, bravery, endurance, and the fearlessness needed to face life's hardships.

7. Vijay Lakshmi: Goddess of Victory

Spiritual and true meaning: The ability to overcome adversity and negativity. Real victory is staying undefeated within, in any circumstance.

Gross meaning: Triumph and success at every stage of life, including spiritual pursuits. She blesses those who stay positive in the face of adversity.

8. Vidya Lakshmi: Goddess of Knowledge

Spiritual and true meaning: Literature, music, art, true scriptures, satsang (good company), meaningful conversation, and Self-knowledge, all embraced and lived. True luxury is a cultivated and enriched mind.

Gross meaning: Material comfort, ease, and the fulfilment of worldly wishes, and relief from financial difficulty.

The Asht Lakshmi offer a complete vision of a well-lived life. Each manifestation points towards an inner virtue: contentment, poise, love, courage, resilience and wisdom. Those who embrace spiritual and material dimensions could ask not 'What may i receive?' but, 'What may i become?' ■

Bangalore Times
MONDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2026
ADVERTORIAL, ENTERTAINMENT INDUSTRY PROMOTIONAL FEATURE
Any feedback related to stories in Bangalore Times? Mail us @bangalore.times@timesofindia.com

Pics: Karthikeyan Sairam

SHIVARAJKUMAR

'Appaji's childlike glee as he watched the fireworks remains my favourite Deepavali memory'

(left to right) Geetha Shivarajkumar, Shivarajkumar and Niveditha Shivarajkumar with their pet dog

Shivarajkumar stands in front of a photo of Dr Rajkumar and says, "I still put out a chair to watch fireworks, just as Appaji did," as he speaks about celebrating Deepavali

Madhu Daithota

Growing up in Chennai in the early 1970s, Shivarajkumar aka Shivanna's fondest Deepavali memories revolved around his appaji, Dr Rajkumar, and their close-knit family. From a home bustling with 22 cousins to elaborate family feasts and fireworks, the actor looks back at celebrations that continue to hold a special place in his heart. Excerpts:

> Every celebration evolves with time, and I am happy that my family has always remained at its centre
> - Shivarajkumar

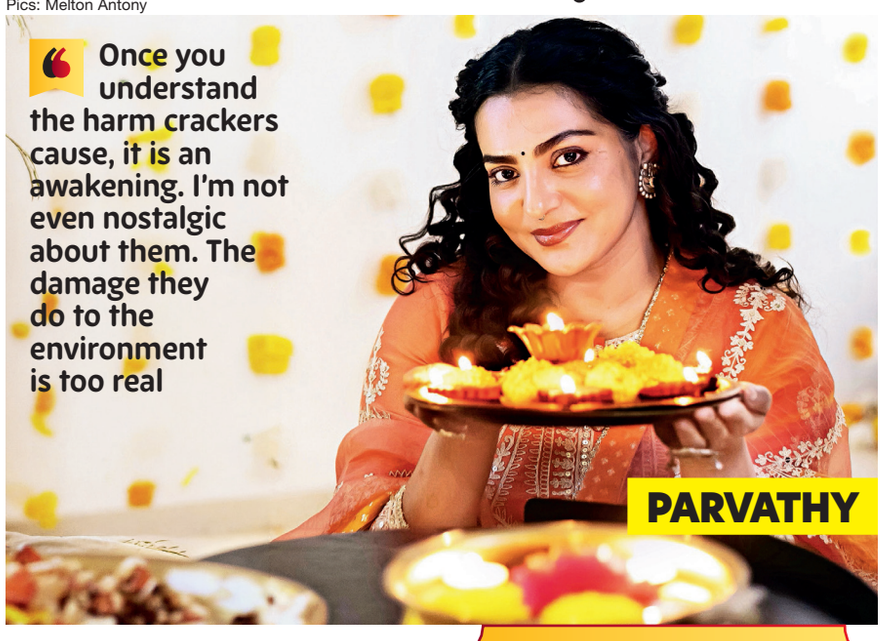
A HOME FILLED WITH FAMILY, FRIENDS AND FESTIVE CHEER

Shivanna tells us, "Besides my parents and siblings, we also had 22 cousins living with us, so our Chennai home was always bustling with activity. Around Deepavali, it wasn't just our home that came alive; the entire street would take on a different hue."

CONTINUED ON 4

'I decided it was time for me to create the Diwali traditions for my house'

Pics: Melton Antony



> Once you understand the harm crackers cause, it is an awakening. I'm not even nostalgic about them. The damage they do to the environment is too real

PARVATHY

Anna Mathews

Parvathy has been shuttling between Mumbai, Hyderabad and Kerala for shoots, script hearings and promotions. With the success celebration of *Pradhama Dhristya Kuttakkar*, held in Kochi, coinciding with Diwali, it has given her an opportunity to continue a tradition she started last year: taking charge of the festivities at home, with her parents and closest friends.

"Earlier, I would simply go to someone's home and join in their celebrations, or leave it to my parents to carry on the family traditions during festivals. Subconsciously, I suppose I felt that celebrations were something families did. But last year, I thought, maybe I could create my own little traditions, plan things and celebrate with my parents, my dog Dobby, and my friends," she says.

'DIWALI IN DELHI ARE SEARED INTO MY MEMORY'

Parvathy has vivid childhood memories of celebrating Diwali in Delhi, with *diyas*, *rangoli* and sweets. "Diwali, for me, has always been the festival of lights. I was spellbound by it as a child. I have very clear memories of being three years old in Delhi, when my father was working there. These days, the excitement around crackers is minimal, but the *rangoli*, *diyas*, boxes of sweets and dinner parties are all seared into my memory. And when we came home for the holidays, the Thrikarthika festival, with its lamps, would remind me of Diwali. After we returned to Kerala, I continued my education at Kendriya Vidyalaya and grew up celebrating Diwali and Holi. So, when I get to celebrate Diwali now, it feels like I'm recapturing those moments, albeit on a smaller scale."

'I've started a tradition that I found really fun'

Last year, Parvathy also got together with friends to start a Diwali ritual that she hopes to make a regular feature of her celebrations. "I wasn't filming last year, so I got to do something fun. We had *chai*, *bhel puri* and *sev puri*, and arranged for someone to apply *mehendi* for everyone. I remember how much joy that brought me, and I wanted to do it again. So, I'm arranging it this year too, though sadly, I can't have *mehendi* applied to my hands because of continuity issues," she says.

'I WANT TO INCORPORATE ALL THE LITTLE TRADITIONS'

While her "activist bone" makes her firmly anti-cracker, Parvathy is a traditionalist when it comes to the festivities. "Though I'm not good at it myself, I admire people who can make rangoli. I love *matki diyas* and the ritual of lighting them, as well as making *kheer* at home. Even the less glamorous things, like giving the house a thorough clean, feel heartwarming because they lead to putting up garlands along the walls. I may not be religious, but I love seeing my mom get ready for *puja*, so I make sure that is arranged too," she says.

As a pet parent, she says she is "completely detached from crackers". "Once you understand the harm they cause, it is an awakening. I'm not even nostalgic about them. The damage they do to the environment is too real," she says.

Parvathy poses with diyas and deepavali decorations

Pics: @metcostumeinstitute

Met Gala 2027 theme

Less controversial, more 'extraOrdinary'

After the controversy around the Galliano theme, the Met opts for extraOrdinary as its new theme

Aakanksha Ahire

Two months after The Metropolitan Museum of Art and John Galliano jointly announced in August that the planned exhibition dedicated to the designer would not go ahead, anticipation had been building around what would replace it.

The wait ended last week, when The Met unveiled its Spring 2027 Costume Institute exhibition, titled *"extraORDINARY: Fashion and the Poetics of the Everyday"*. Moving away from the couture grandeur often associated with the Met Gala, the new theme turns the spotlight on the beauty of the everyday, exploring how designers transform familiar garments such as jeans, T-shirts and puffer coats into extraordinary creations.

Basically (pun intended), you could walk into an exhibition of this stature wearing nothing more than a simple white T-shirt and jeans, and fit right in!

CONTINUED ON 4

Background

The Costume Institute's original plan for 2027 was to stage a retrospective of John Galliano's work. However, the proposal faced opposition from donors, politicians and Jewish leaders in New York City. The criticism centred on Galliano's 2011 conviction in France over antisemitic and racist remarks. Some donors reportedly approached Met executives and threatened to withdraw their financial support if the retrospective went ahead. Following the backlash, Galliano issued a statement that read, "After much reflection and discussion with all those involved, I have decided, with great sadness, that it is best for the exhibition not to take place at this time..."

AUGUST 6

Will this be the Met Gala's most controversial theme yet?

John Galliano's retrospective comes 15 years after his conviction for antisemitic and racist remarks

Aryahi Jain

Bhavitha Mandava's Met Gala look this year, designed by Matthieu Blazy, appeared to be a casual denim-and-sweater ensemble but was actually an intricately crafted trompe l'œil creation

A deconstructed sweatsuit with a dramatic gold train from Jun Takahashi's Fall/Winter 2024-25 collection for Undercover

A backwards-draped tan trench coat framing a metal breastplate from Jonathan Anderson's Loewe Spring/Summer 2022 collection

A metallic silver jacket and a plaid skirt reimagine everyday staples in Anrealage's Fall/Winter 2024 collection

> The cancellation of the Galliano show was disappointing for everyone involved... I committed myself to this (theme) really quickly because it brings up ideas of value and consumption and resourcefulness
> – Andrew Bolton, Met's curator in charge in a statement

UP TO DATE | WHAT'S #TRENDING AND WHY

Ramayana makers issue warning against theatre recordings

The makers of Ranbir Kapoor and Yash-starrer *Ramayana: Part 1* have warned moviegoers against recording the film inside cinema halls and circulating unauthorised footage online. Citing Bombay High Court orders dated November 2 and 6, they said offenders would face criminal, civil and contempt proceedings without further notice. They have also urged people to delete any such footage already shared on social media.

A night of fashion, music and talent at Bennett University

(L-R) Ujjwal was crowned Mr Bluemoon 2026 and Anaika Khandelwal won Miss Bluemoon 2026

For freshers at Bennett University, Bluemoon 11.0 was more than just another campus event, as it became a stage for emerging talent, fashion showcases and a night of live music and dancing. Now in its 11th edition, the event featured a three-round Talent Hunt, including personalised introduction reels, a paired runway segment and an elimination round. A panel of judges, including Anjali Nandi, Femina Miss India Bihar 2026, evaluated the contestants. Ujjwal was crowned Mr Bluemoon 2026, Anaika Khandelwal won Miss Bluemoon 2026, Kaushiki Shivraj received Best Dress, and Pankaj Chahar clinched Best Walk.

Punjabi singer Gurnazar got the crowd singing along, while DJ Praveen kept the dance floor buzzing well past midnight, making Bluemoon 11.0 a memorable start to campus life for the new batch.

— Sampada Sharma, BA Mass Communication student, BU

Jeans, bubble wrap & T-shirts could rule the Met's red carpet

CONTINUED FROM 1

The Metropolitan Museum of Art has announced its Spring 2027 Costume Institute exhibition, extraORDINARY: Fashion and the Poetics of the Everyday, exploring how everyday garments and objects can be re-imagined as high fashion. Think blue denim, white T-shirts and puffer jackets, alongside paper, plastic, metal and bubble wrap, transformed into new creations.

TOO ORDINARY, NOT REALLY!

The Costume Institute offered a glimpse of the theme through archival looks shared on Instagram, including a deconstructed sweatsuit with a dramatic gold train from Jun Takahashi's Undercover Fall/Winter 2024-25 collection; layered flannel plaids, striped slip dresses and combat boots from Marc Jacobs' Perry Ellis Spring 1993 'Grunge' collection; and a tan trench coat draped backwards to frame a metal breastplate from Jonathan Anderson's Loewe Spring/Summer 2022 collection. These are among the historical looks expected to feature in the exhibition.

The looks highlight how designers have turned everyday clothing and familiar objects into works of art. Exploring the extraordinary possibilities of the mundane, the exhibition will open on May 9, 2027, following the Met Gala on the preceding Monday.

JEANS & T-SHIRTS COULD BE THE STARS OF MET GALA 2027

Andrew Bolton, the Costume Institute's curator in charge, said he hopes visitors will attend the exhibition wearing their own versions of jeans, T-shirts and jackets. "I want visitors to leave looking differently at the clothes they arrived in... With a greater sense of what is worth noticing, valuing and caring for," he said. That said, the gala's dress code is still under wraps, although Bolton's statement could hint at a dress code inspired by the exhibition's theme. According to *The New York Times*, the exhibition will feature 200 to 230 pieces, around 30 to 40 per cent of which will come from the museum's own collection, with the rest donated or loaned by fashion houses.

The internet has its say

While some netizens have called the theme boring, others see it as a sign of a recession. Some have questioned why the museum did not instead honour another major fashion name the world has recently lost. While critics and fashion commentators are curious to see how everyday clothing will be reimagined, they are also questioning whether the theme is a creative choice or an attempt at reputation management, with some suggesting the Met is playing it safe following the backlash over its original plans.

@gracewells.studio
This feels like a depressing punishment for backlash at Galliano. Like a pouting child refusing to change out of their pajamas.

@jesusalcaladice:
From Galliano to Gap

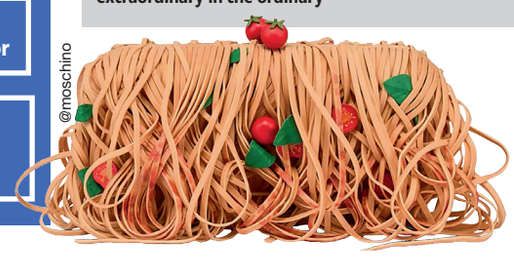
@vantacreate
Recessssionnnnn indicator

@cjmkirk
So terrified by a whiff of controversy, you went for jeans and tshirts. It's just the literal opposite of Art.

@hoda_kova

Cate Blanchett's 2024 red-carpet look by Swedish sustainable label Hodakova is a striking example of turning everyday objects into high fashion. Her halter top and suit, embellished with antique silver spoons, echo the Met's Spring 2027 theme of finding the extraordinary in the ordinary

@moschino



Moschino transformed pasta, an everyday food staple, into a quirky high-fashion statement bag

LEISURE

SUDOKU CHALLENGE

Level: Medium

			9					
	5	6	3				2	
				7		1		3
	6			9		2		
1								9
		7		5			1	
5		3		1				
	4				2	3	6	
					5			

HOW TO PLAY

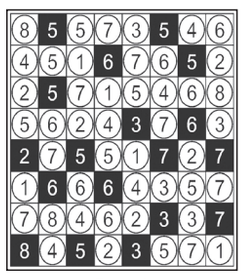
Fill in the grid so that every horizontal row, every vertical column and every 3x3 box contains the digits 1-9, without repeating the numbers in the same row, column or box.You can't change the digits already given in the grid. Every puzzle has one solution.

TIMES HITORI

HOW TO PLAY

1. A number may appear just once in each row or column. Eliminate repeat numbers by darkening cells. (see example)
2. Darkened cells must never be adjacent in a row or column.
3. Unmarked cells must create a single continuous area, undivided by darkened cells.
4. Every time you darken a cell, you can automatically circle its vertical and horizontal neighbours, which means they cannot be eliminated.
5. Any cell "sandwiched" between neighbours of the same value can be circled. (e.g. 6 (4) 6)
6. A "triple" is a special case of sandwich. Circle the centre cells, and darken the ends. (e.g. 6 6 6)

1	1	1	5	2	3	4	4
3	5	1	9	2	6	3	4
3	4	1	3	4	2	5	7
4	3	5	7	9	3	2	1
6	6	9	6	1	7	4	3
2	8	2	4	2	9	1	6
3	7	6	1	3	5	7	8
5	9	1	6	5	1	8	2

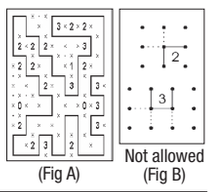


Example

LOOP THE LOOP

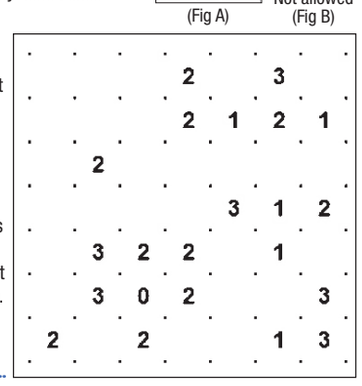
RULES

- Connect adjacent dots with vertical or horizontal lines, creating a single loop (Fig A).
- Crossovers or branches are not allowed (As shown by dotted lines in Fig B).
- Numbers in the puzzle indicate the number of lines that should surround it, while empty cells may be surrounded by any number of lines.
- You can't draw lines around zeroes.
- Each puzzle has just one unique solution.



(Fig A)

Not allowed (Fig B)

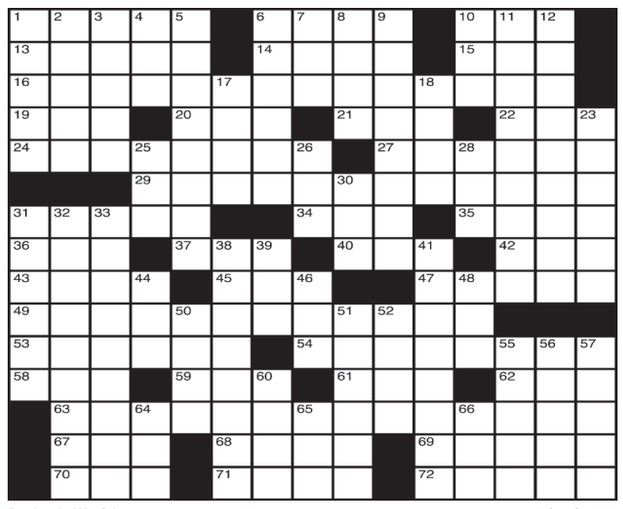


HOW TO BEGIN:

Example (Fig A) -
Begin with the zero next to 3. Since no lines can be drawn around zero, mark crosses around it, as shown. Now there is a cross in one space around 3. So we know the three lines of 3 can only be drawn in the remaining three spaces. Next, these lines can only be extended in one direction each. Continue, using the same logic.

Hints: Keep eliminating possibilities by marking crosses in spaces between dots where a line isn't possible, i.e., if you have already completed required lines or where a line extension may create a branch or cause a deadend **(Fig B)**.

THE DAILY CROSSWORD



By Justin Werfel — 09/11/2026

ACROSS
1 Confess (to)
6 __ at the moon
10 23-Down fig.
13 Extract, as minerals from soil
14 Gobi Desert continent
15 Egg cells
16 Avian scavengers with red heads
19 Tread the boards
20 Feathery neckwear
21 Smitten Kitchen blogger Perelman
22 Some QB protectors
24 Neatens up text boxes, say
27 Hangry plea
29 Demo release
31 Secretly included on an email
34 Pop singer Carly __ Jepsen
35 "The Incredibles" supersuit designer Mode
36 Portuguese phone greeting
37 Health retreat
40 Recipe amt.
42 Addams cousin
43 Gambling town near Tahoe
45 One of eight on an octopus
47 Supple
49 Paperwork for leisure travelers
53 Nonprofit journalism agcy.
54 Most civil
58 Rotten
59 20-vol. lexicon
61 Karate rank
62 Dallas City Hall architect I.M. __
63 Part of speech that requires a direct object
67 Enter a race
68 Benefit
69 Baking tool with holes
70 Actress Adams of "The Muppets"
71 Fairy tale opening
72 Screen found in many a living room, or what 16-, 29-, 49-, and 63-Across can be called

DOWN
1 "I do" location
2 Card with two pips
3 "Knives Out" protagonist
4 "Grody!"
5 Hitchcock film with nonhuman villains
6 Capital of Cuba
7 Columbus sch.
8 Untamed
9 Penalties for missing due dates
10 __ favor: "please," in Spanish
11 Indulged too much
12 May, in June
17 Bear who steals "pic-a-nic" baskets
18 __ Eats: DoorDash rival
23 Upper house of Congress
25 Cell service initials
26 High-end camera, for short
28 Language ending
30 Large cask
31 Running tally of drinks at a pub
32 Pharaoh played by Elizabeth Taylor
33 Puzzle
38 Collects $200 in Monopoly
39 Class with easels
41 Least fancy
44 Valuable excavation find
46 Team VIP
48 Real or ideal suffix
50 Cry of victory
51 Antiseptic fluid
52 Czech or Pole
55 Olympic swords
56 Start a tennis rally
57 Neighbor of Nepal
60 Gorilla researcher Fossey
64 Indefinite amount
65 Nervous twitch
66 "The Fresh Prince of Bel-Air" aunt, familiarly

Saturday's Puzzle Solved

A	P	R	E	S	S	K	I				P	E	A	R
G	O	E	S	I	N	O	N			G	A	T	W	A
A	P	P	S	T	O	R	E		W	A	N	T	O	N
T	H	A	I	S		E	P	S	O	M	S	A	L	T
H	I	V	E		C	A	T	T	R	E	E			
A	T	E		F	U	N		A	L	P	A	C	A	S
			S	R	S		E	L	D	O	R	A	D	O
S	E	R	I	E	S	P	R	E	M	I	E	R	E	S
T	R	A	D	E	W	A	R		A	N	D			
E	M	P	E	R	O	R		A	P	T		M	B	A
			D	I	R	E	C	T	S		C	U	R	T
B	L	O	O	D	D	R	A	W		T	A	M	A	L
R	E	D	O	E	S		C	O	L	U	M	B	I	A
A	V	E	R	S			T	O	E	B	E	A	N	S
D	I	S	S				I	D	E	A	L	I	S	T

©2026 Tribune Content Agency, LLC 07/11/2026

SCRAMBLE

Rearrange the letters in the four word jumbles, one letter to each square/circle, to make four ordinary words

DEEOR
ACILL
EEXDNP
AIMGWW

HOW TO PLAY

Now arrange the letters in the circles to form the answer to the riddle or to fill in the missing word as indicated

___ on the negative simply contributes to its ___ - Shirley MacLaine (8,,5)

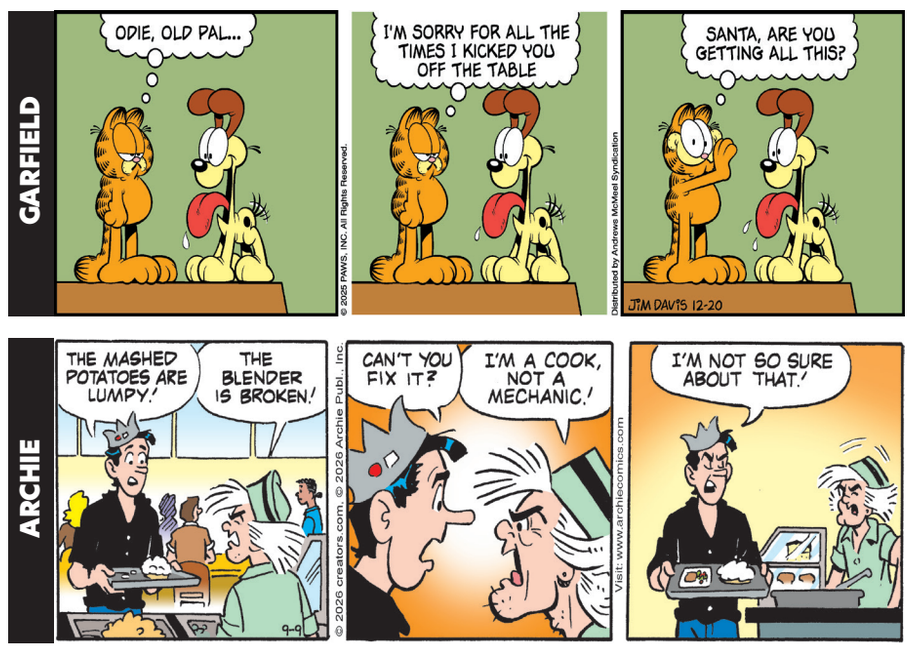
EVENTS

WORKSHOPS

Baking Pizza And Traditional Art: Indulge in a vibrant experience where traditional art meets with joy of baking at Hobby Ghar in Seshadripuram on November 9 from 12 pm onwards.

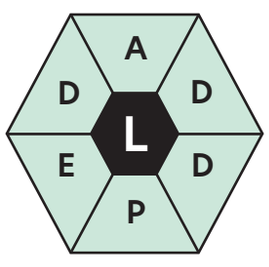
DIY Diwali Lamp: Learn to make your own lamp for this Diwali at Brik Oven in Whitefield on November 9 from 1 pm onwards.

Email us at bangalore.times@timesofindia.com



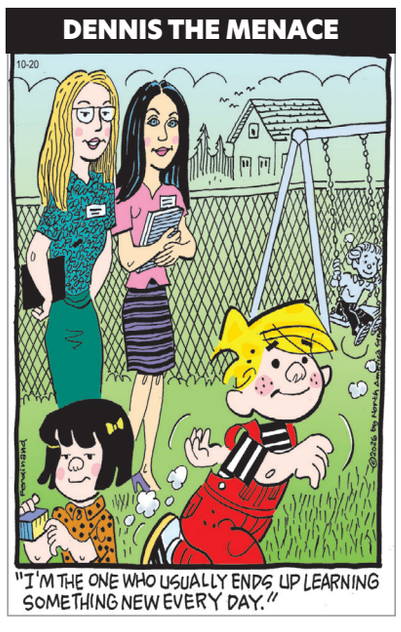
SPELLATHON

Today's Ratings:
12-average | 14-good | 16-outstanding



How many words of four or more letters can you make from the letters shown in today's puzzle? In making a word, a letter can be used as many times as it appears in the puzzle. Each word must contain the central letter. There should be at least one seven letter word. Plurals, foreign words and proper names are not allowed. British English Dictionary is used as reference.

DENNIS THE MENACE



RNI NO. KARENG/2007/20799
VOLUME No. 20; ISSUE No. 309
This newspaper is published by Manjeet Singh Dhami from Bennett Coleman & Co Ltd., Elixir Chancery Building, 1st, 2nd and 4th Floor, 135, Residency Road, Shanthala Nagar, Bengaluru – 560025 (Phones: Office: EPABX - 080- 42200000, Editorial: 080-46787878) on behalf of Bennett Coleman & Co Ltd., edited by Kavya Christopher and printed by Sekar S at Bennett Coleman & Co Ltd., The Times of India Press, No. 9/10/11-A, 4th Main, KIADB Bommasandra Industrial Area, Anekal Taluk, Bangalore - 560 099 (Ph : 080-22899999). Regd office: Dr. D.N. Road, Mumbai - 400 001. All rights reserved. Reproduction in whole or in part without written permissionis prohibited.

ARIES: When it's time to decide, you will do so with conviction. You won't vacillate, worry or regret your choice. You'll stand by your decision, and that's that.
TAURUS: Your influence on the situation at hand will be more mental than practical. Don't underestimate its power. Helping people think differently is perhaps the most important leadership skill.
GEMINI: If you suspect someone is waiting for your signal to make a move, you're right. Tune into your body, especially the areas where you hold tension. Recognising physical stress is the first step towards releasing it.
CANCER: Looking back at your failures will only fuel self-doubt, while dwelling on your accomplishments may make you complacent. Don't look back; focus on what lies ahead.
LEO: You'll take a risk and experience the exhilaration of putting yourself on the line. Whether you win or lose is almost irrelevant. Your life will improve either way. Without risk, there is no reward.
VIRGO: You have faith, love and freedom on your side. Act on what you believe in, give wholeheartedly and make full use of your rights and privileges
LIBRA: You admire people who stay connected over the years, recognising the adaptability this requires. People change with every phase of life, becoming different versions of themselves. To be loved through all those changes is a gift.
SCORPIO: Jealousy, when channelled constructively, can reveal what you truly want. When those pangs arise, take them as a sign that what you desire is within reach. The question is: what will you do to make it happen?
SAGITTARIUS: What's broken can be fixed, especially when it comes to relationships. Get serious about your work and avoid relying on people who lack the technical expertise to assist you. You deserve a team that is well matched to the task.
CAPRICORN: Those who have prospered may be quietly looking for someone with whom to share their good fortune. You'll stand out, not because you are in need, but because you know how to achieve so much with relatively little.
AQUARIUS: You'll set something right today, whether it's a past wrong, a mess that needs clearing or something that was overlooked. Make amends, put things in order and move on with a clear conscience.
PISCES: Sometimes the best adventures don't unfold in the wide world outside but within you. There are valuable treasures to discover when you have the courage to explore your inner world.

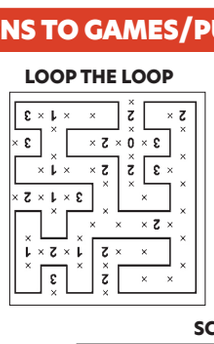
FINOLEX FORTUNE
finolexpipes.com | 1800 200 3466
Book **Anupam V Kapil** for appt/written predictions:
9822042295 or anupamvkapil@gmail.com.
See what the stars have in store for you - according to your moon sign.

SOLUTIONS TO GAMES/PUZZLES

TIMES SUDOKU

6	2	8	4	3	5	7	9	1
9	4	1	7	8	2	3	6	5
5	7	3	6	1	9	4	8	2
4	9	7	2	5	3	8	1	6
1	3	2	8	6	4	5	7	9
8	6	5	1	9	7	2	3	4
2	8	9	5	7	6	1	4	3
7	5	6	3	4	1	9	2	8
3	1	4	9	2	8	6	5	7

LOOP THE LOOP



TIMES HITORI

5	9	6		1	8	2		
7	6	1	3	5		8		
2	8		4	9	1	6		
6		9	1	7		3		
4	3	5	7	9	2	1		
	1	8	6	3	4	5	7	2
3	5	1	9	2	6		4	
	4		3		5	7	2	1
1		5		3	4			

SPELLATHON

Words: Erode, lilac, expend, wigwam
Answer: Dwelling on the negative simply contributes to its power - Shirley MacLaine

SCRAMBLE

addle, addled, dale, deal, lade, lead, leap, paddle, PADDLED, pale, paled, peal, pedal, plea, plead, pled

Small plates, big Diwali energy

Pics: @iStock

Paneer tikka

A festive spread of delicious dishes, bringing together vibrant flavours and culinary traditions for everyone to savour and enjoy

Mini churros

Shruti Paniker

A plate in one hand, a drink in the other, and nowhere to put either: festive hosting in a compact home can quickly become a balancing act. That's where a thoughtfully planned, small-plate menu can make room for conversation, movement and second helpings. Think familiar flavours in manageable portions, a few clever serving stations and enough advance preparation to let the host join the party.

Give every dish a different role

A table full of fried snacks can feel repetitive, however varied their shapes. Balance crisp tartlets with grilled *paneer*, refreshing *chaat* and a creamy miniature dessert. Mint, lime, pomegranate and tangy *chutneys* can add freshness between richer bites. Chef Pooja Sachdeva says, "Not everything needs to be fried or cheese-based to feel indulgent. Seasonal ingredients, citrus, pomegranate, mint and thoughtfully used spices can bring brightness to a festive spread."

Count portions, not just dishes

Chef and culinary consultant Nishant Choubey suggests approximately 10-14 bite-sized portions per adult for a two-to-three-hour gathering serving as the main meal. Check dietary requirements, include substantial options and keep a buffer for favourites. Bring food out gradually so guests can keep grazing without crowding the table.

I find the best twists are ones that look brand new but you instantly recognise the flavour of something you have always loved
— Mahtab Raza Ansari, executive chef

Keep the flavour, rethink the format

Familiar dishes offer plenty of possibilities beyond miniature *samosas*. Ansari suggests biryani arancini, *dal makhani* on toasted bread coins and *pav bhaji* sliders, with thickened sauces and sturdy fillings. Chef Pooja Sachdeva suggests *chole* in tart shells, individual *dahi papdi* cups, mini *kathi* rolls and bite-sized *paneer tikka* skewers. "The key is to reinvent the technique, not the flavour, creating intrigue while retaining familiarity."

Choubey's suggestions include beetroot *murabba* croquettes with chilli jam, jackfruit *shikampuri pao* tacos with *thecha*, and *gulab jamun* kunafa bites with tangy cherry sauce. For simpler sweet finishes, consider Sachdeva's mini *shrikhand* tarts or Ansari's *motichoor ladoo* cheesecake shots.

I would serve food in smaller quantities and replenish it as needed, rather than crowding the table from the start. Choose dishes that can be prepared ahead, keep spare serving spoons and napkins handy, and use serving bowls that are easy to carry. This keeps the table looking fresh and lets the host enjoy the evening too
— Sheeba D'Souza, chef, food stylist and author

Build bites that hold together

The first test is whether guests can comfortably eat a dish while standing. Executive chef Mahtab Raza Ansari recommends "*paneer tikka* skewers, savoury tartlets and individual *chaat* cups, with portions that hold their shape and fillings that stay put". Chef and culinary consultant Nishant Choubey puts equal emphasis on texture and holding quality. "The other important consideration is temperature and holding quality. A dish that becomes soggy within minutes or requires complicated assembly can disrupt the flow of a party. Small plates should allow the host to spend more time with guests and less time managing the food," he says.

Korean fried bao buns

Bhai Dooj gifting

What do you get a sibling who has everything?

Shopping for a sibling who buys whatever they want, the moment they want it? The usual wallet, perfume or box of chocolates probably won't cut it. This Bhai Dooj, skip the predictable gifting routine and look for something they wouldn't necessarily buy for themselves. Think personalised, practical or just a little unexpected. Here's where to start.

Give their everyday essentials an upgrade

A good pair of headphones, a sleek coffee tumbler, or a premium desk organiser can make everyday routines feel a little more special. Pick something that fits their lifestyle.

Make it personal

Turn an old sibling photograph into a framed print, put together a mini scrapbook of childhood memories or customise a phone case with an inside joke. It's the kind of gift that money can't quite replicate.

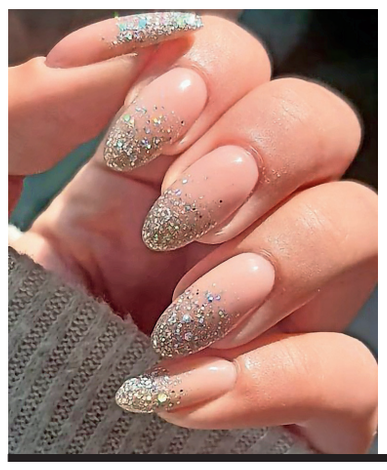
Gift an experience, not another thing

Book a pottery workshop, a concert, a stand-up comedy show or a cooking class you can attend together. Shared plans also mean you get to spend time together beyond the customary *tilak* and *mithai* exchange.

Build them a little indulgence kit

Put together a curated box with their favourite speciality coffee, niche snacks, skincare minis or books from an author they love and add a handwritten note. Thoughtful beats expensive, every time.

Nailed it! Quick festive manicures for your Diwali



Running late for a Diwali party but your nails are still giving weekday energy? All you need is a couple of nail paints and ten minutes. These two easy designs will have your fingertips party-ready before the cab arrives.

GLITTER, BUT MAKE IT SUBTLE

Not ready for full-on glitter nails? Apply a sheer nude or champagne base and dab fine gold glitter polish onto the tips. Use a sponge to build the glitter gradually instead of applying one thick coat. Seal everything with a glossy top coat.

GOLDEN TIPS, MAJOR GLAM

Give the French manicure a festive update. Apply a nude or sheer pink base, let it dry, then use a gold metallic polish to paint thin tips. No steady hand? Stick a piece of tape just below the nail tips to get a cleaner line. Finish with a clear top coat for that salon-like shine. Works especially well with gold jewellery and traditional outfits.

Did You Know?

Deepika danced wearing 30-kg chaniya cholis

In Sanjay Leela Bhansali's *Goliyon Ki Raasleela Ram-Leela*, Deepika Padukone's *chaniya cholis* for the garba sequences weighed up to 30 kg, requiring her to build immense stamina to spin and dance gracefully on set.

Deepavali meant 22 cousins, identical clothes and a house full of joy, says Shivarajkumar

Karthikeyan Sairam

Shivarajkumar with wife Geetha Shivarajkumar (left) and daughter Niveditha Shivarajkumar (right) lighting up diyas at their home in Bengaluru

CONTINUED FROM 1

"There would be a long line of cars belonging to film producers ducers who visited on the first day of the festival to give sweets to Appaji. In return, he would give them sweets and a Rs 20 note, which they considered a lucky charm," he shares.

He also recalls, "In the kitchen, my mother and our atthes (aunts) would prepare a feast. Sitting together with the entire family and enjoying a festive lunch was a joy. We followed this ritual throughout living in Chennai."

APPAJI'S WONDER AT FIREWORKS IS A MEMORY I CHERISH

Shivanna says, "After we moved to Bengaluru, the celebrations continued on an equally grand scale. In the early years, my mother, Parvathamma, would ensure that someone was sent to the city on the eve of Deepavali to buy identical clothes for all the children. She believed shops offered better discounts closer to the festival, and she was right! Regardless of whether someone was an infant, in their late teens or early twenties, we all had to wear the same clothes. I loved how inclusive it made us feel, without any distinction or preferential treatment."

He shares, "At night, when it was time for fireworks, Appaji would place a chair by the front gate and watch us light them. I still get goosebumps when I think of the childlike glee on his face as a rocket lit up the sky. '*Hingella itatta*?' he would ask in wonder. That's why he was Dr Rajkumar. He never pretended to know it all and could enjoy everything as though it were life's biggest marvel."

> I still love lighting fireworks, but not as much as Appu and I once did
> - Shivarajkumar

He continues to say, "After my brother Appu and I got married and started living in our own homes, he would host a Deepavali party one day and I would host it the next. We would easily have over 100 people, given the size of both our paternal and maternal families. We simply enjoyed being together and savouring home-cooked meals."

Shivanna mentions, "Today, I do exactly what Appaji did decades ago. I place a chair by the gate and watch the fireworks being lit around our home. I remember his face every Deepavali, and that is the thread that binds me to the festival."

CELEBRATIONS HAVE BECOME MORE INTIMATE OVER THE YEARS

Recalling his memories of celebrating Deepavali, Shivanna says, "I have many endearing memories of past celebrations. But the children have grown up and have families and traditions of their own. At our home today, it is more about spreading light and joy and spending time with friends who visit us during the festival."

"I still love lighting fireworks, but not as much as Appu and I once did. My daughters prefer celebrating in a more relaxed and peaceful way, so our festivities are now more intimate and casual than they used to be. Geeta makes the best food in the world, and I enjoy whatever she prepares," he adds.

"Every celebration evolves with time, and I am happy that my family has always remained at its centre. As for what I wish for this Deepavali, it is good health for my wife, children and the rest of the family. I never ask God for fame or material wealth. My prayers are for the well-being of society and the safety of women," he tells us.

FILM REVIEWS NOW IN CINEMAS...

Jithu, Suriya give a breezy, fun spin to the serial-killer genre

SCENE
(Crime/Comedy)
★★★★
Cast: Suriya, Naslen, Nazriya Fahadh, Lal, Anandaraj
Duration: 2hr, 29mins
Director: Jithu Madhavan
Language: Tamil, Telugu (UA 16+)

Should you watch it?
A serial killer thriller that's more fun than frightening, with a relaxed, charming Suriya, so yes!

Review in short

Breezy is the last adjective one might think of for a serial killer movie, but Jithu Madhavan's *Scene*, starring a wonderfully relaxed Suriya, is just that. *Scene* is the most entertaining and inventive Tamil film of 2026. The surprises begin with the eccentric cop Inbaraj, who has a Sherlockish eye for clues but also a weakness that makes him vulnerable. He is in pursuit of Easwaran (Naslen, casually cool), a clever serial killer. Inba's team includes Maya (Nazriya Fahadh, spunky), also his love interest. The music by Sushin Shyam keeps it groovy. The film takes time to find its rhythm, but once the cat-and-mouse game begins, it has us hooked.

– M Suganth

Want a more detailed review? Head to **etimes.in**

RATING SCALE: TRASH ★ | BELOW AVERAGE ★★ | AVERAGE ★★½ | ABOVE AVERAGE ★★★ | GOOD ★★★½ | VERY GOOD ★★★★ | OUTSTANDING ★★★★½ | MASTERPIECE ★★★★★